Dos & Don'ts

of UI Design

Learn How Even Minor Changes can have a Significant Impact on the Quality of Your Design.

An Introduction

First of all, Thank You so much for getting this “UI Pedia” for yourself.

Secondly, let us introduce ourself – “We are the team of qualified designer at Pixsel who aim to provide the best knowledge to upcoming Designers. We think that sharing the knowledge we have, will bring the community together.

With this hope, the Instagram page named – Pixsel Academy was created.

As we were sharing the knowledge through our posts yet, we decided to make this freebie for our followers that contains around 101 UI design tips.

I hope, this will help you in a way and that’s what our mission is. Providing the knowledge and resourses that we can.

Let’s all grow together and grow this community even bigger.

Thank You so much.

Let’s begin

Tip - 1 Human-like Language

APPLE Airpods Pro

with MagSafe Charging Case Bluetooth Headset

In stock: **7**

₹21,900

Cart

Avoid using Robotic language, this will make user confused.

APPLE Airpods Pro

with MagSafe Charging Case Bluetooth Headset

Only **7** left in stock!

₹21,900

Add to Cart

Use human-like language to connect labels and values.

Tip - 2 Limit Saturation

Adding elements with high saturation will damage the contrast of your dark UI.

Avoid going beyond 200 - 500 of tone level when using colors.

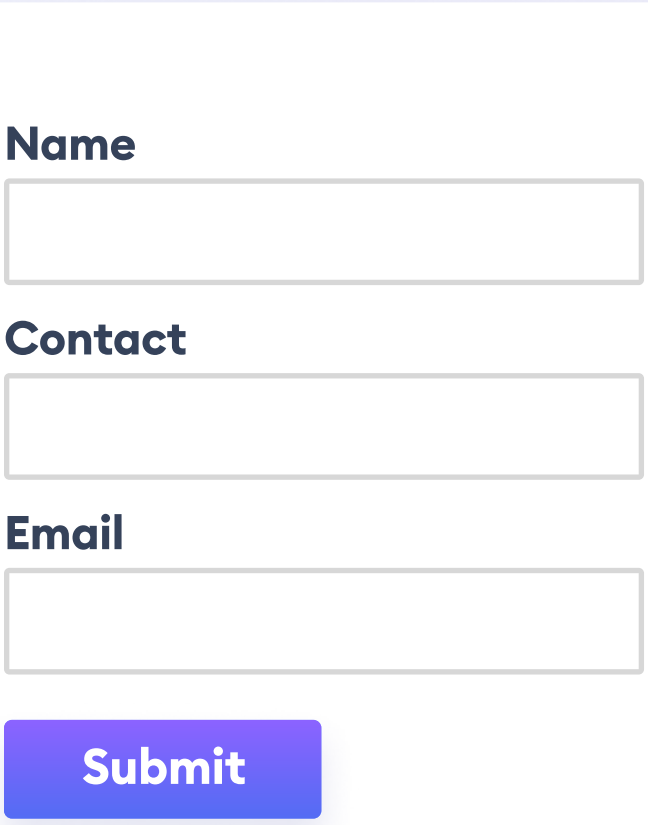
Tip - 3 Making 2 Color Palettes

Avoid using same color palettes for both Dark and Light mode.

Most of the people prefer light theme. So, make a different color palette with darker shades.

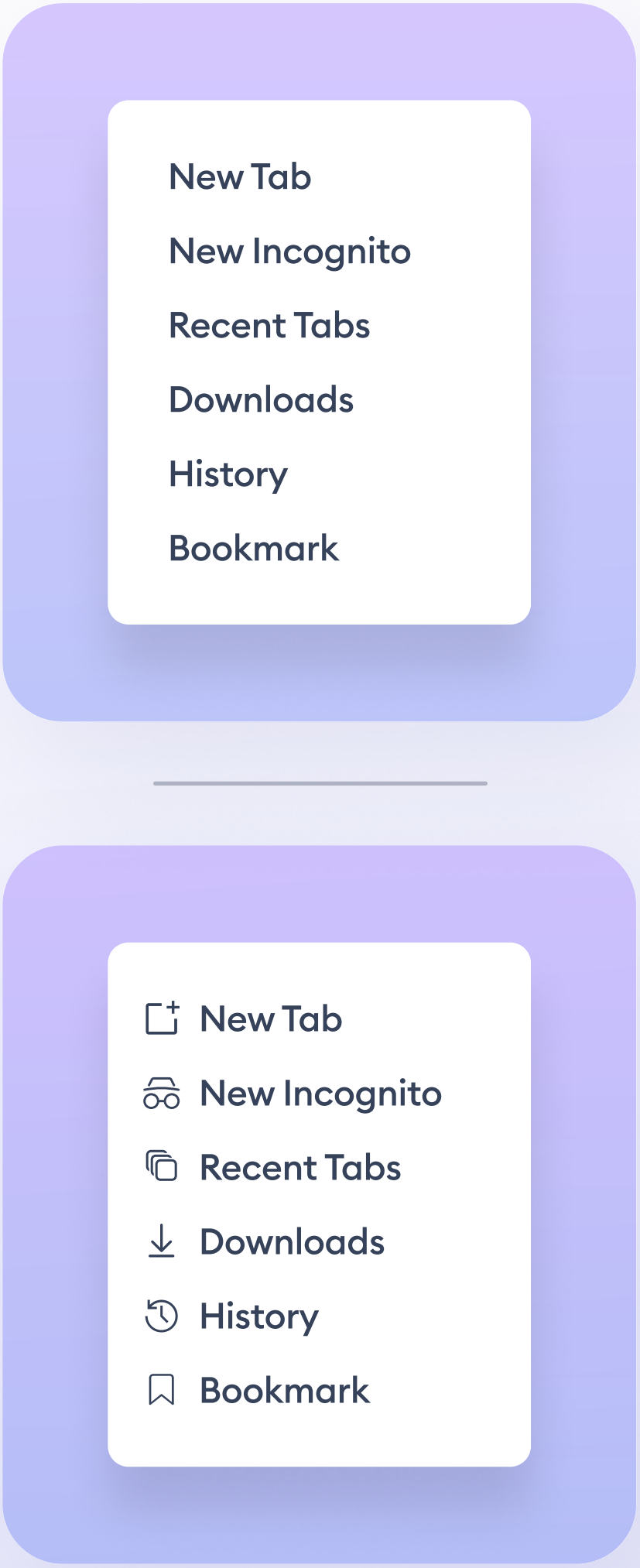
Tip - 4 Horizontal Alignment

Inconsistent alignment looks very unprofessional and hard to follow.



Using horizontal alignment make user's orient much better and faster in forms.

Tip - 5 Menu Representation



Avoid using only labels for complex or abstract functions.

Use Icon + Label representation to create rational and emotional impact.

Tip - 6 Breaking Up Content

Property Feature

Beautiful waterfront location. 98% of recent guests gave this location a 5-star review. Fast check-in experience. 95% of recent guests gave the check-in experience a 5-star review. Free secure parking. This property features a single lock-up garage with storage.

Avoid using only text for showing important features.

PROPERTY FEATURES

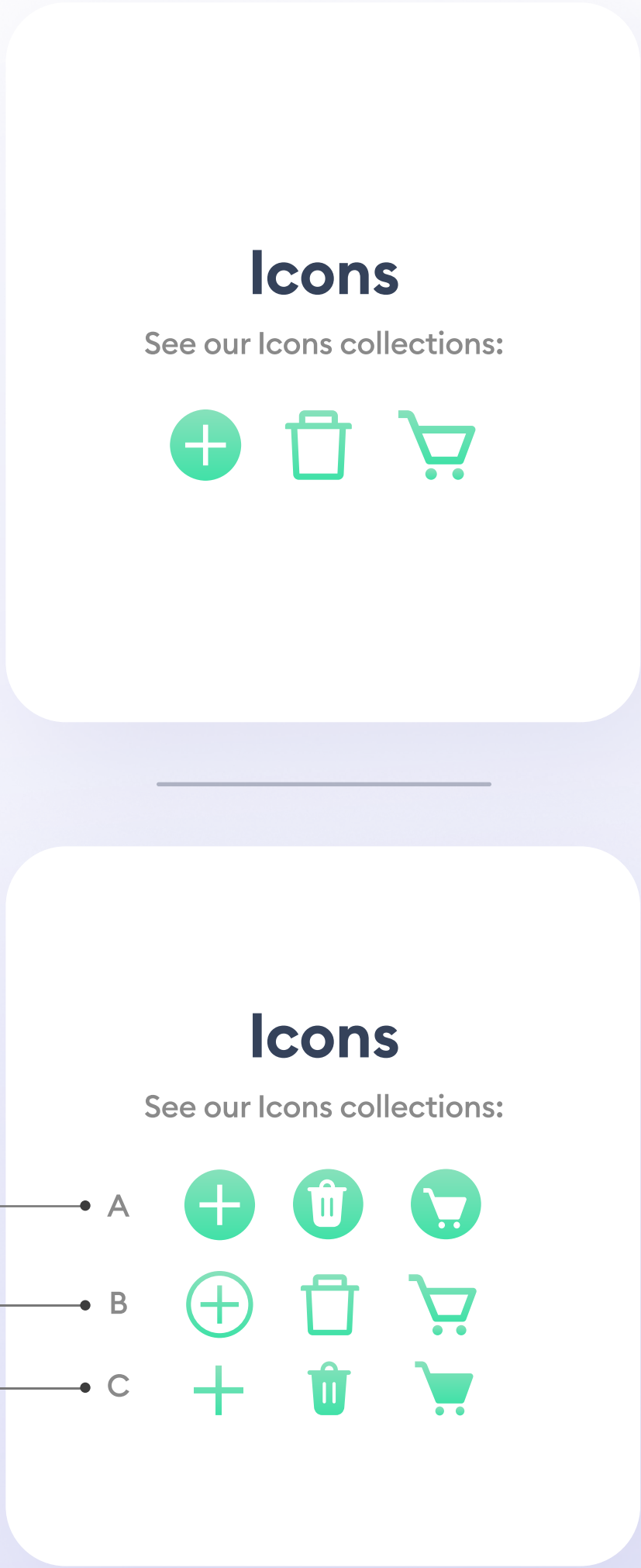
Beautiful Waterfront Location
98% of recent guests gave this location a 5-star review.

Fast check-in experience
95% of recent guests gave the check-in experience a 5-star review.

Free secure parking
This property features a single lock-up garage with storage.

Allow people to quickly scan content by using descriptive headings and icons.

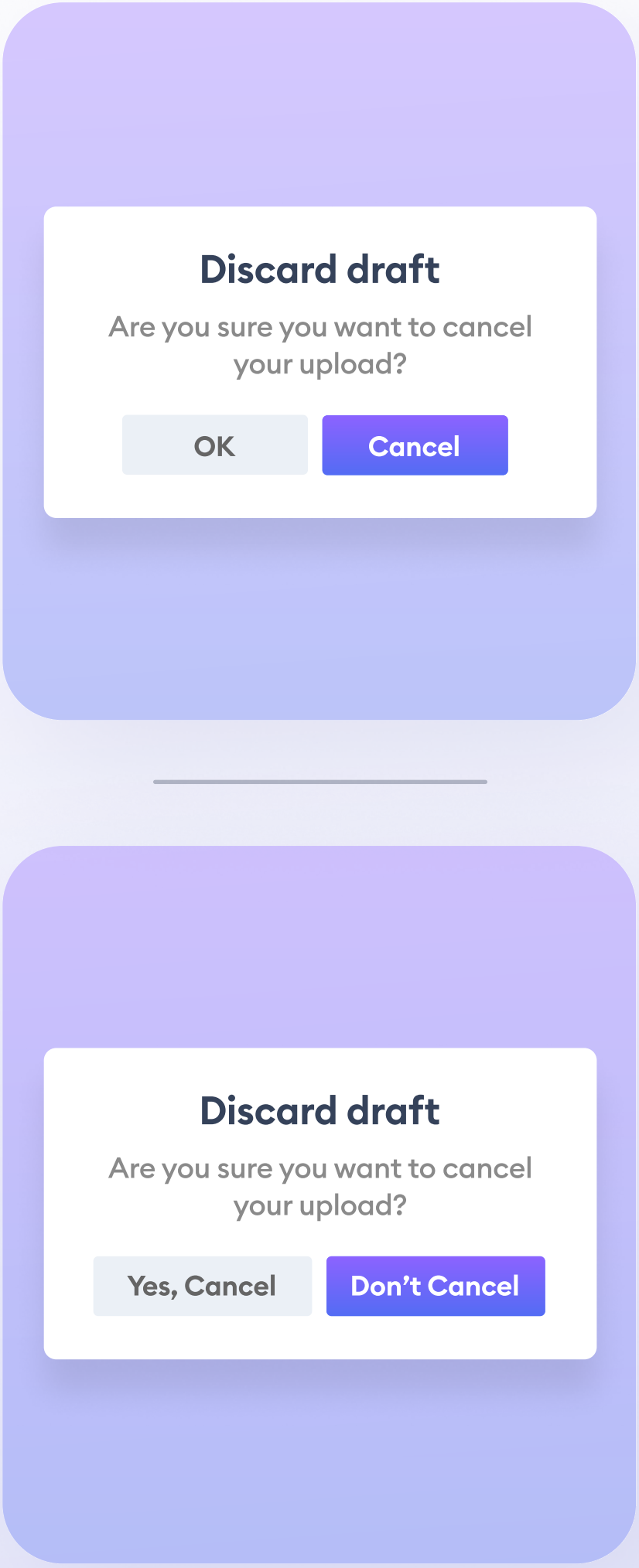
Tip - 7 Icon Consistency



Inconsistent icons could create a risk of confusion and can hurt brand's visual credibility.

Use a consistent icon set for better communication among the users.

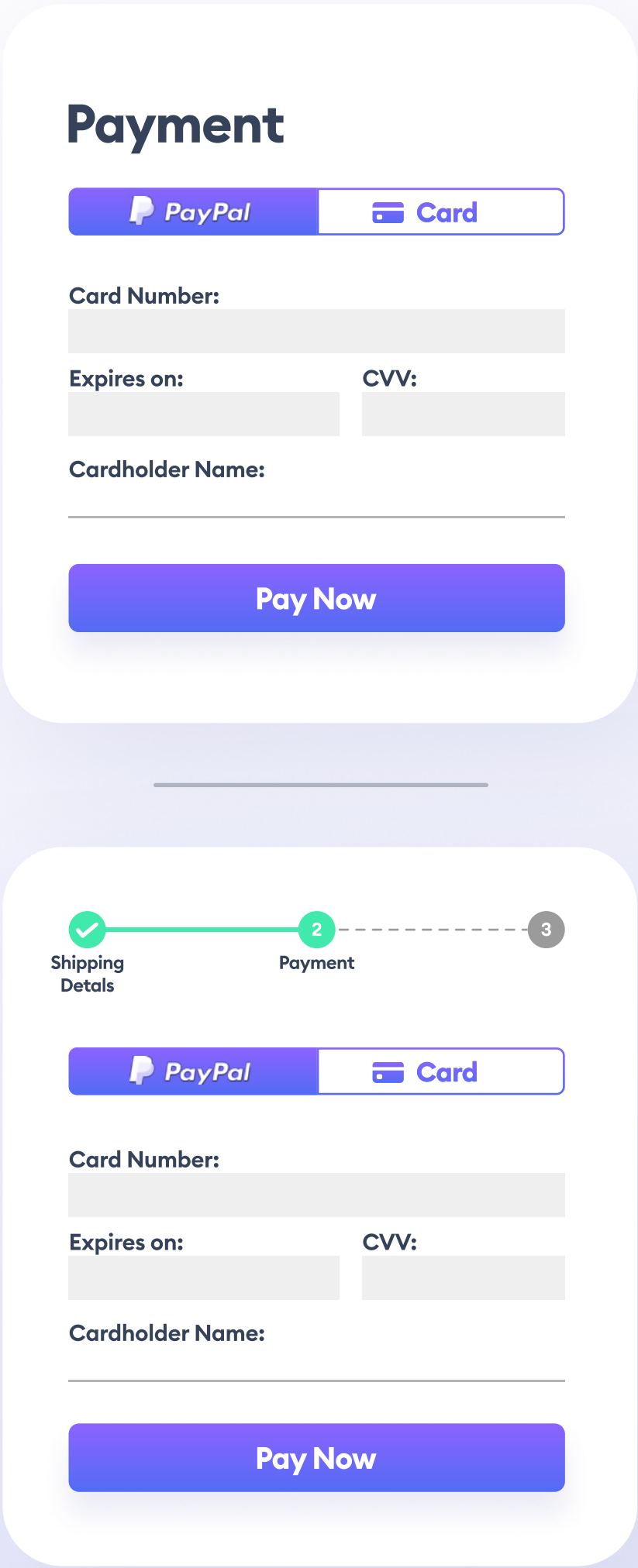
Tip - 8 Descriptive Options



This is an example of bad UX. It creates confusion for users to select an option.

Having options with clear description helps the users to take decision as per his/her choice.

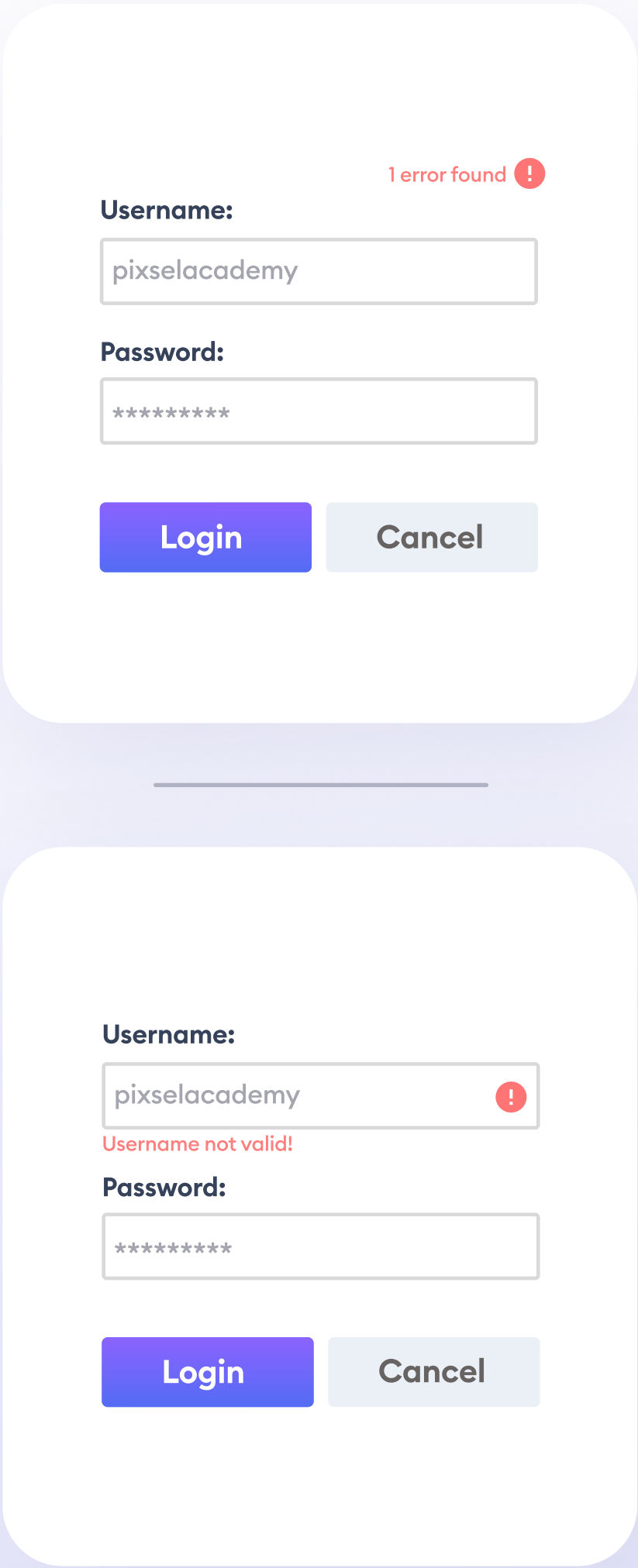
Tip - 9 Process Bar



Here user won't be able to track their process in the flow.

Use a process bar to indicate the user's status in the process flow.

Tip - 10 Tooltips & Guides



Here users will find it difficult to locate the error and the reason for the same.

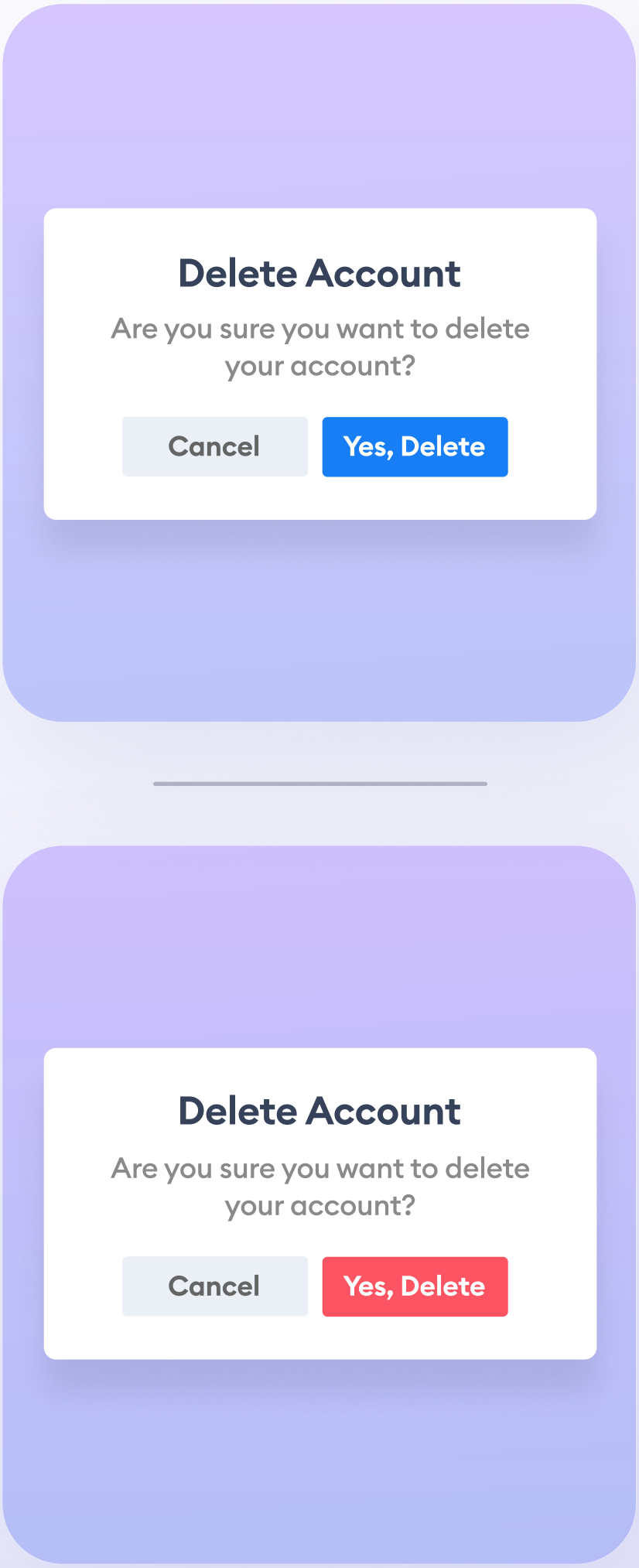
Show the user where and why the error occurred. This help users to do the necessary changes.

Tip - 11 Fitt's Law

Small and Distanced CTA will acquire more time for users to take action.

Keep main CTA big and closer to the thumb. This will help users to identify easily.

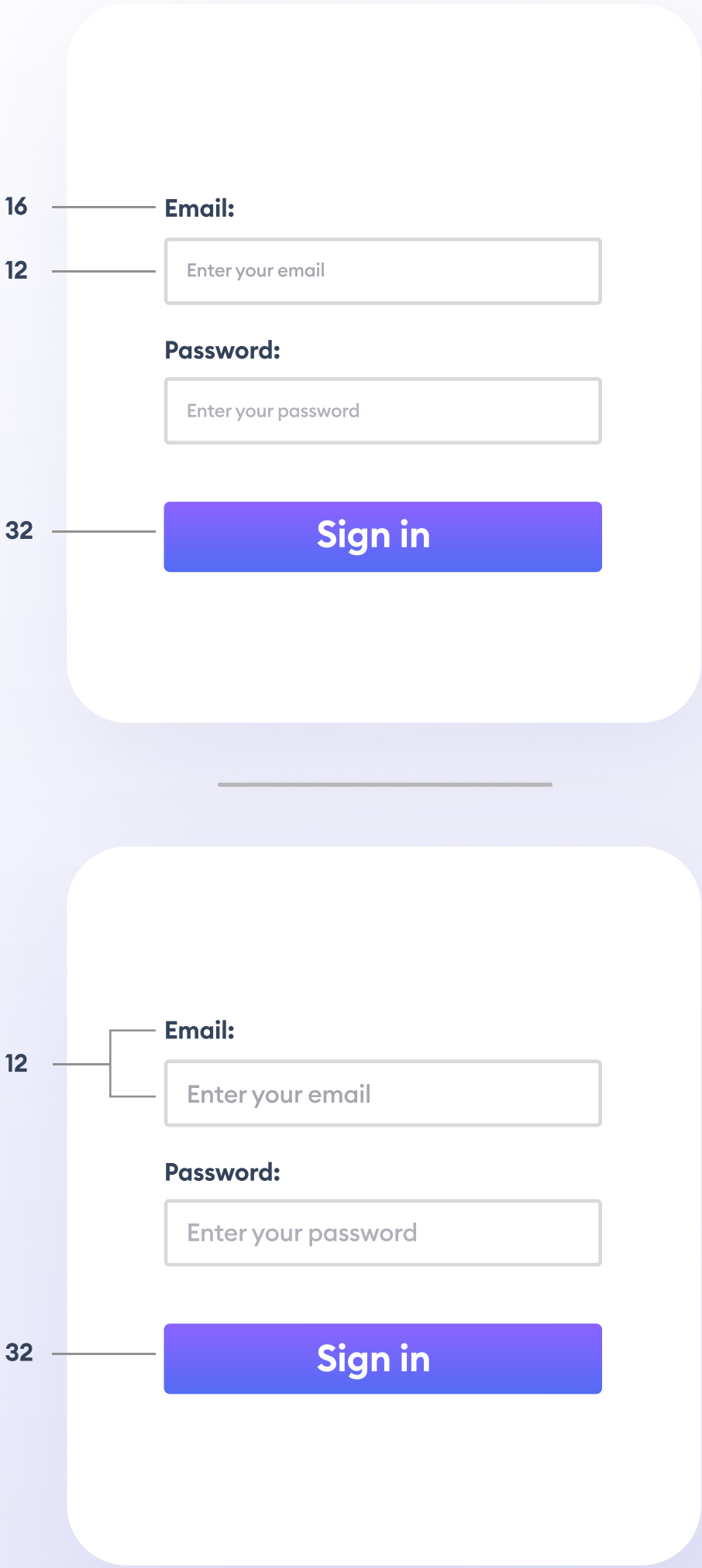
Tip - 12 Color Psychology



Blue color for destructive action looks normal.

Red color for destructive action alerts the users and act as a warning sign.

Tip - 13 Fewer Font Sizes



The more font sizes, the longer it takes to process the form.

Try to differentiate the font only between sections and actions.

Tip - 14 Single Column Form

Multiple columns disrupt a user's vertical momentum.

Use a single column on small forms, or group them on other cases.

Tip - 15 Avoid Pure Black

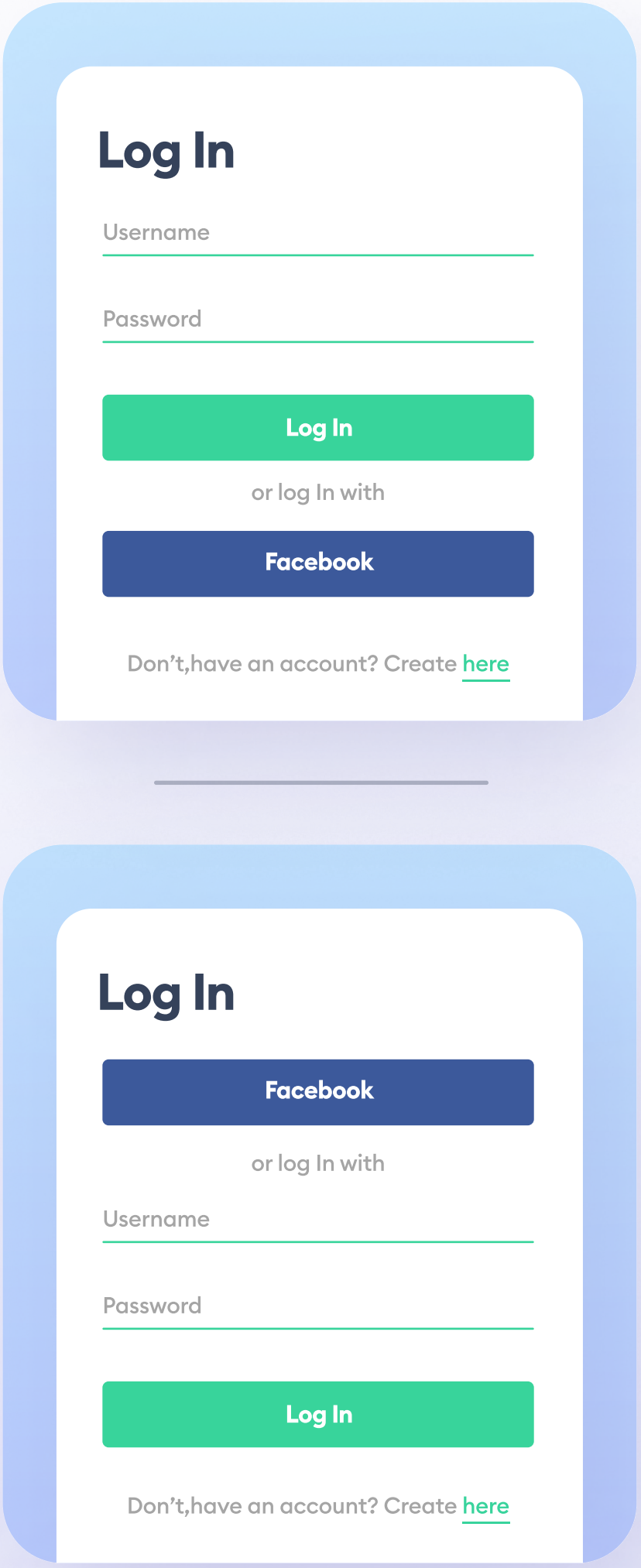
Black
#000000

Pure black or white can cause uneasiness in user's eyes.

Dark Grey
#333335

Avoid using **pure black** instead, you can use variation like this.

Tip - 16 Social Media Login First



Avoid using registration form before social media login option.

Using social media login first help the user to see it first and help to log in without filling the registration form.

Tip - 17 Text Alignment

Beautiful Waterfront Location
98% of recent guests gave this location a 5-star review.

Fast check-in experience
95% of recent guests gave the check-in experience a 5-star review.

Free secure parking
This property features a single lock-up garage with storage

Unaligned text creates difficulty for users to scan the content.

Beautiful Waterfront Location
98% of recent guests gave this location a 5-star review.

Fast check-in experience
95% of recent guests gave the check-in experience a 5-star review.

Free secure parking
This property features a single lock-up garage with storage

Aligning text is an easy way to clean up your design and make content easy to read.

Tip - 18 Checklist Vs Radio Button

What are your favourite skills?

- [ ] Programming
- [x] Design
- [ ] Videography
- [ ] Photography
- [x] Marketing

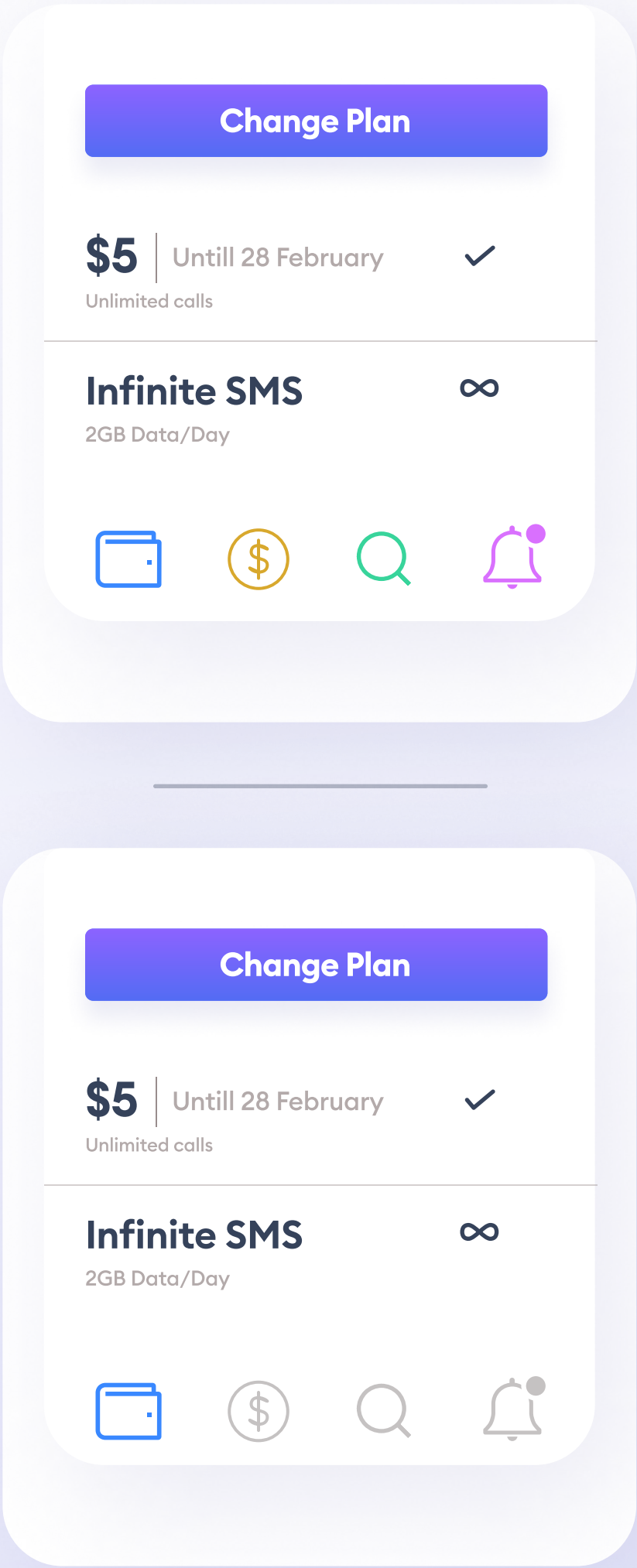
Checklist is use for multiple choice selections.

What are your favourite skills?

- ( ) Python
- ( ) Java
- ( ) Ruby
- (•) JavaScript
- ( ) Swift

Whereas, Radio buttons are use for single choice selections.

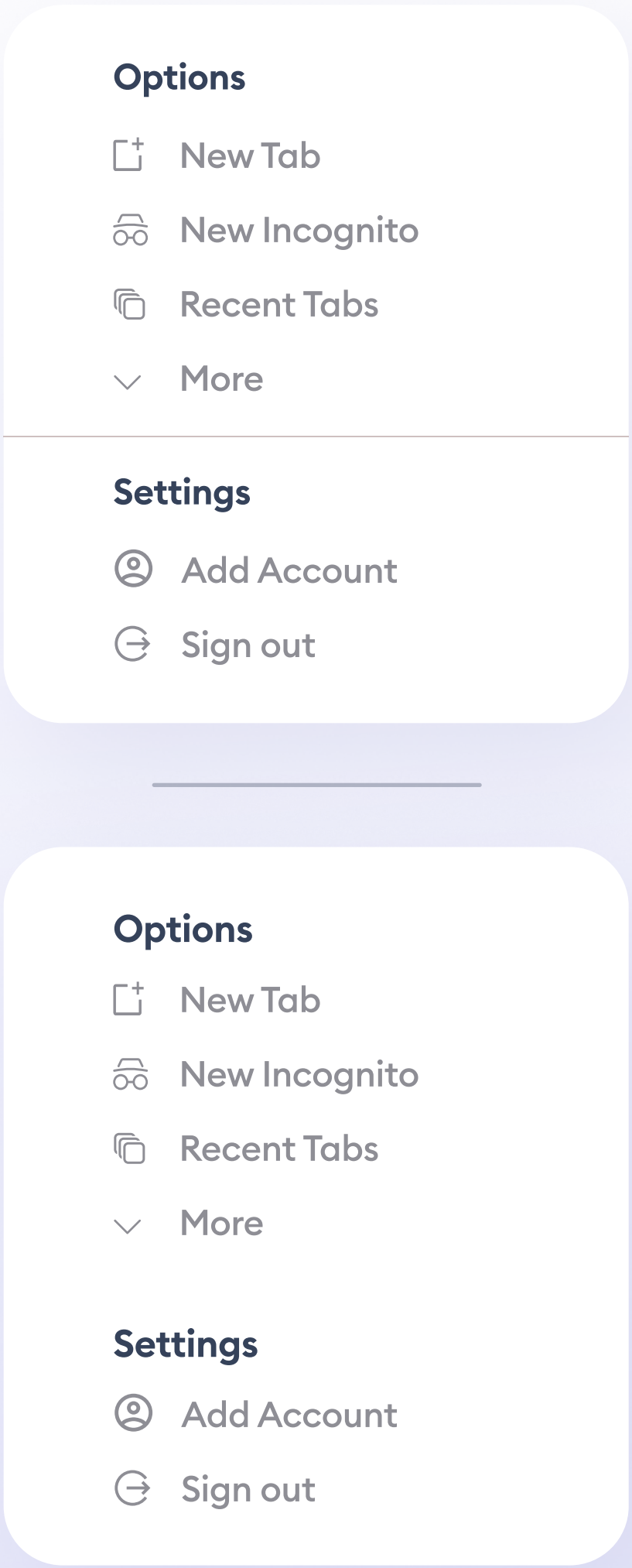
Tip - 19 Selection Color



Multiple colour navigation adds to the cognitive load.

Try keeping colours to two, with one to denote the selection.

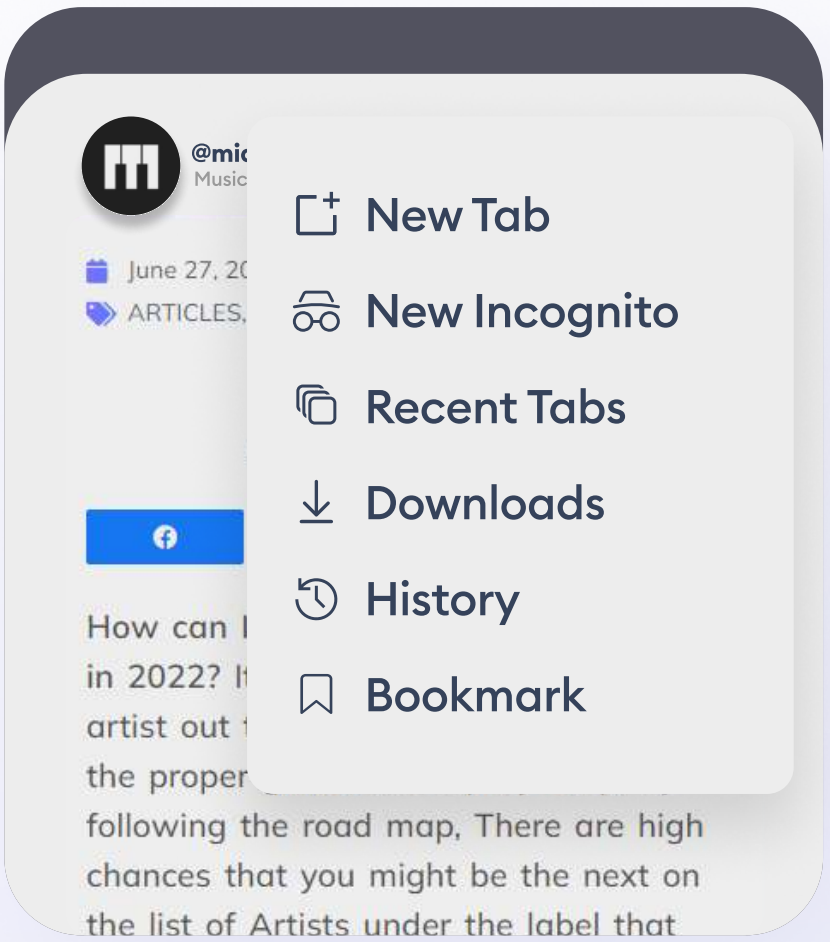
Tip - 20 Space the Sections



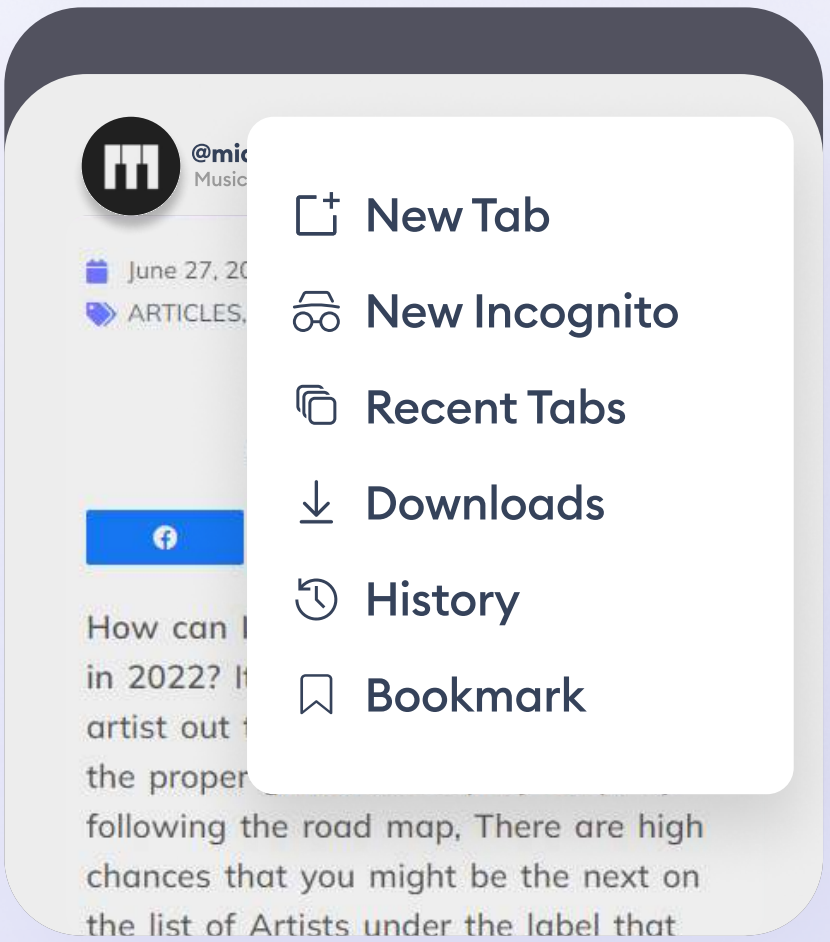
Using new element like “a line” just to create a division is not ideal option.

Instead use spacing to create divisions whenever required.

Tip - 21 Different Shades For Layers



Similar shades for different layer creates uneasiness to the eyes.



Keep the second layer such as drop-down at least 2 shades or tints different than the background.

Tip - 22 Padding & Margin

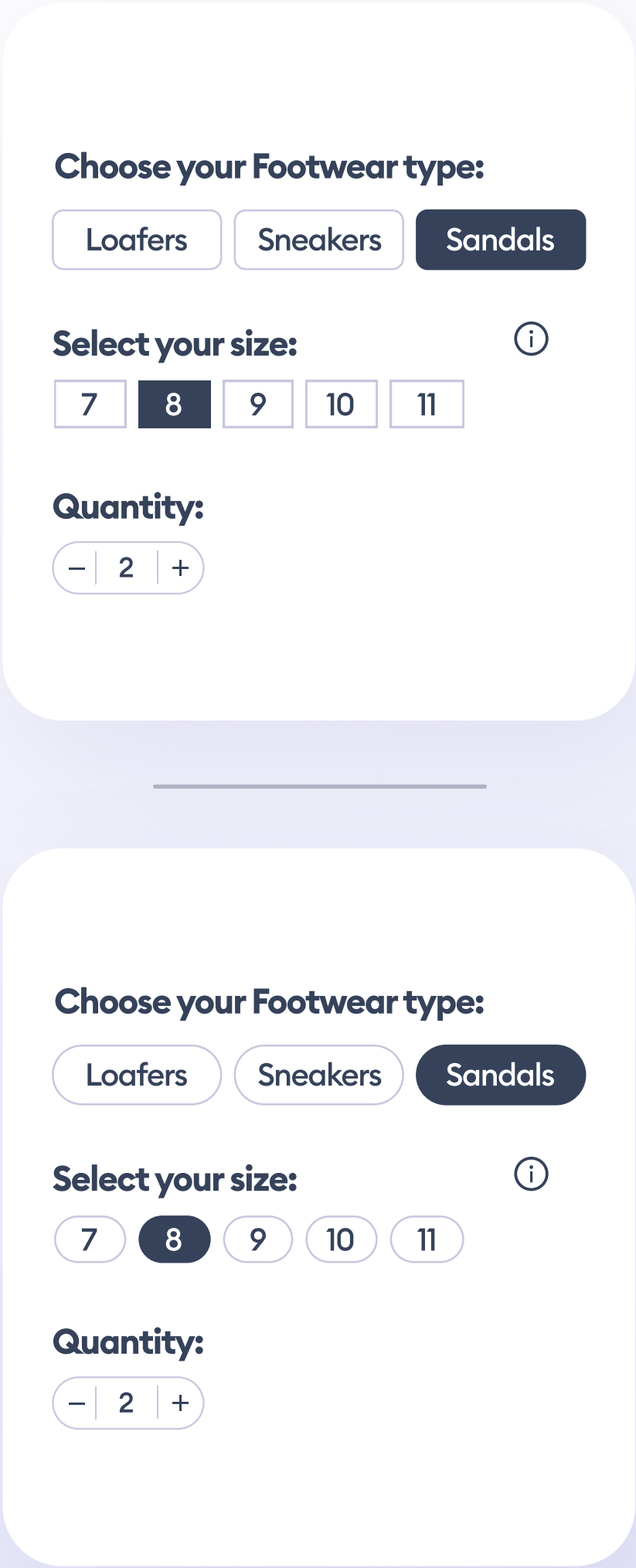
Photography Workshop

Less margin and padding destroy visual hierarchy of the page and looks cluttered.

Photography Workshop

Use more padding and margin to give better breathing space for the design.

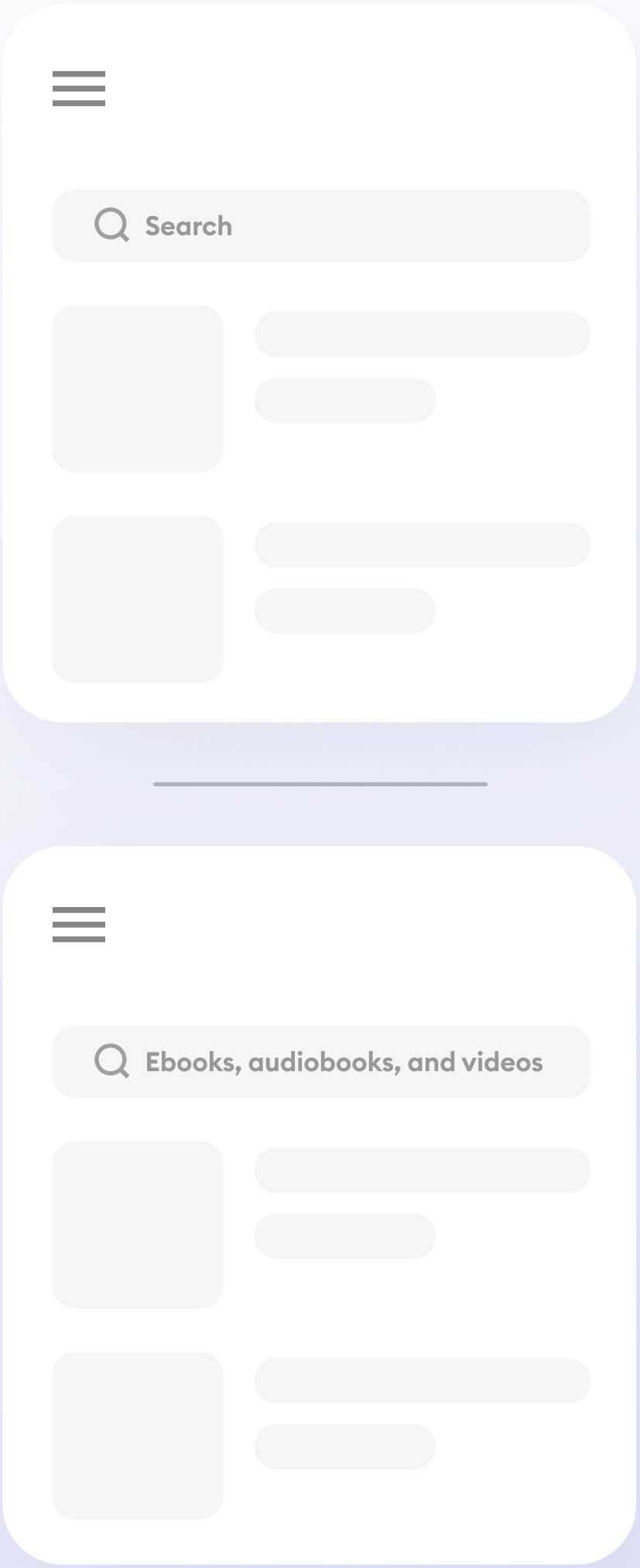
Tip - 23 Pattern Repetition



User Experience almost worsens due to any strange differences in visual elements between screens.

Maintain consistency to make users not to force themself to learn new representations or toolsets for each task.

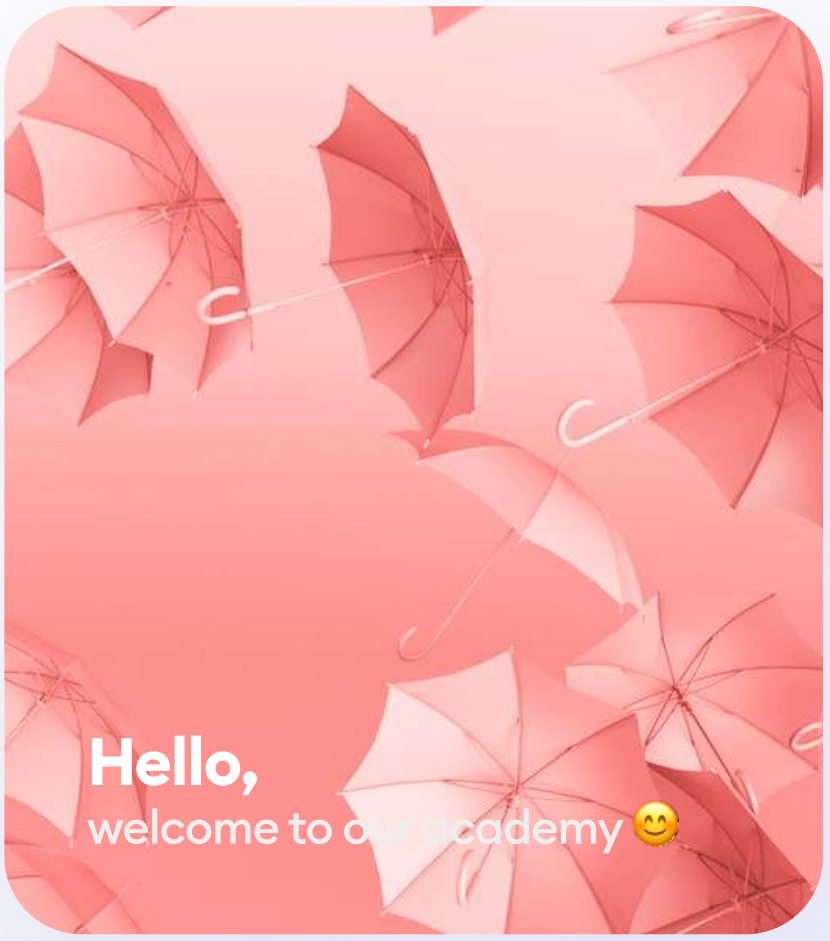
Tip - 24 Search Input



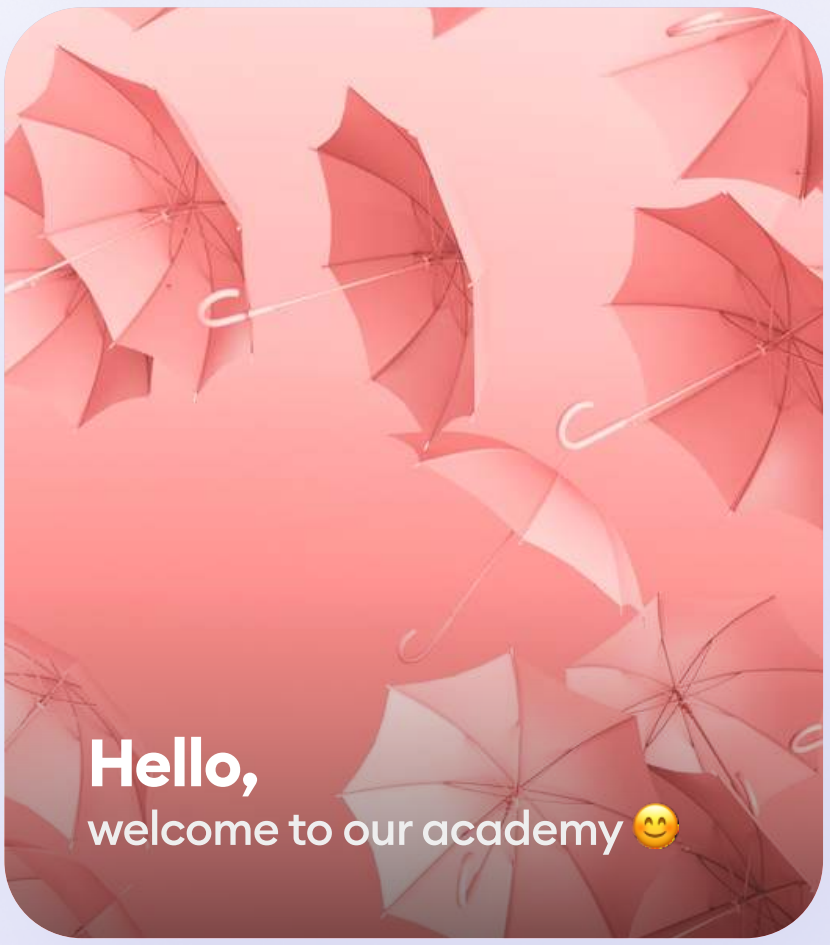
User will feel clueless about what kind of information he can look up without placeholder text in search field.

Use placeholder text in search field to give hint to the users about what kind of information to look up.

Tip - 25 Add Contrast with Overlay

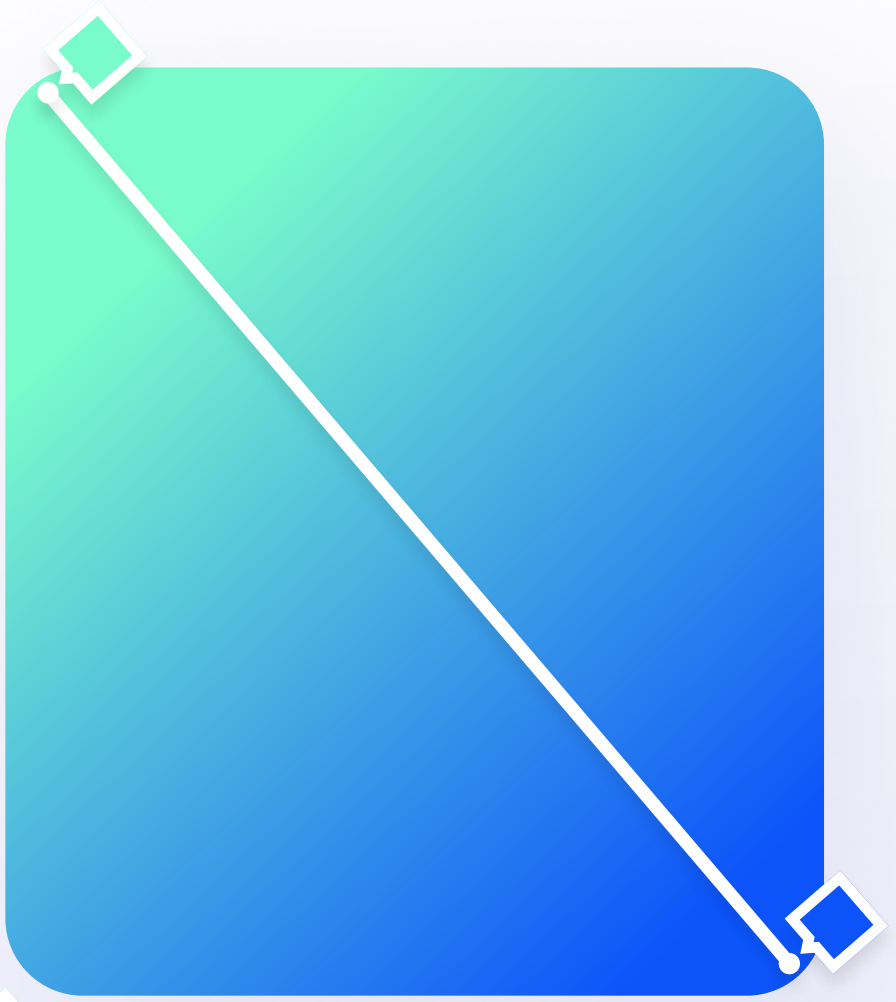


Without contrast the text does not seems to appear clearly because of the bright image.

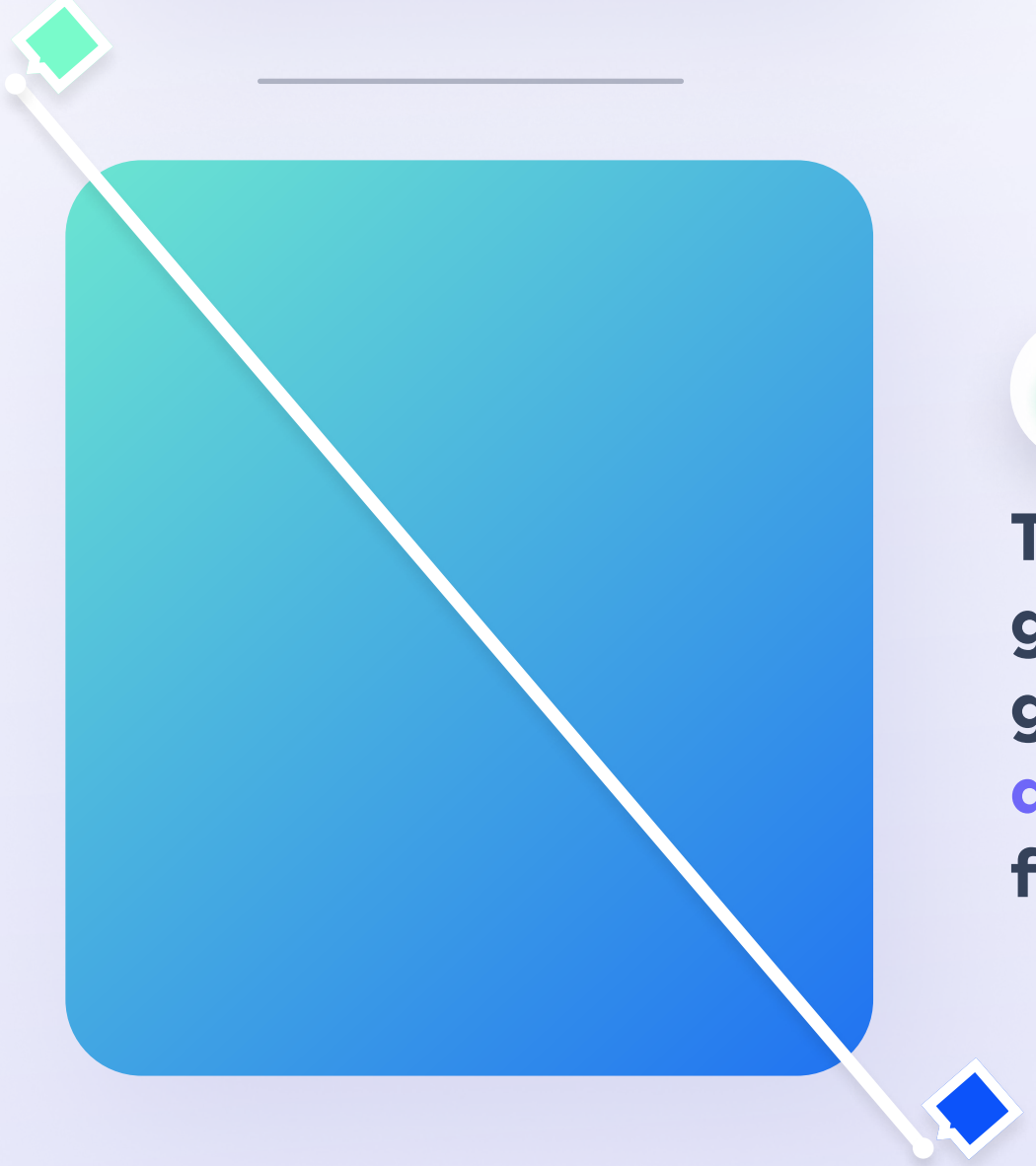


Add contrast with overlay to make your text more visible if the original image isn't dark enough

Tip - 26 Gradient Tip

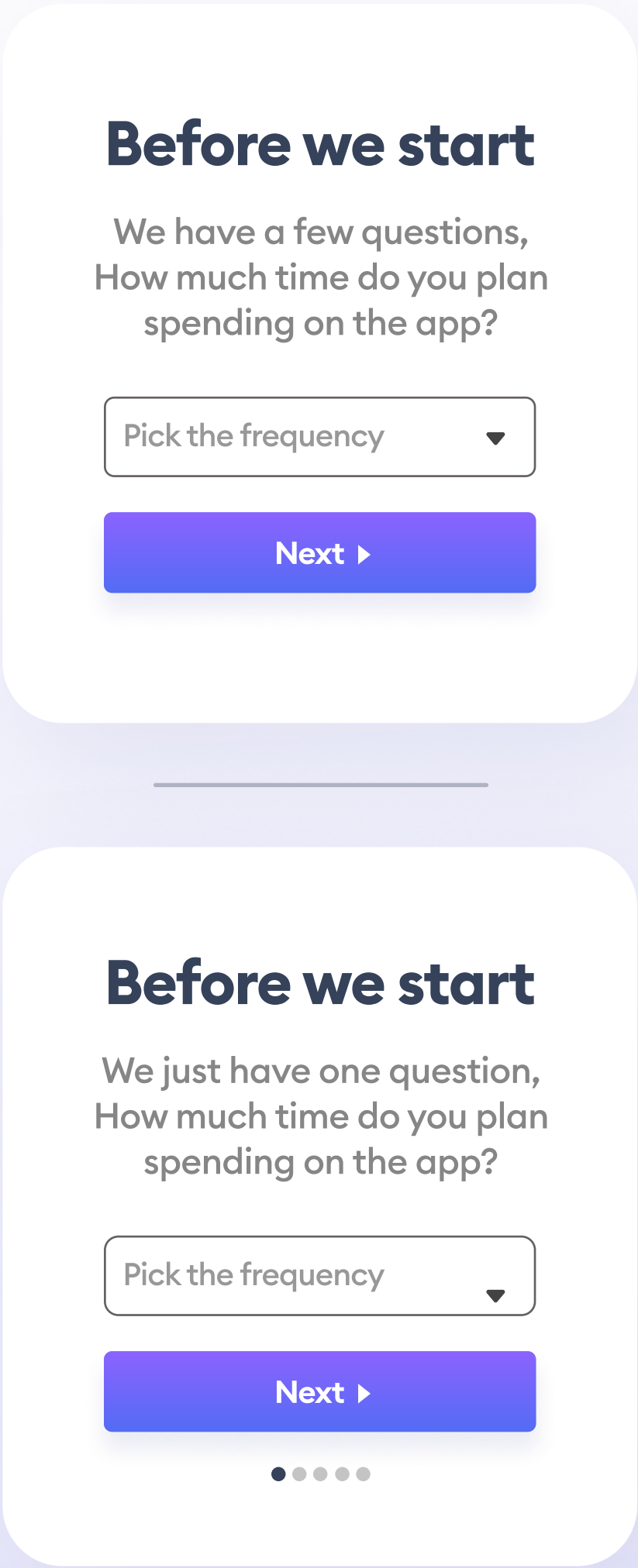


Gradient with close end points looks direct and sharp which creates bad impression.



To achieve a smooth gradient, make the gradient handle's start and end farther away from the object.

Tip - 27 Onboarding Tip



Here the user are not familiar with how many steps or procedures they have to attempt.

Use some visual elements to show the steps or proceducers.

Tip - 28 Make CTA Stand Out

PRO 🚀

$120/m

- Unlimited projects
- Shareable files
- Multiple editors

Get Pro

CTA having dull color creates less attention. So it become hard for user to click on it.

PRO 🚀

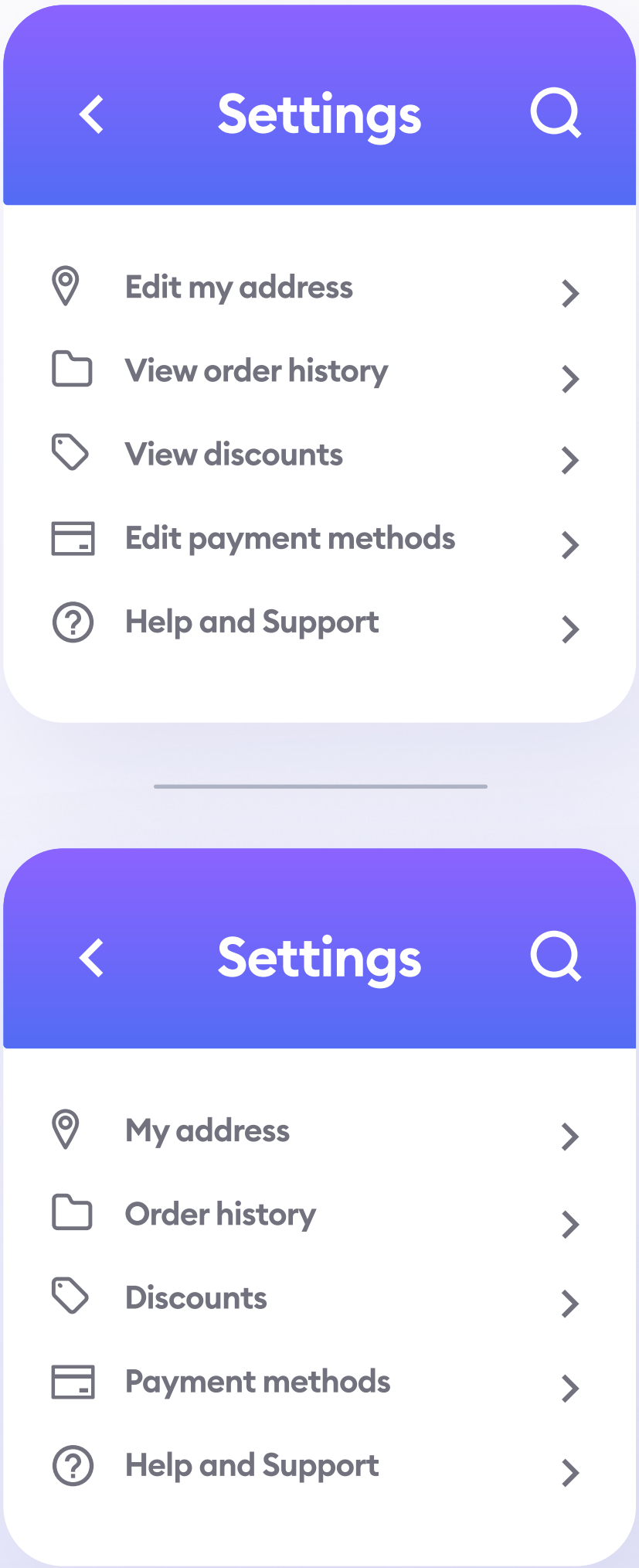
$120/m

- Unlimited projects
- Shareable files
- Multiple editors

Get Pro

Use primary color to make the CTA stand out and encourage action.

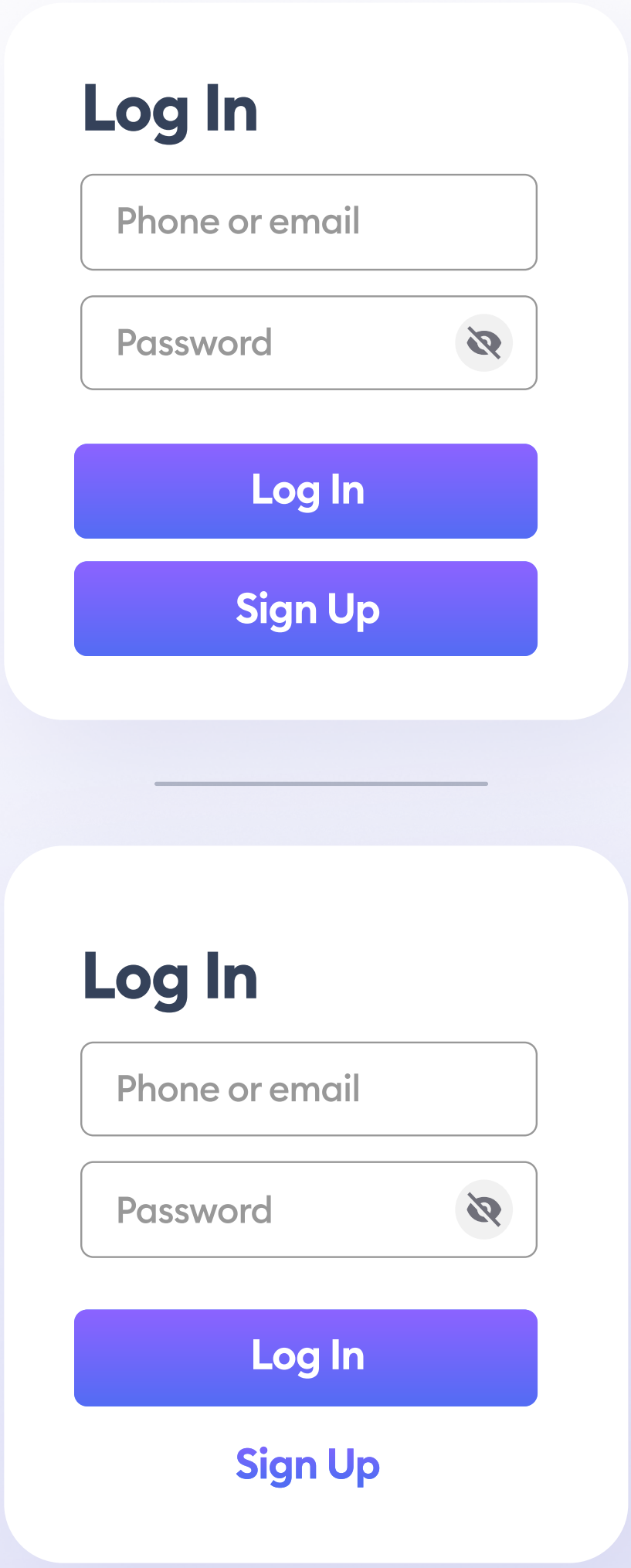
Tip - 29 Cut off Verbs in Label



Using verb in labels makes it long and seems too detailed.

Avoid using verb in labels if it is clear enough to express the action.

Tip - 30 Button Hierarchy



Button without hierarchy harms the visual representation and make user hard to take desicions.

Utilize button hierarchy to help user make a clear choice.

Tip - 31 One Typeface is Good

Travelling

Why Travel the World this year?

If you travel, you will not only learn about foreign cultures, but about your own as well.

Avoid using different typefaces, this creates confusion and harms the readability of the page.

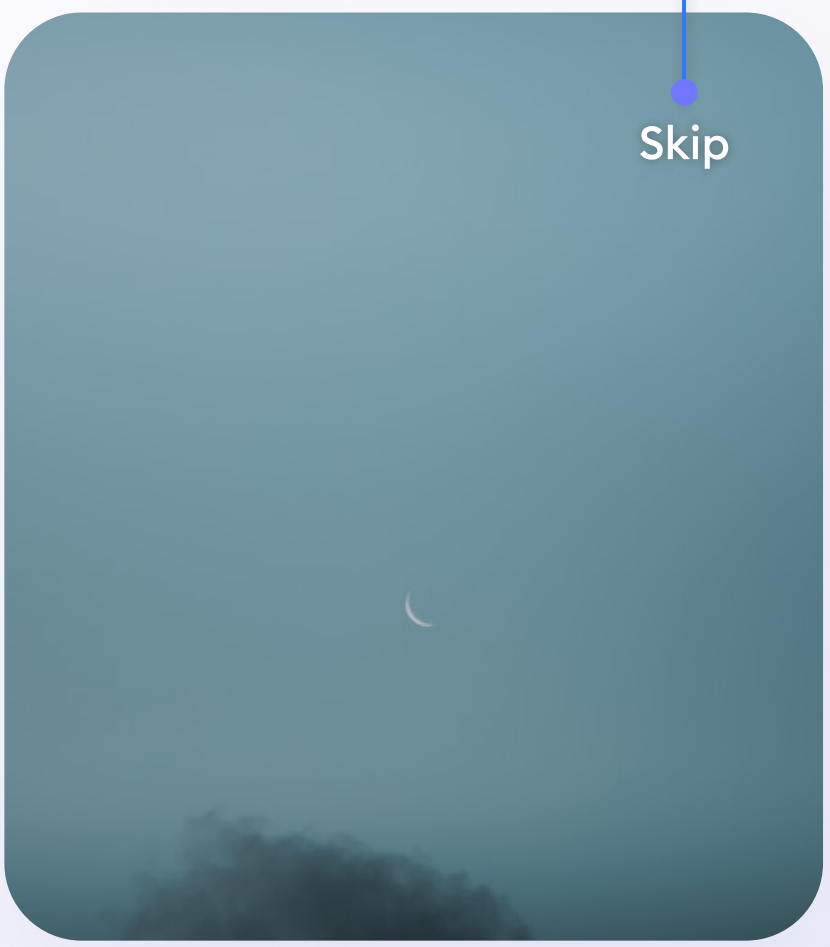
Travelling

Why Travel the World this year?

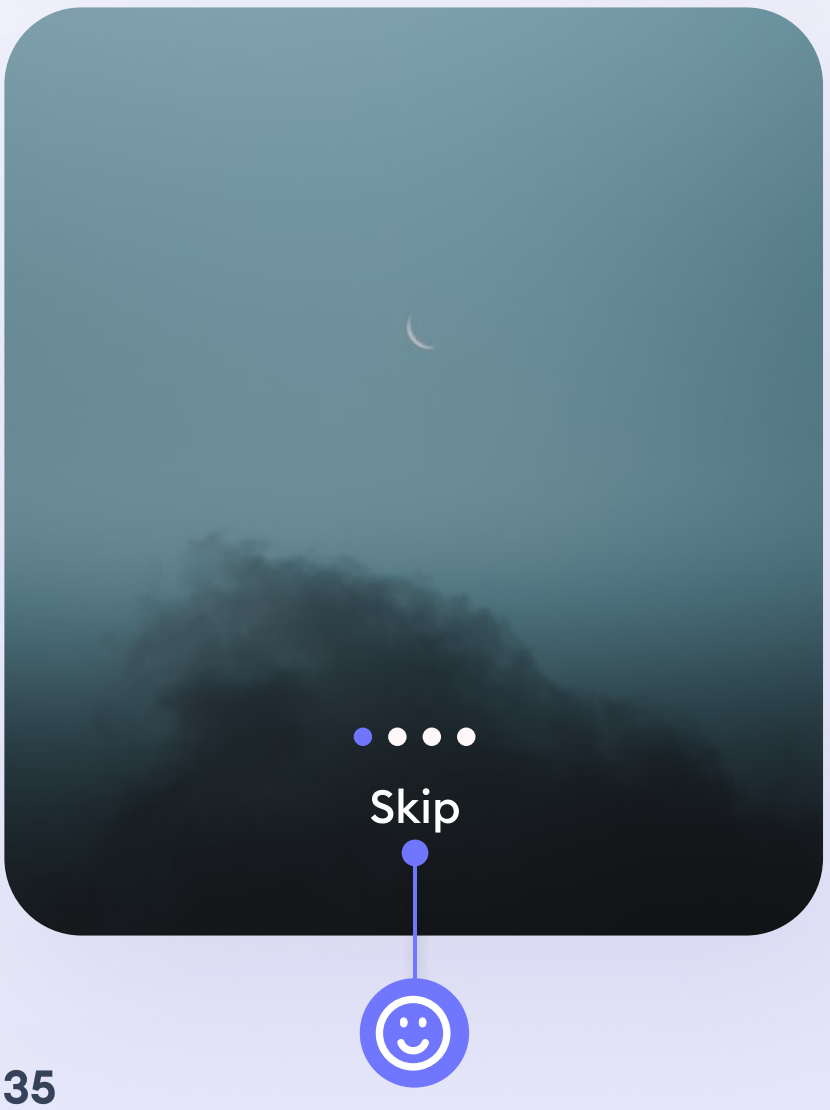
If you travel, you will not only learn about foreign cultures, but about your own as well.

Keeping your typefaces consistent is the key to avoiding confusion. Sticking to a typeface help the users to understand a pattern.

Tip - 32 Improve Onboarding Experience

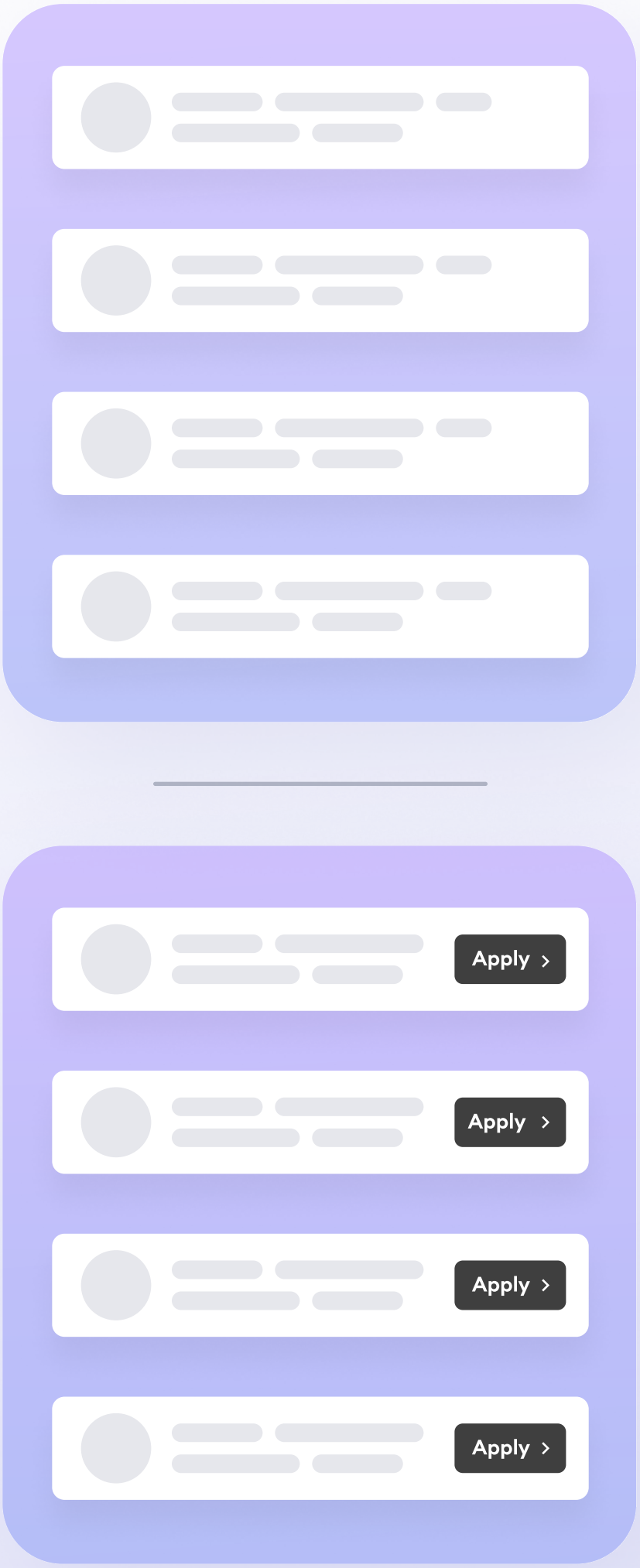


Placing skip link in the top corners will make it little difficult for user to reach.



Enable users to skip your Mobile App Onboarding sequence at any time, and place that Skip link within easy thumb reach.

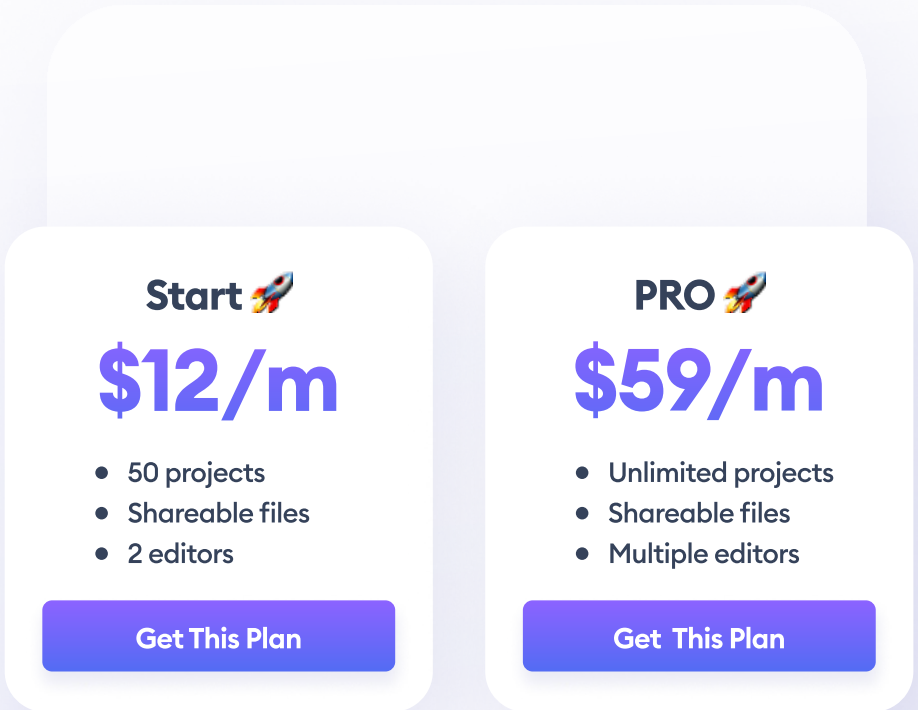
Tip - 33 Make Your Cards Look Clickable



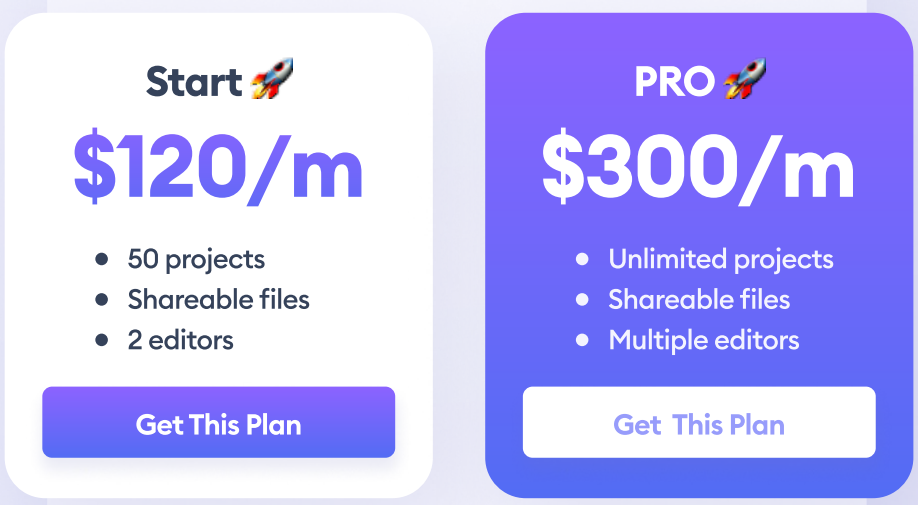
In this case, cards fail to indicate that they're clickable.

use an actionable button to prompt clickability and describe the action.

Tip - 34 Highlight The Best Plan



Having same color for both plan makes the most used plan less of no importance.



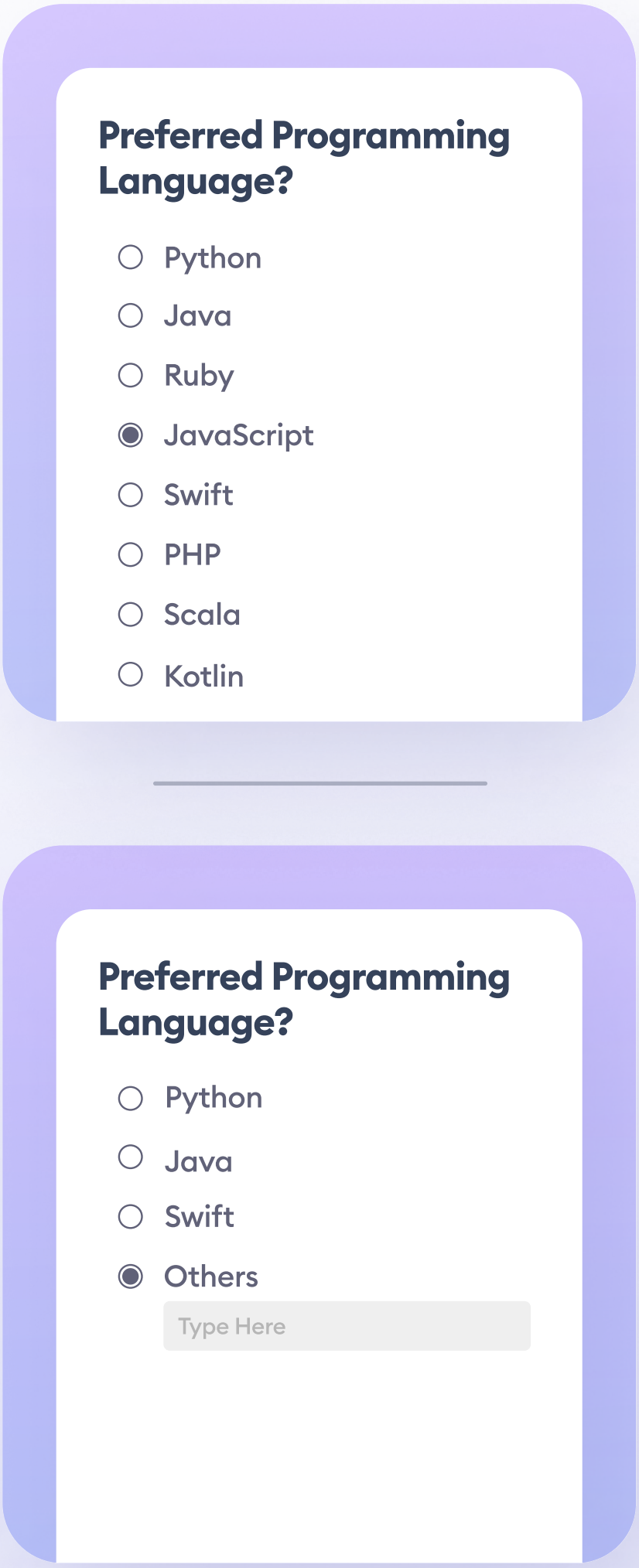
Always highlight the best plan to help users identify the most used plan and you promote your top offer.

Tip - 35 Avoid Too Wide Lines

Wide lines can bore users and create readability problems.

Instead of pixels, you can restrict the character number per line as well for better visual representation of content.

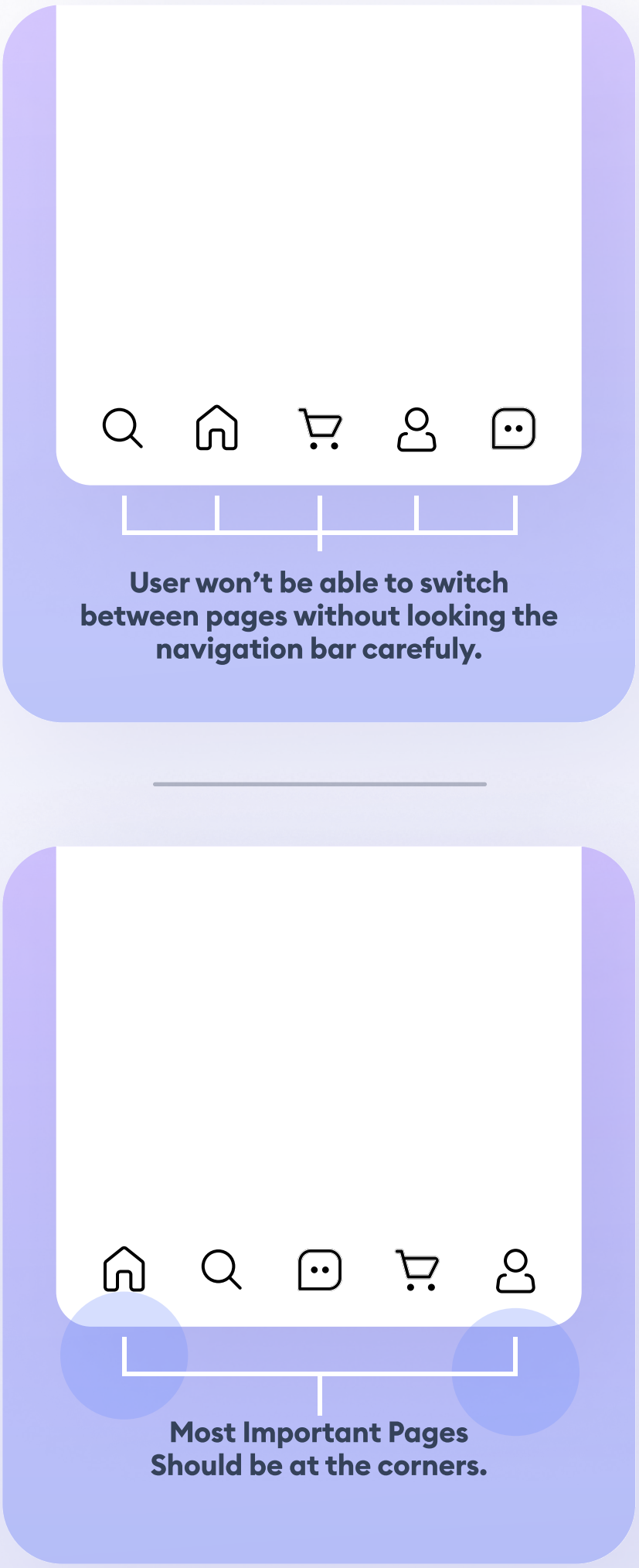
Tip - 36 Hick's Law



More options create complexity of choices and leads to delay in making decision.

Provide user with less options for better and quick decision and also provide the 'other' section for entering their views.

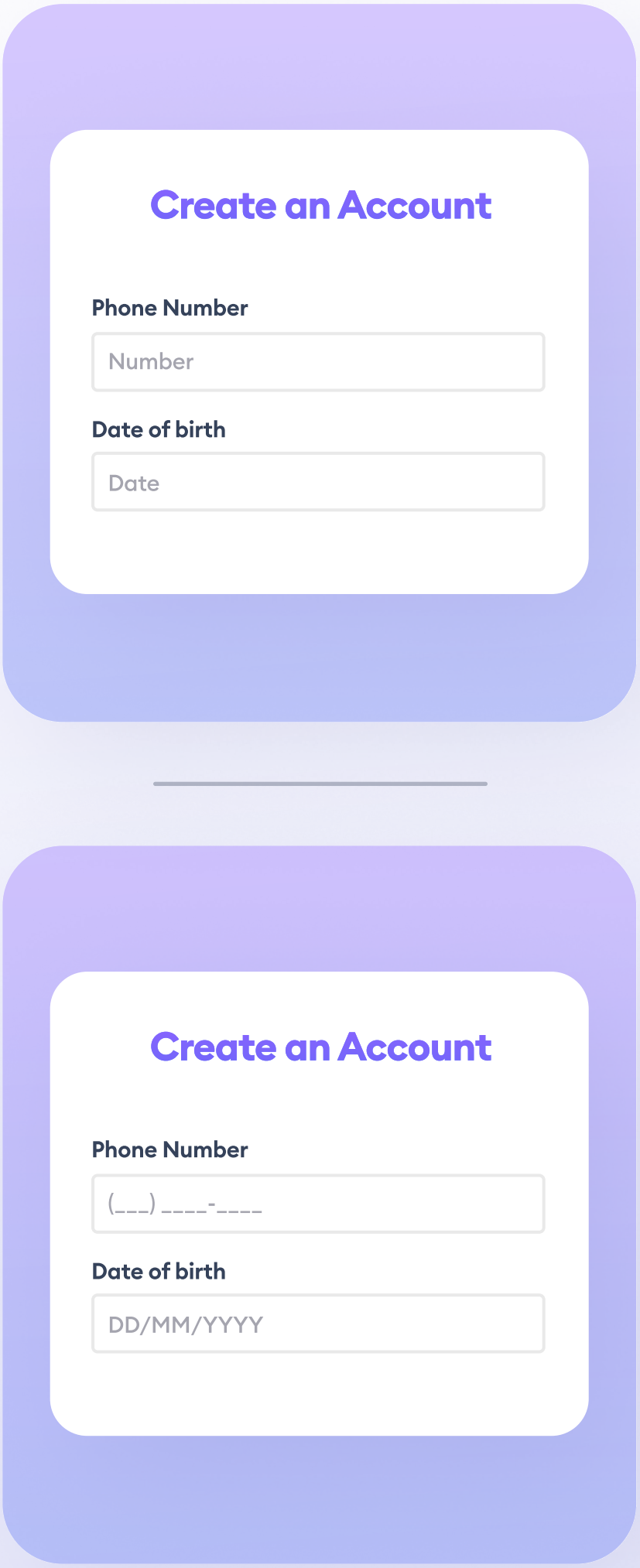
Tip - 37 Serial Positioning Effect



Improper arrangement leads to difficulty in switching the pages.

Users tend to remember the First & Last items in a series. So place the most important pages at the corners.

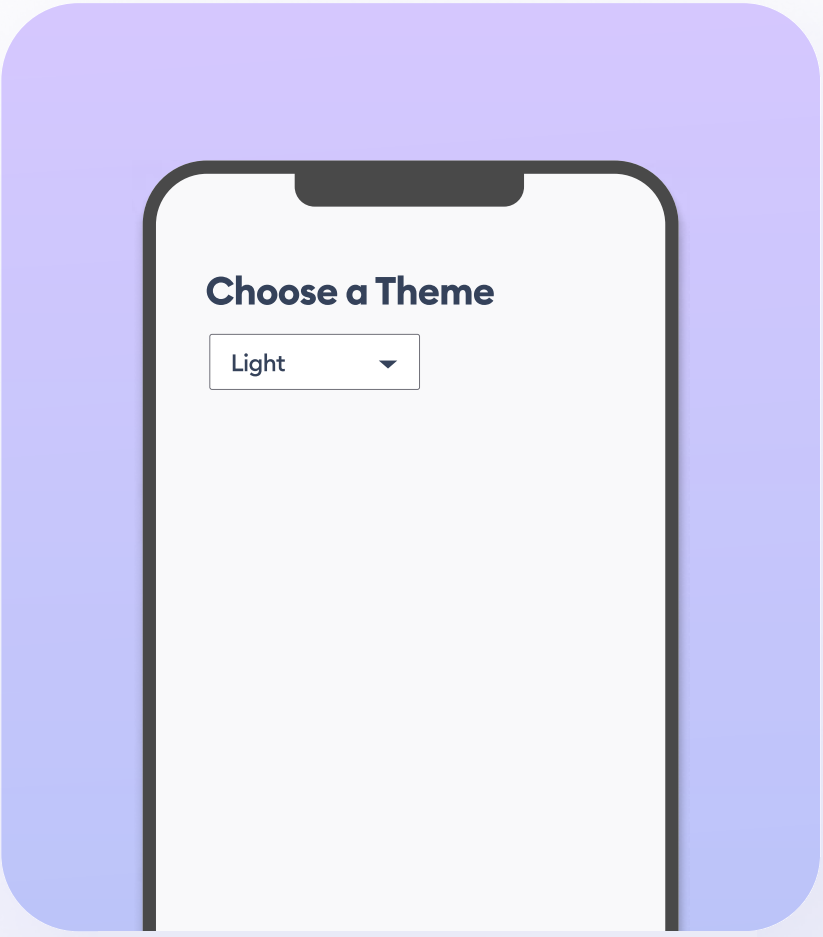
Tip - 38 Use Input Masks



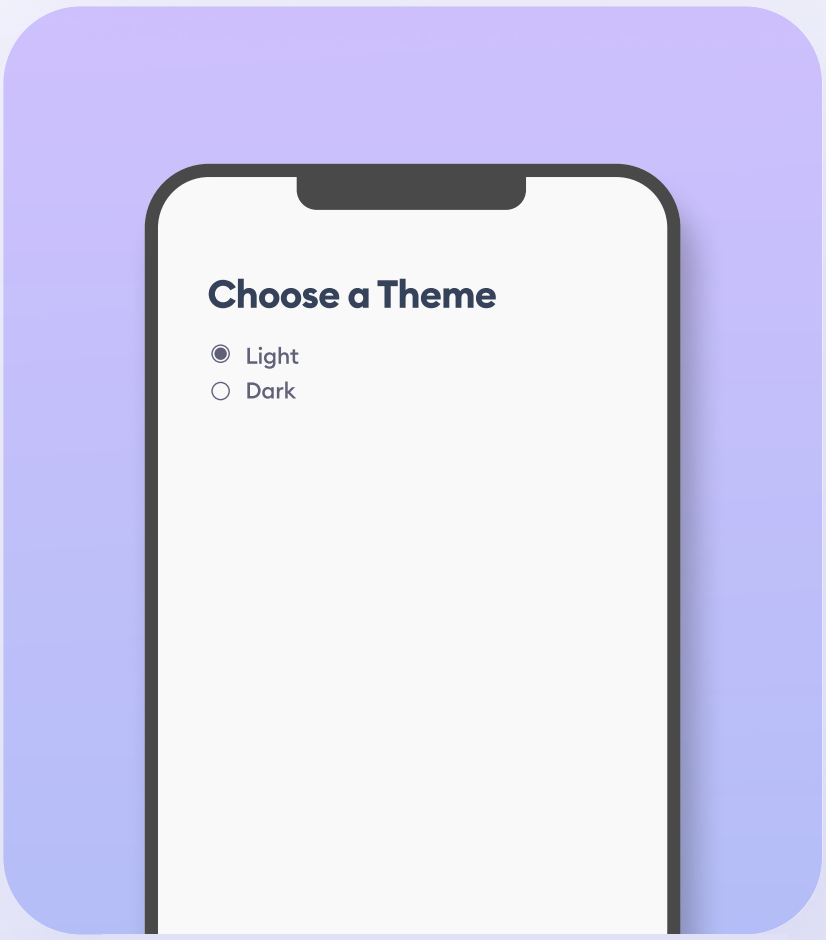
Absence of input mask makes the user unsure about the format.

Provide input masks to avoid any error especially for phone numbers and dates.

Tip - 39 2 to 4 Option Rule

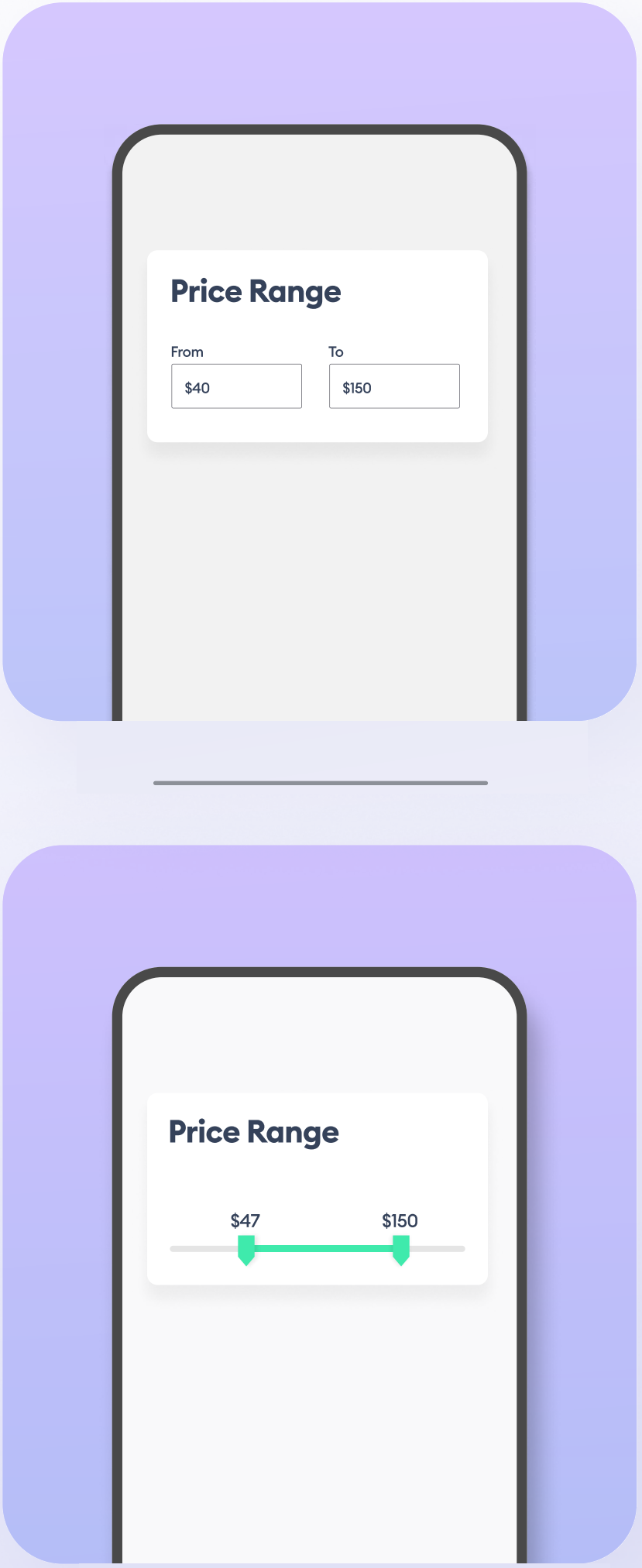


It is not ideal to enter more than 2 or 3 values inside a drop-down list.



Display all options side by side when user has to select from 2 to 4 values.

Tip - 40 Avoid Writing When Possible



Using fields everywhere is not an ideal choice.

Using slider will make the process fast and understandable.

Tip - 41 Spacing is the Key

Travelling

Why Travel the World this year?

If you travel, you will not only learn about foreign cultures..

Less or inconsistent spacing creates difficulty in readability and grouping.

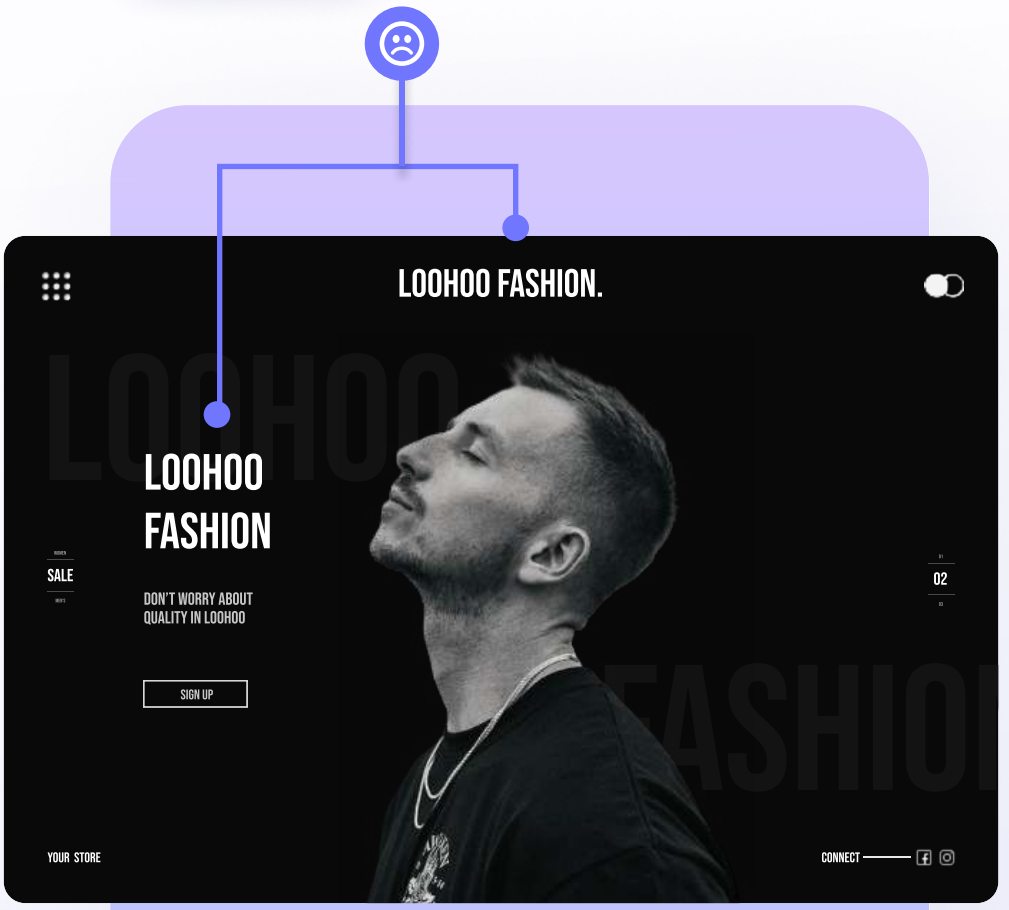
Travelling

Why Travel the World this year?

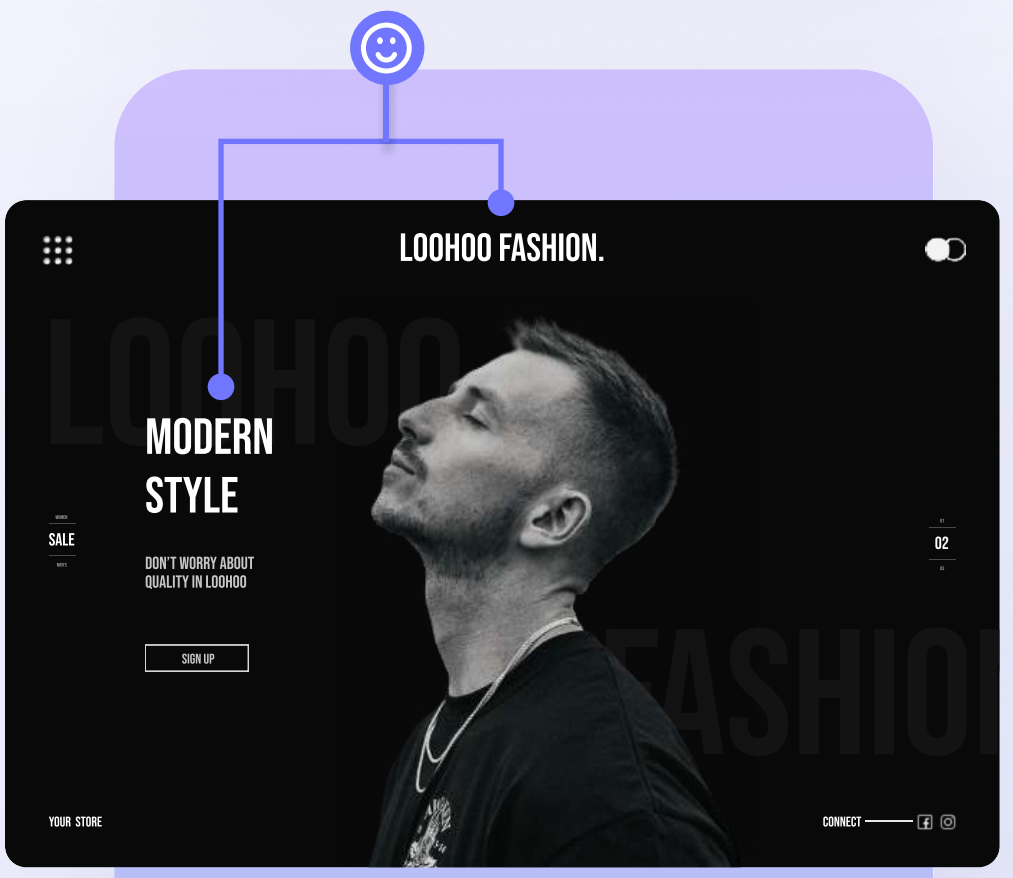
If you travel, you will not only learn about foreign cultures..

Make sure to leave spaces from edges and group relevent elements.

Tip - 42 Logo Repetition

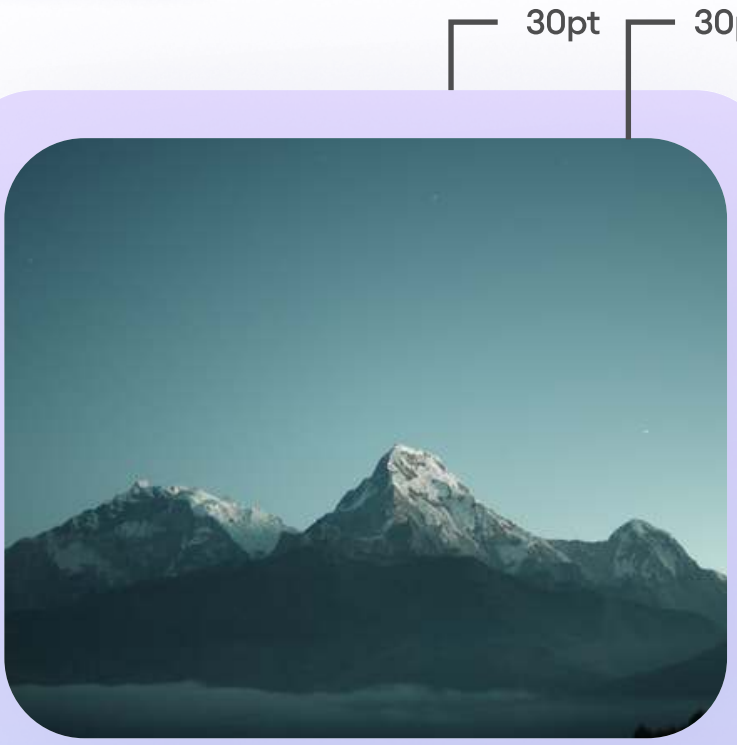


Repetetion of the logo many times in the same page is not ideal.

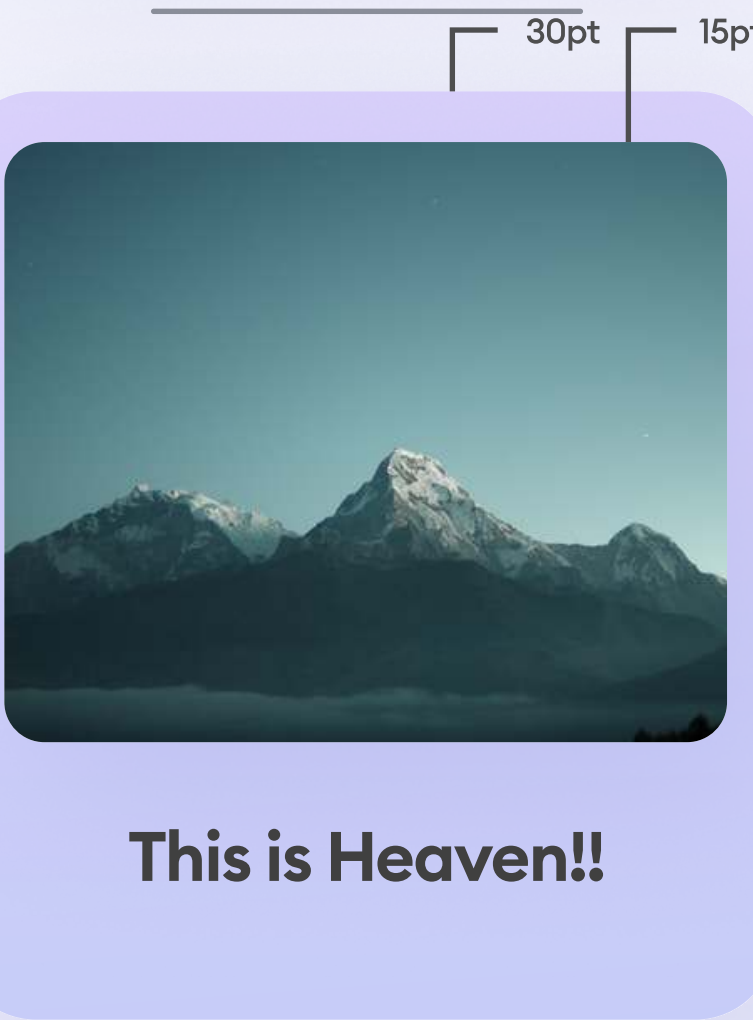


Instead use a headline to convey the style and info about what you do.

Tip - 43 Border Radius



Using same border radius for both outer and inner elements looks uneven.



Don’t round inner element the same amount as of the card. Decrease it slightly for a better look.

Tip - 44 Limit content

Bali

4.0 (98)

Bali is part of the Coral Triangle, the area with the highest biodiversity of marine species, especially fish and turtles. In this area alone, over 500 reef-building coral species can be

Scrolling within a card can create a lot of confusion.

Bali

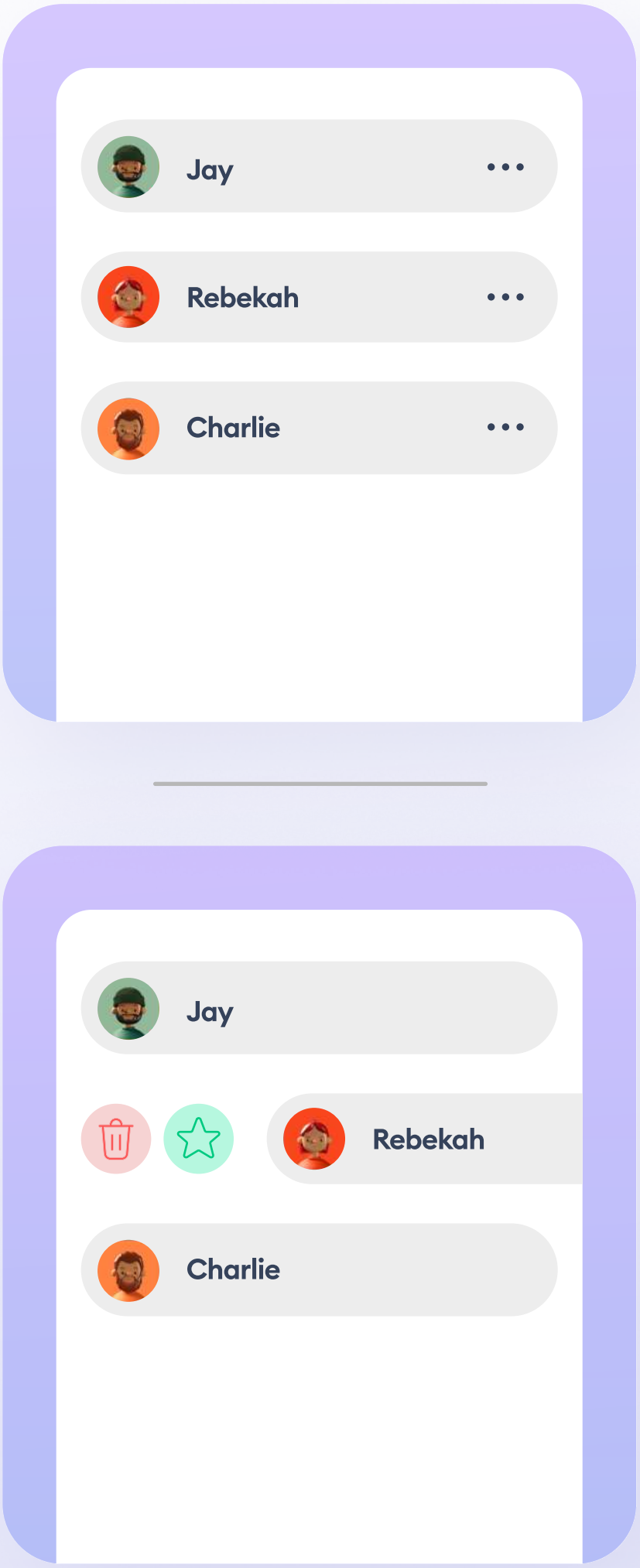
4.0 (98)

Bali is part of the Coral Triangle, the area with the highest...

Explore More

Instead use a ‘See more’ or ‘Explore’ buttons.

Tip - 45 Use Swipe Actions

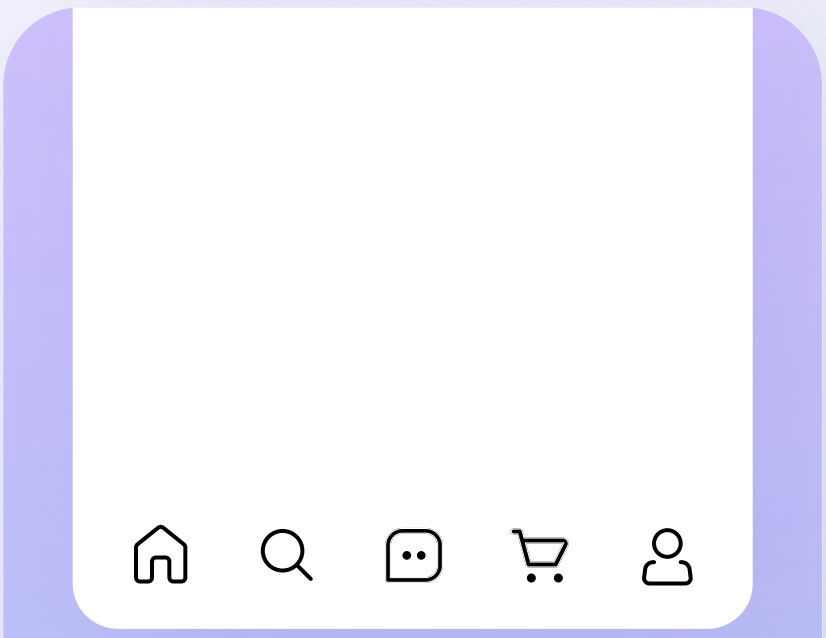


Using option button can slow down the process.

Use swipe actions on certain card to make the process fast and minimal.

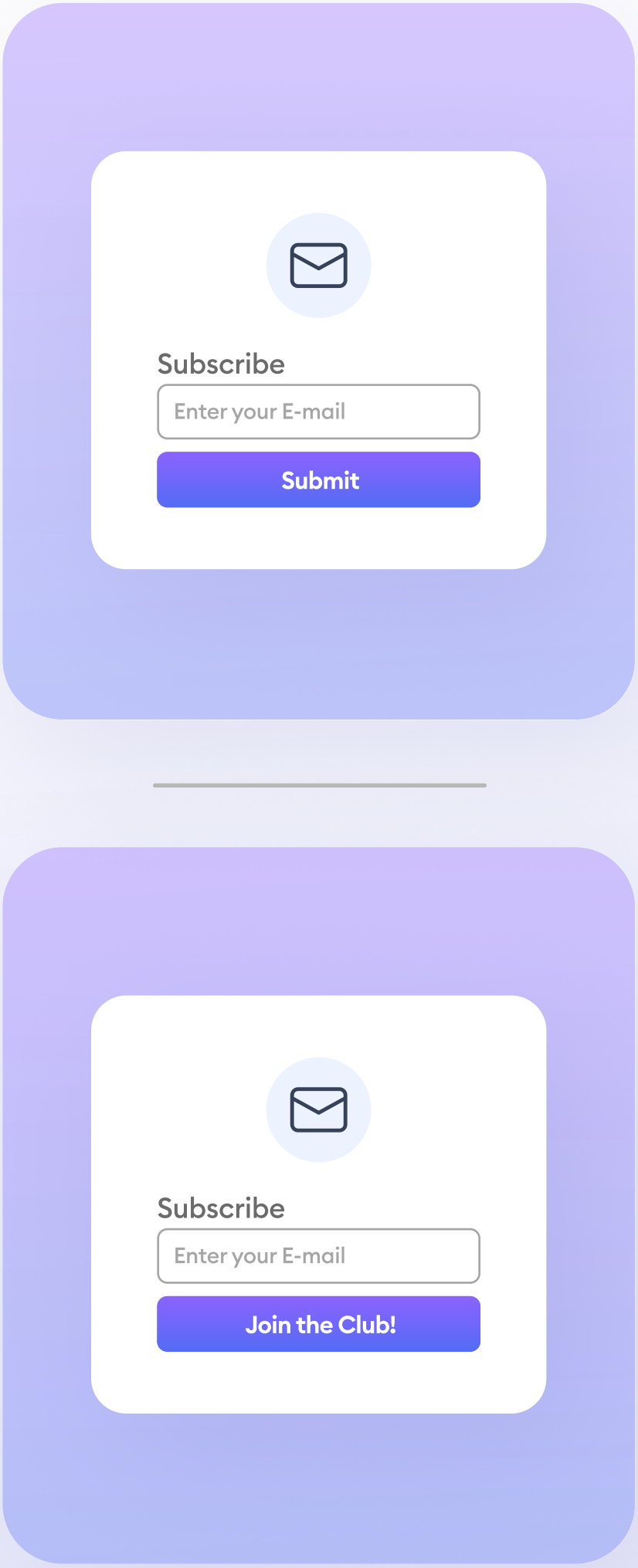
Tip - 46 Icon Selection

Using fancy icons makes your design look unprofessional.



Use simple flat icons for more professional look.

Tip - 47 Using Right Words

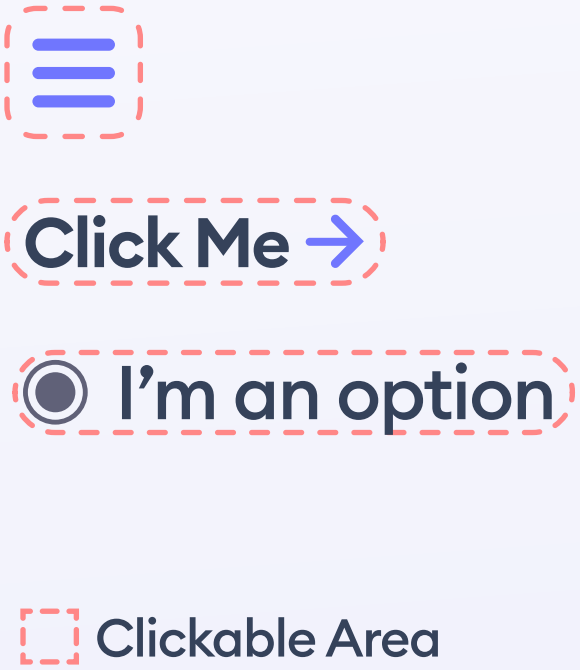


Wrong words will make people less interested about your program.

Use words that make users to be excited to join in.

Tip - 48 Enhancing Clickable Area

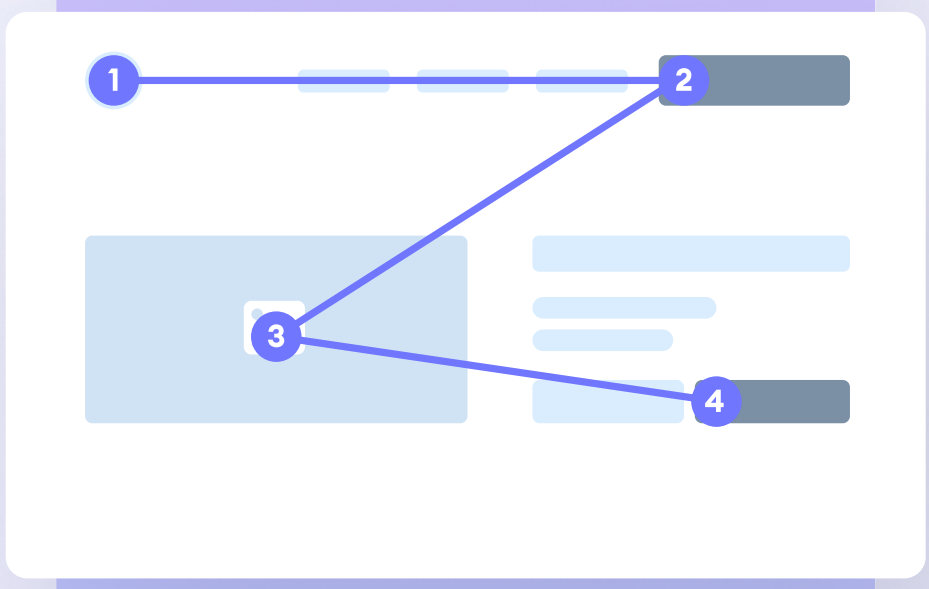
Having small clickable area creates difficulty for the user to click on buttons or elements.



Enhance the clickable area of the elements to make it easy to click.

Tip - 49 The Gutenberg Priciple

The Gutenberg Principle states that user's eyes travel to a Z-shaped path from the top-left area to the bottom-right area.



It's a good practice to place your CTA at the end of this flow to lead users to take action.

Tip - 50 Prompt User to Scroll

If you have too much spacing between the sections user will less likely scroll to the down.

A simple hack to prompt users to scroll is by showing them a glimpse of the next section.

Tip - 51 Padding on Buttons

Stay Updated

Join our community & be the first to hear about our upcoming Products and news.

Join Newsletter

x

Buttons with small paddings don’t look good.

Stay Updated

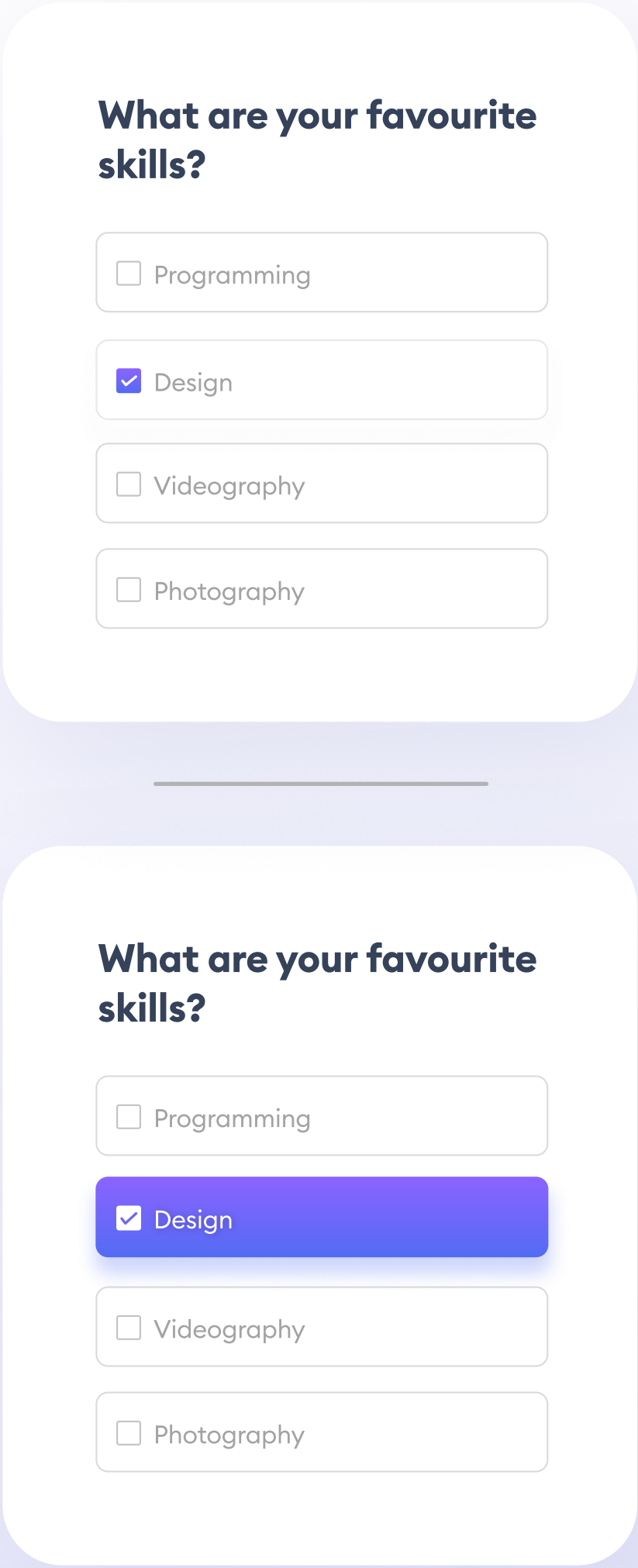
Join our community & be the first to hear about our upcoming Products and news.

2x Join Newsletter 2x

x

Double the value of the side paddings from the value of top and bottom paddings.

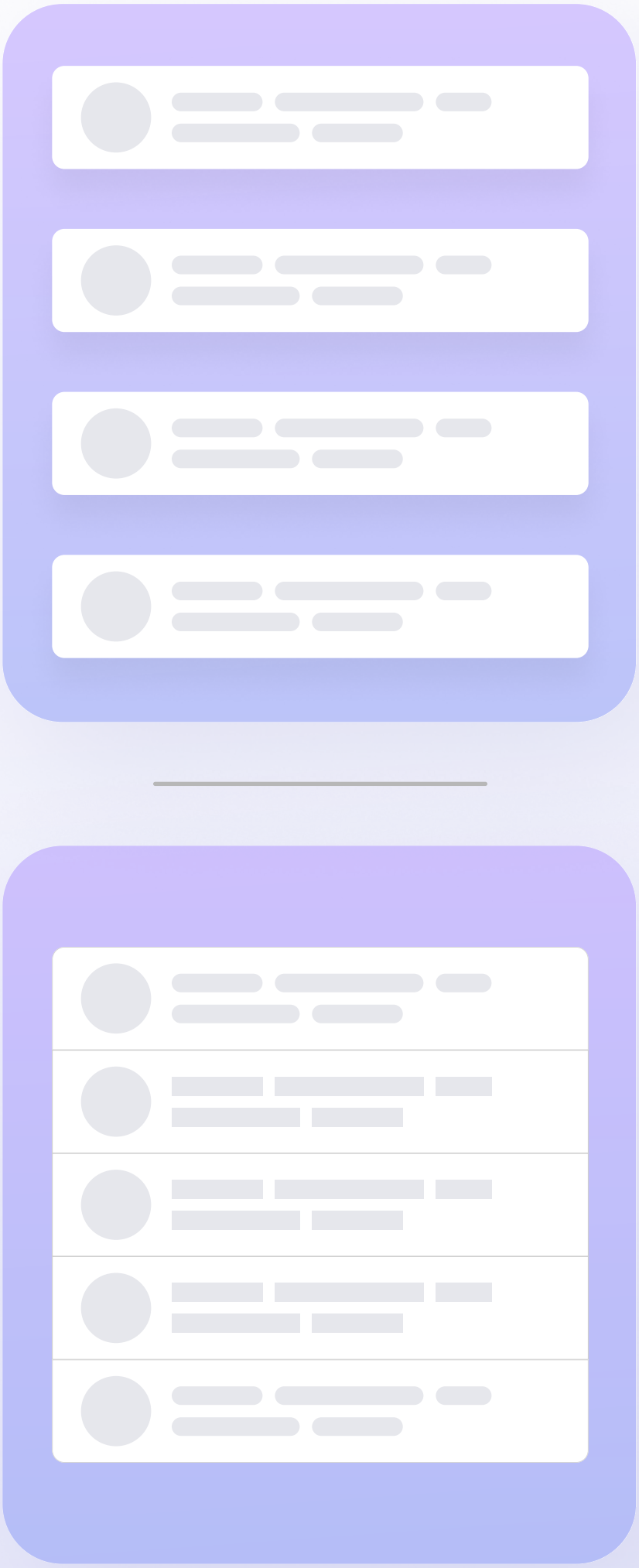
Tip - 52 Make Selected Items Pop



It becomes difficult for users to know that something happened once selected.

To grab their attention, make those selected items stand out.

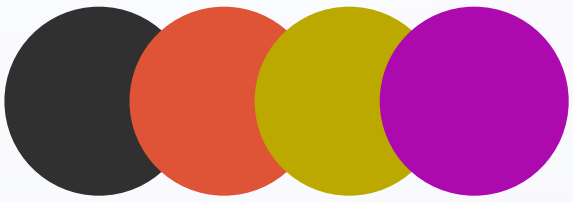
Tip - 53 Know when to use list



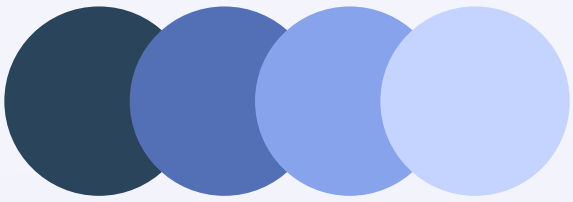
Cards do not give the sense of similarity between the homogeneous elements.

To promote speedier scanning, use a **list instead of a card** for homogeneous content.

Tip - 54 Avoid using bad color schemes

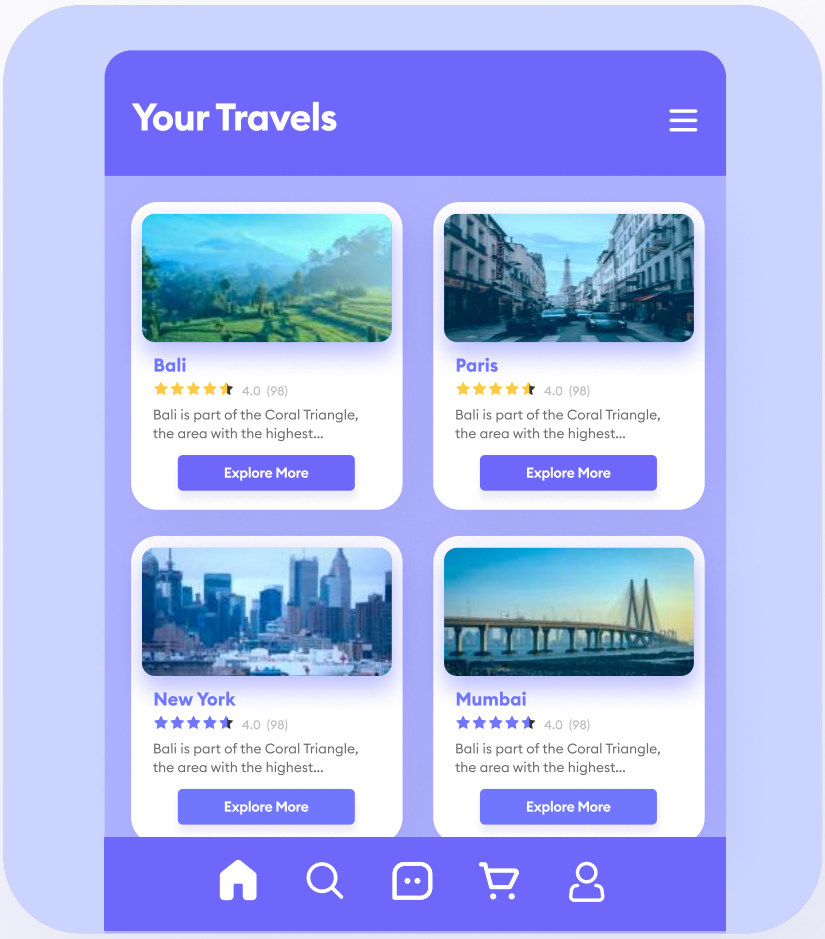


A colour scheme with too many inconsistencies looks terrible.

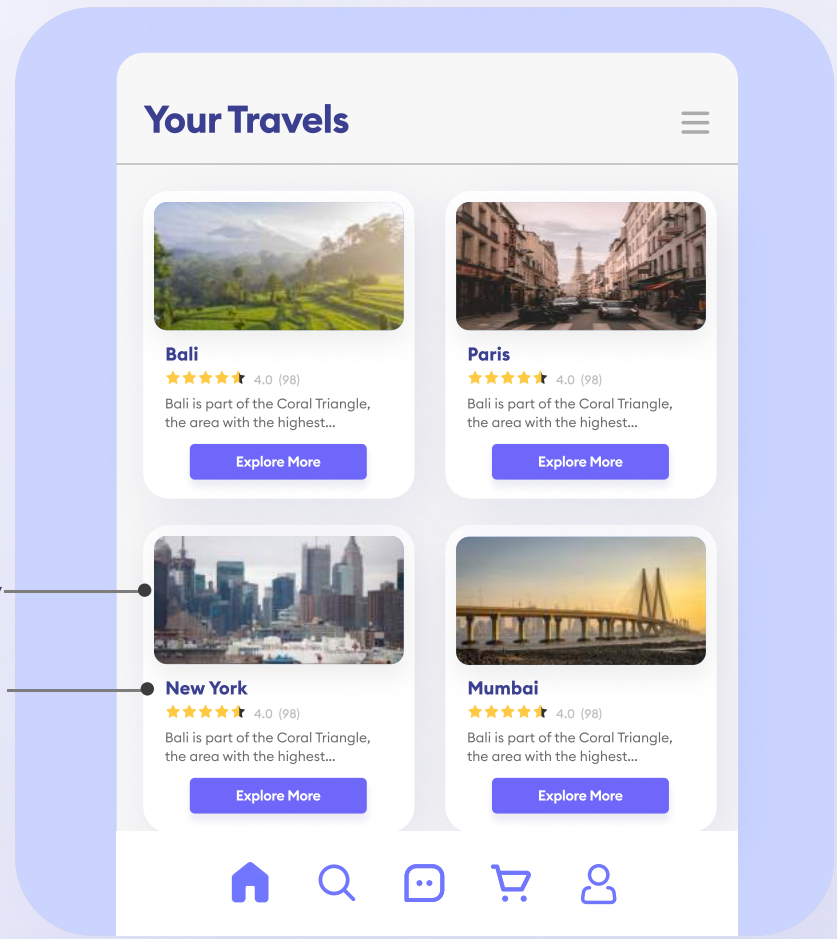


Avoid using too many inconsistent color for a single color scheme.

Tip - 55 Brand Color Usage

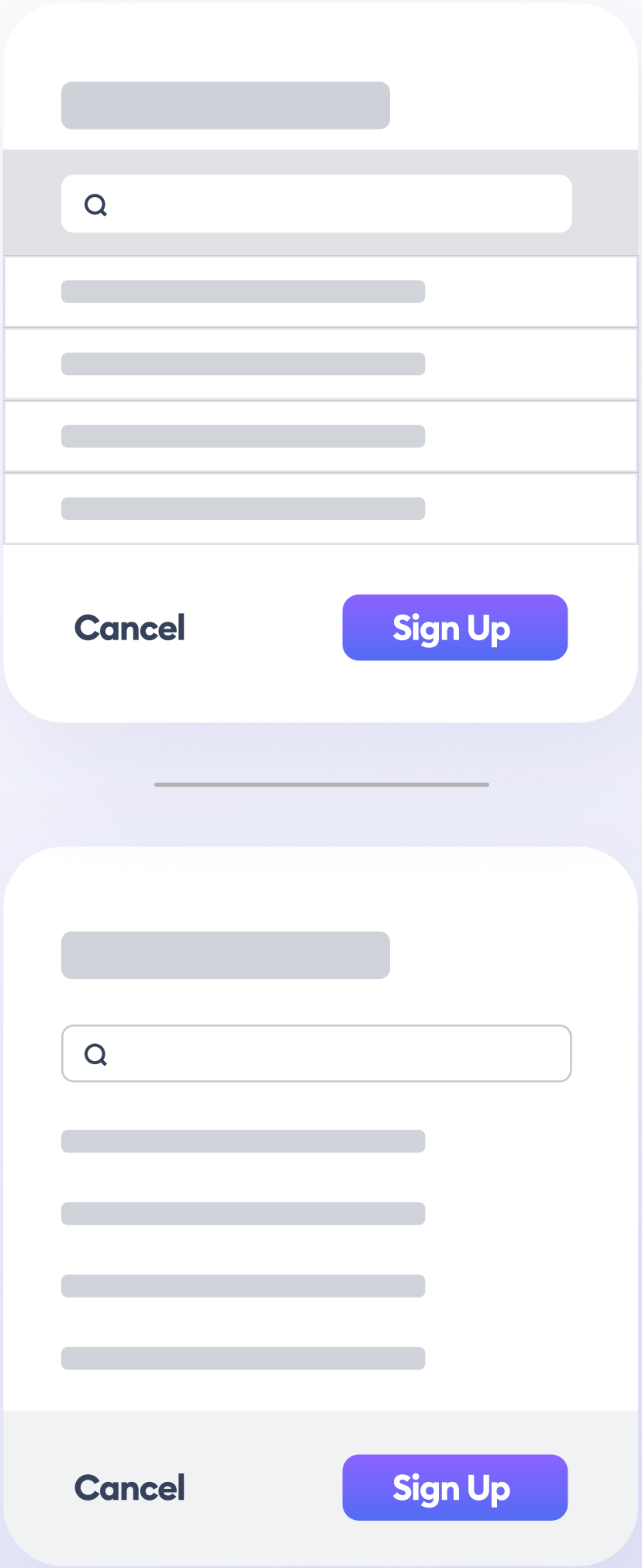


Too much primary colour does not look nice.



Using your primary colour to showcase just the most crucial components of your UI.

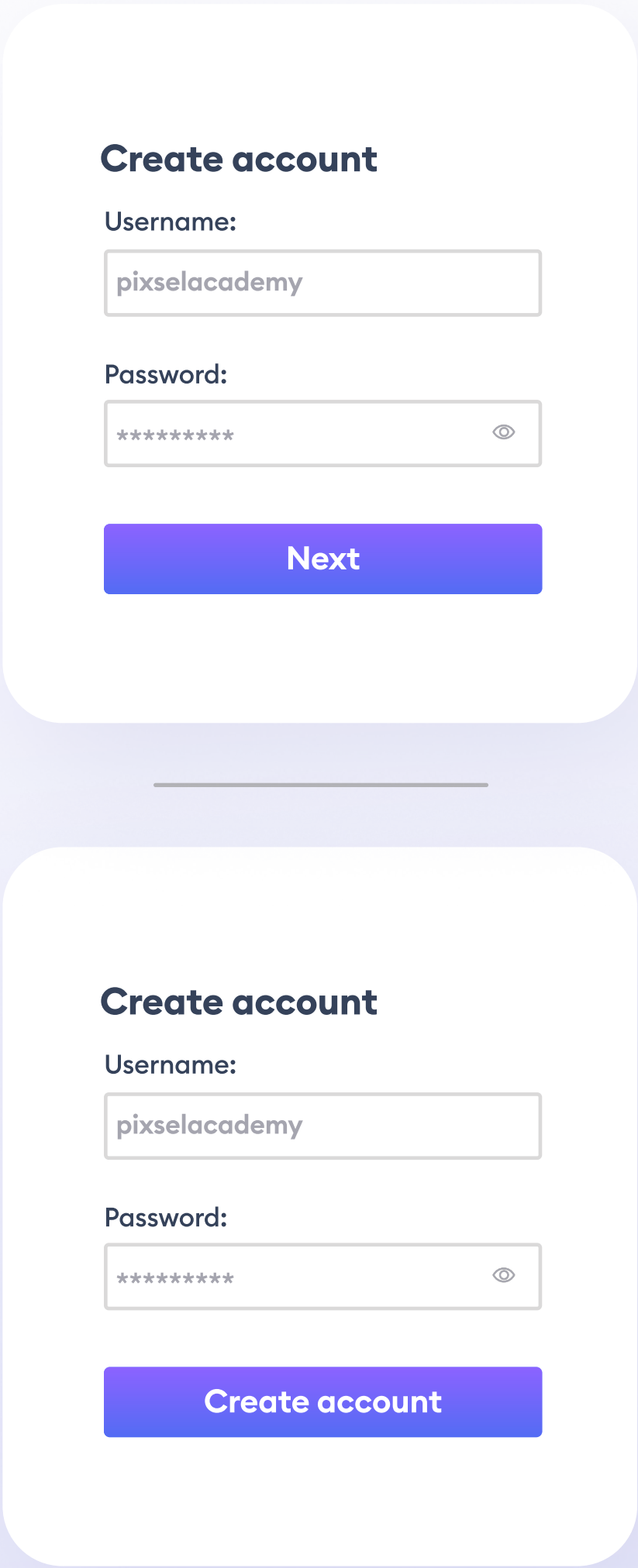
Tip - 56 Borders



A design with too many borders can complicate the user's experience and make it appear awful.

Therefore, avoid using too many borders in your website.

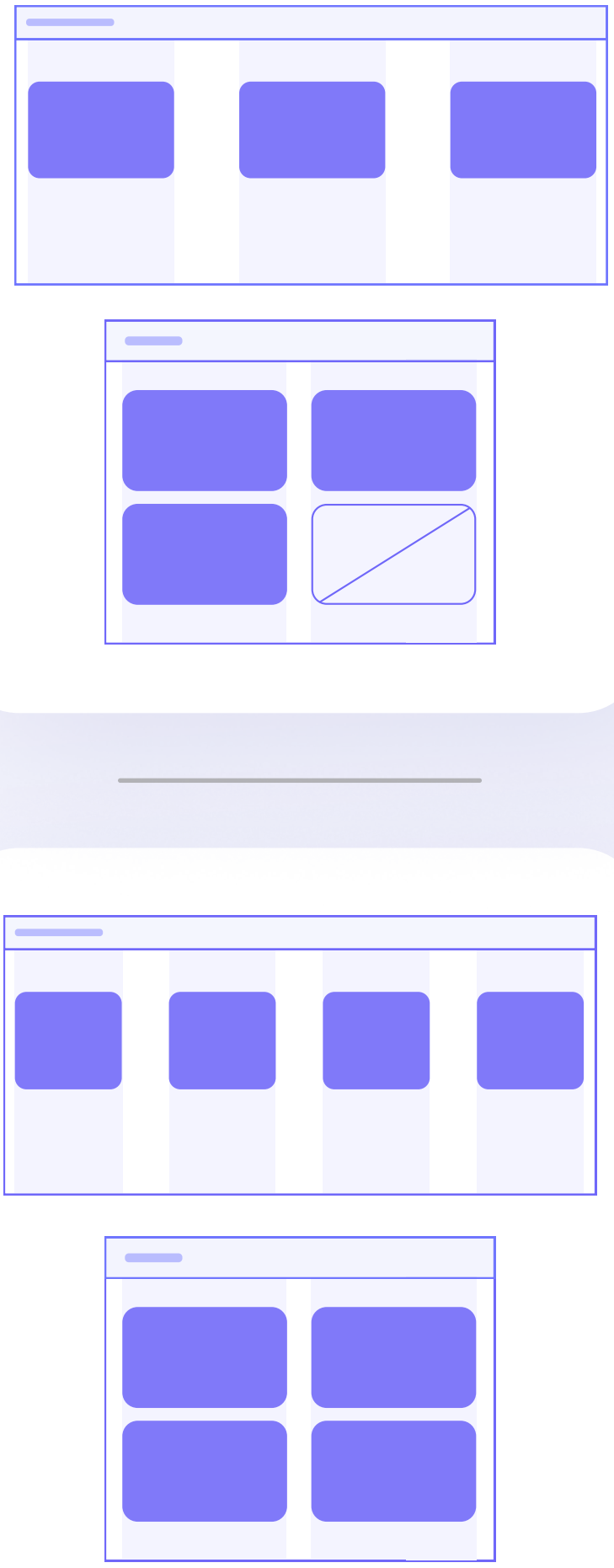
Tip - 57 Button Statement



Avoid using vague actions like OK or Next.

Your button needs to clearly state what's going to happen.

Tip - 58 Make Design Responsive



Irresponsive website design has a negative impact on user experience.

Use a grid and test your grid design in different screen sizes.

Tip - 59 Fewer fields are preferred.

First Name

Last Name

Email

Adress:

Every additional field in your form lowers your conversion rate and causes you to lose leads.

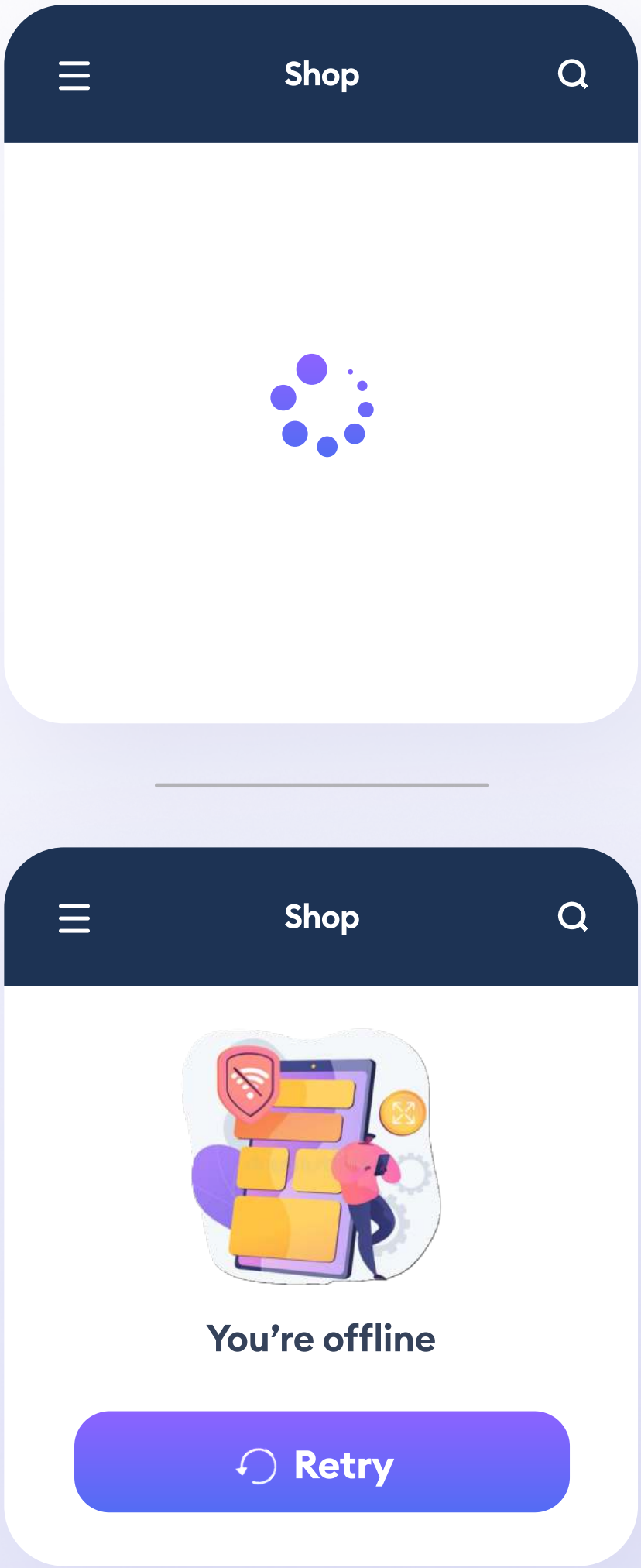
Name

Email

Adress:

Try to keep form as short and clear as possible.

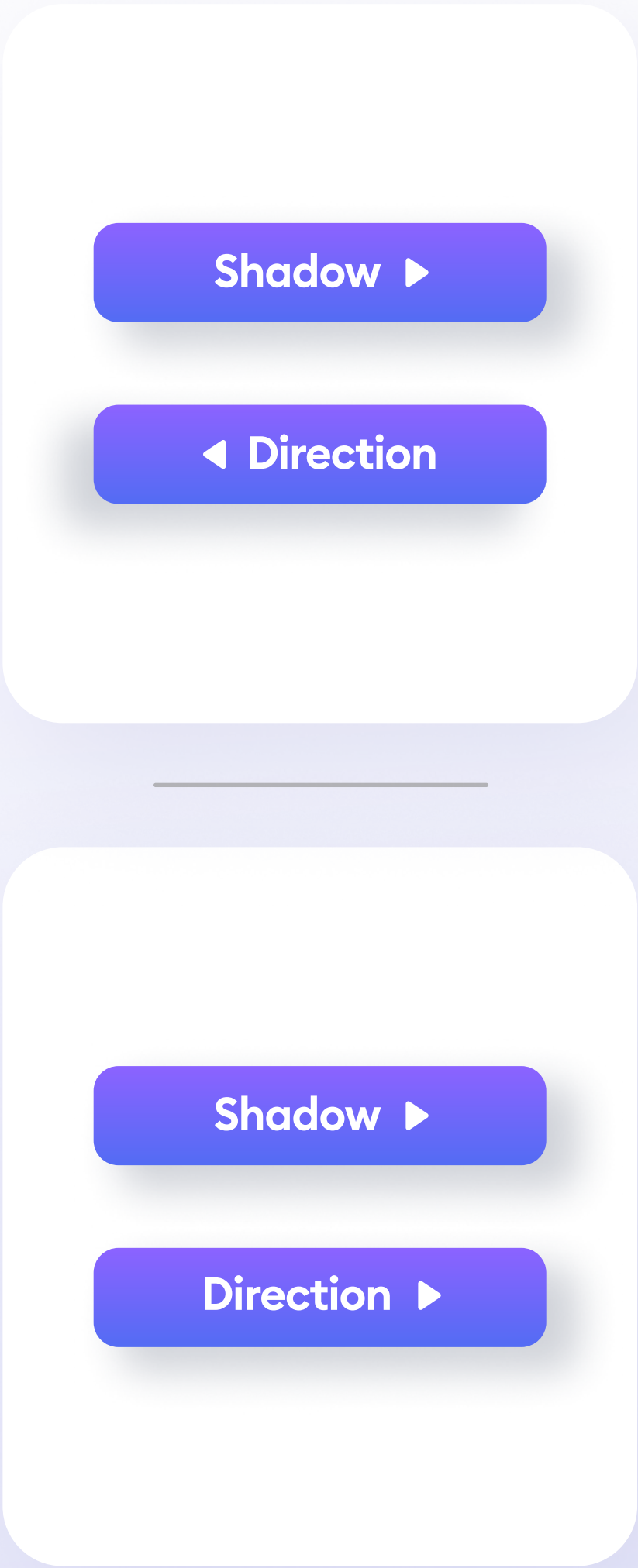
Tip - 60 Error Indication



This type of error indication looks incomplete and less interesting.

Clearly indicate an error and suggest a solution.

Tip - 61 Shadow Directions



Random shadow directions look odd and compliacte the user's experience.

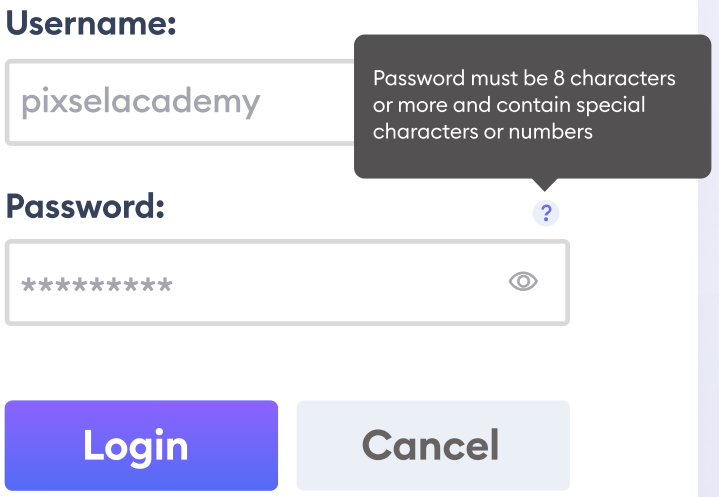
Make sure that your shadows always come from single light source.

Tip - 62 Skeleton loading Vs Loading Circle

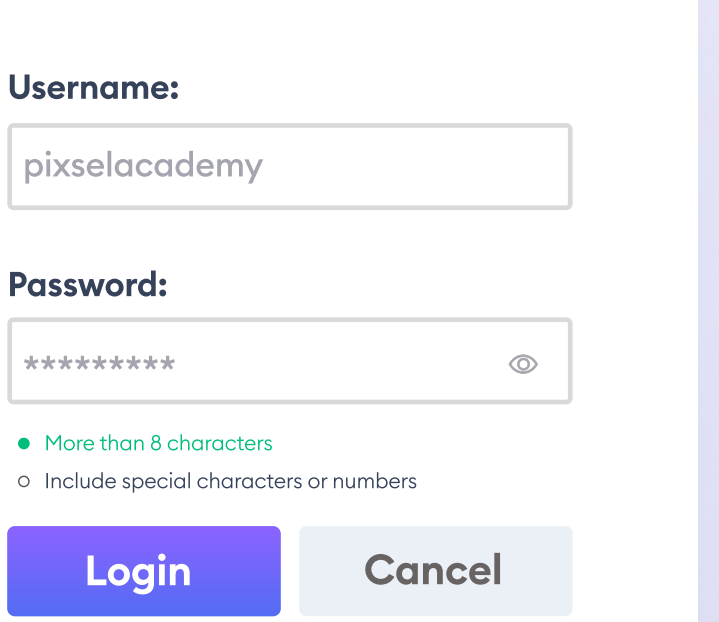
Loading Spinners make loading appear slower and give users no idea what to expect on screen.

Use Skeleton loading as it is percieved as **faster** than standard loadings.

Tip - 63 Keep Important information visible



Important information should not be hidden under a tooltip.



Make the important guideline visible for users to immediately understand what is required.

Tip - 64 Use Boxes in Forms

Name

Email

Address:

It takes a while for underline fields to be understood as a form.

Name

Email

Address:

Instead, make use of rectangles with visible borders.

Tip - 65 Make Elements look clickable

Why Travel the World this year?

If you travel, you will not only learn about foreign cultures, but about your own as well.

Read more

Here it creates difficulty for users to identify the clickable elements.

Why Travel the World this year?

If you travel, you will not only learn about foreign cultures, but about your own as well.

Read more

Add color or a button to indicate its clickability.

Tip - 66 Keep Illustration Consistent

Inconsistent illustration fails to define the brand's style and look.

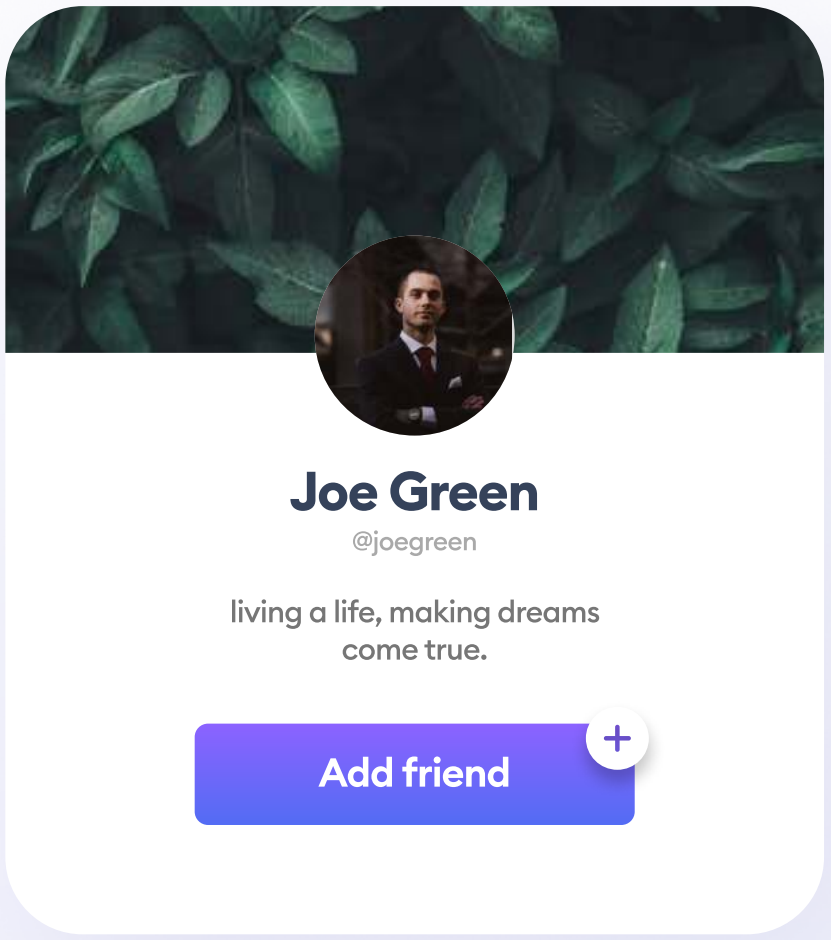
Keep your illustrations consistent, as these become part of your brand.

Tip - 67 Consistent Gaps

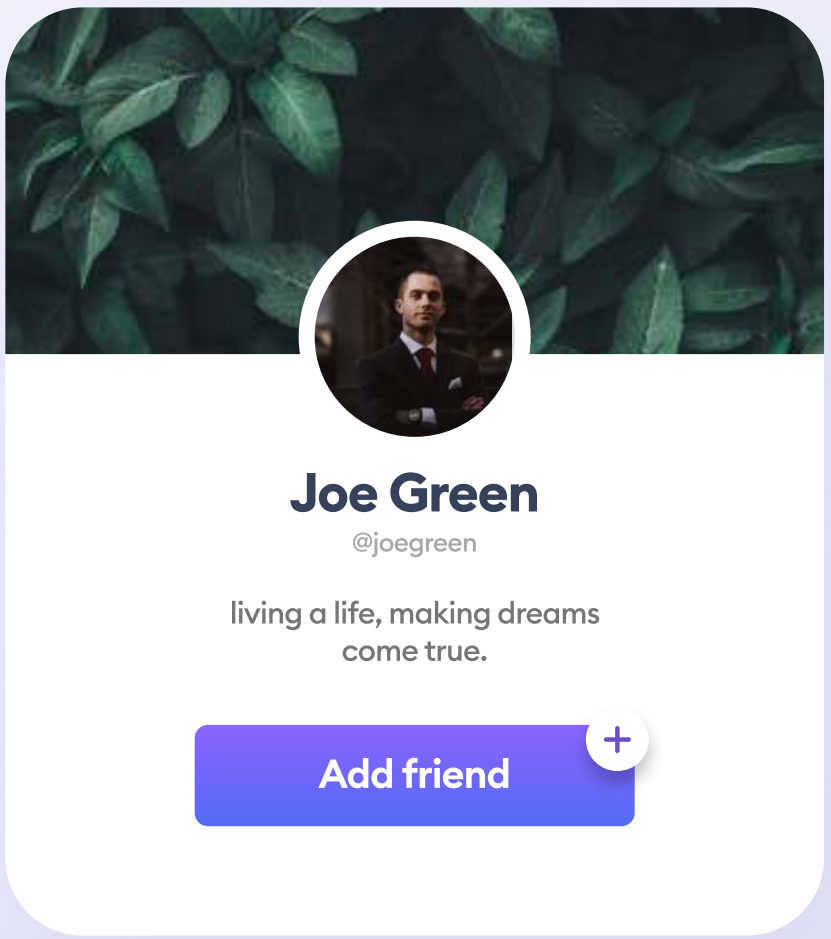
Keeping uneven gaps gives a bad user experience.

Instead, use consistent gaps to enhance the quality of your grid.

Tip - 68 Add a stroke on avatars

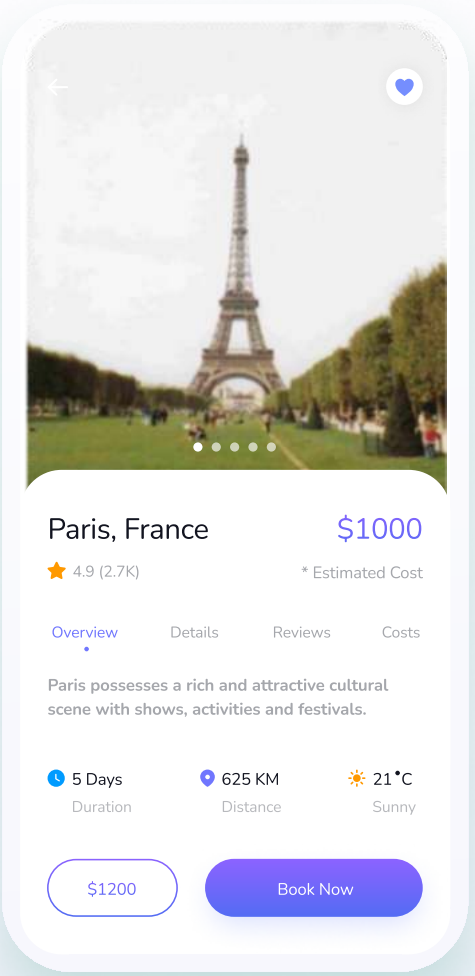


Avatars without stroke kinda blend with the background.

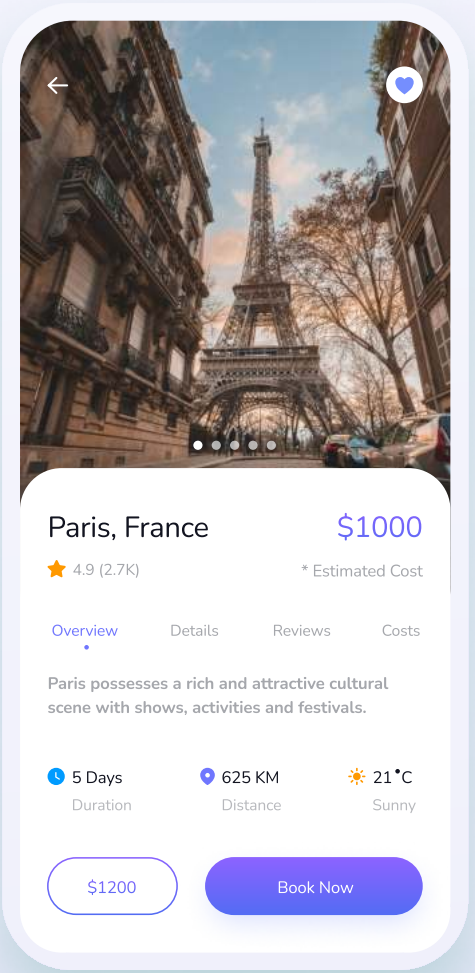


Stroke avatars to make them more appealing and distinguishable from the backdrop.

Tip - 69 Image Resolution



Blurry or distorted image doesn't look appealing.



Use high-resolution images to place text over them and maintain legibility.

Tip - 70 Perspective views?

Icon with perspective views looks complicated.

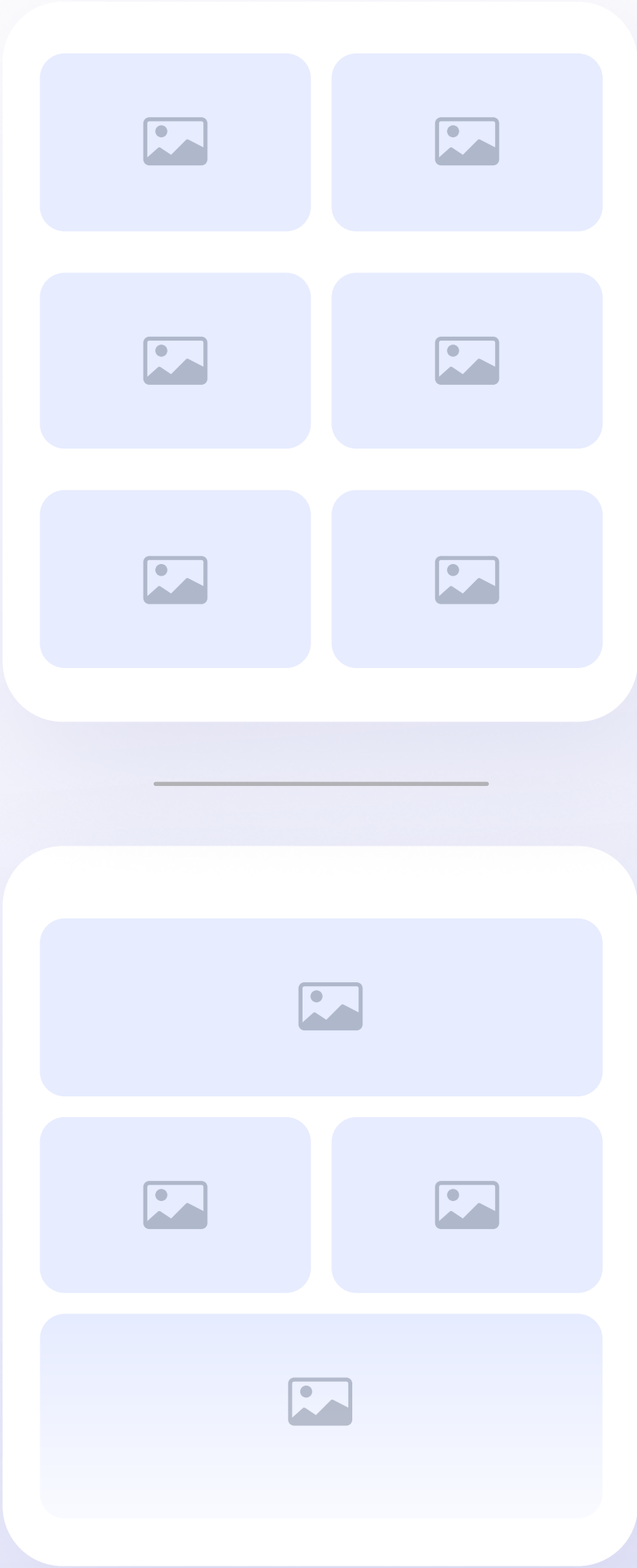
Make icons front facing for better experience.

Tip - 71 Be Consistent with weight

Inconsistent icon's stroke weight is not a good practice.

Pay attention to using the same stroke weight through an icon set.

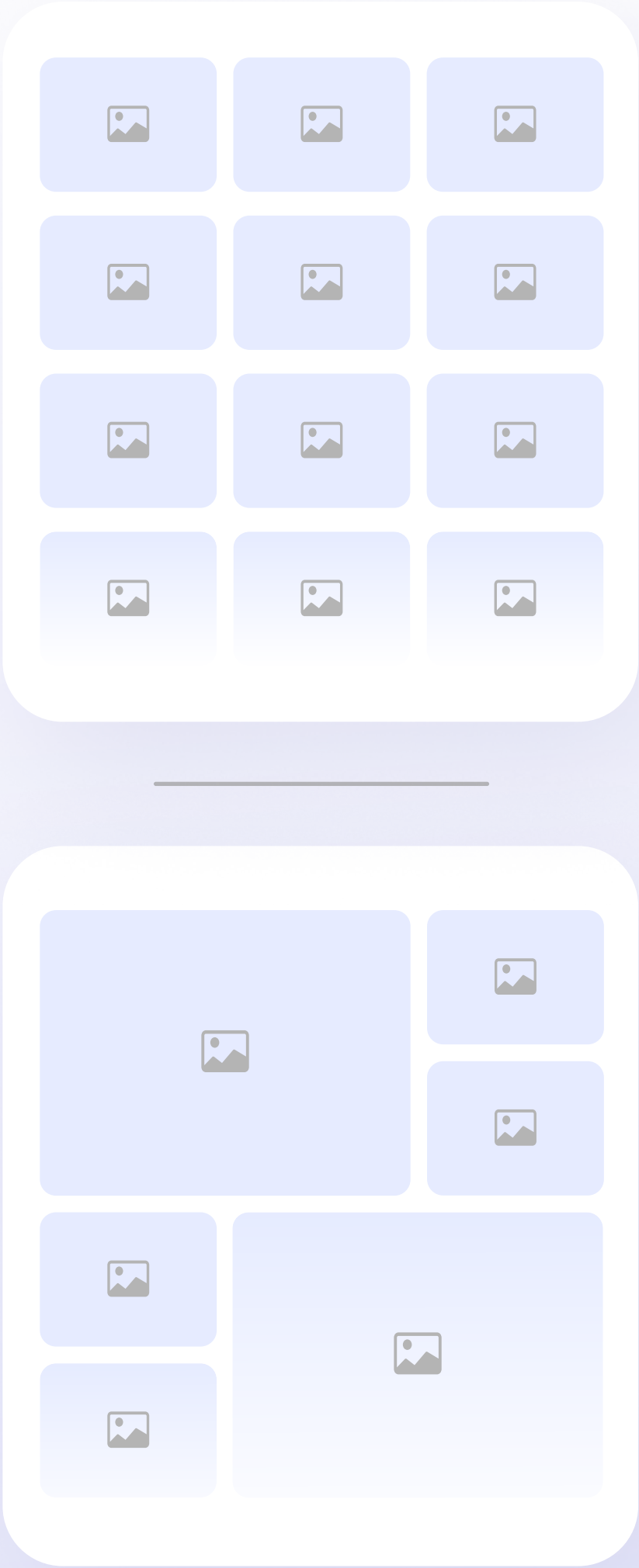
Tip - 72 Make Images Stand Out



It become hard for users to recognize the lead images.

With multiple images on a screen, make some to lead the pack.

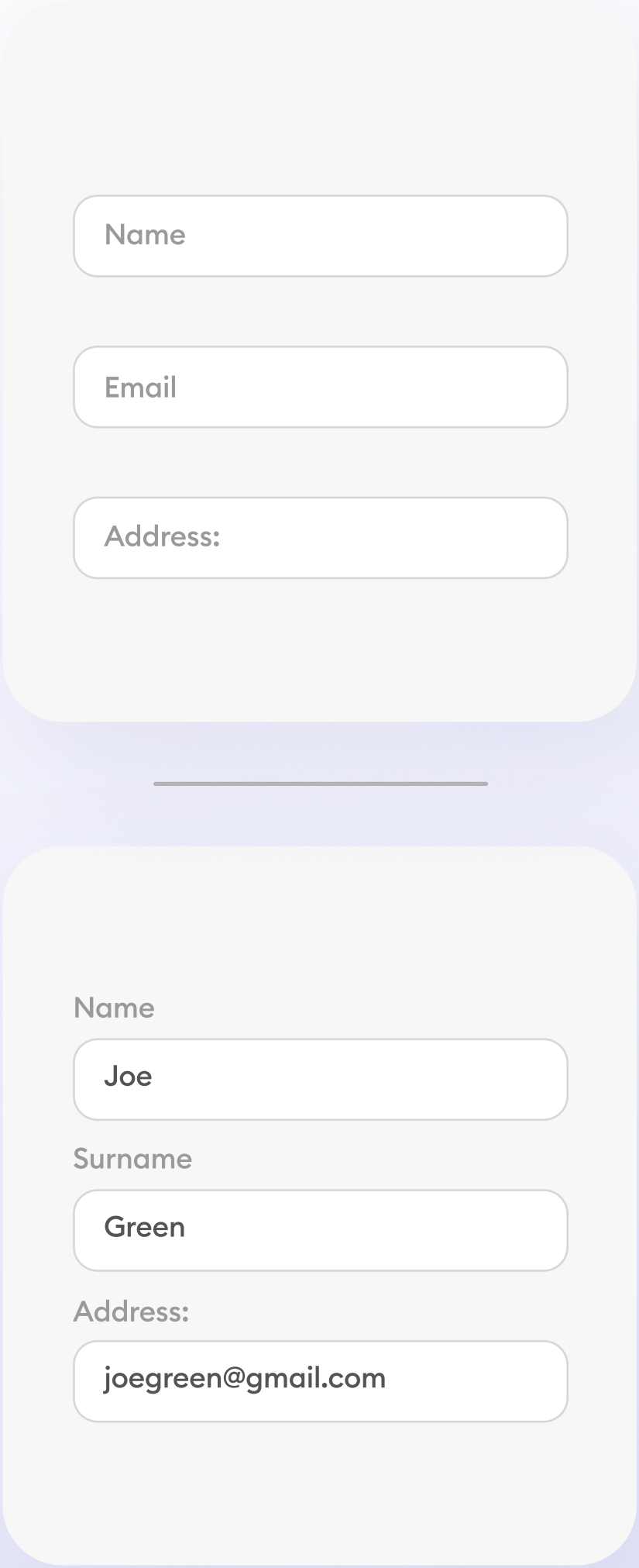
Tip - 73 Add Dynamic to the Layout



It detracts from the appeal of the images on the website.

Employ multiple columns and image sizes to make scrolling more fun and dynamic.

Tip - 74 Placeholder text



Using placeholder text as label can cause many usability issues.

Instead, resist using placeholder text as labels.

Tip - 75 Color - based distinction

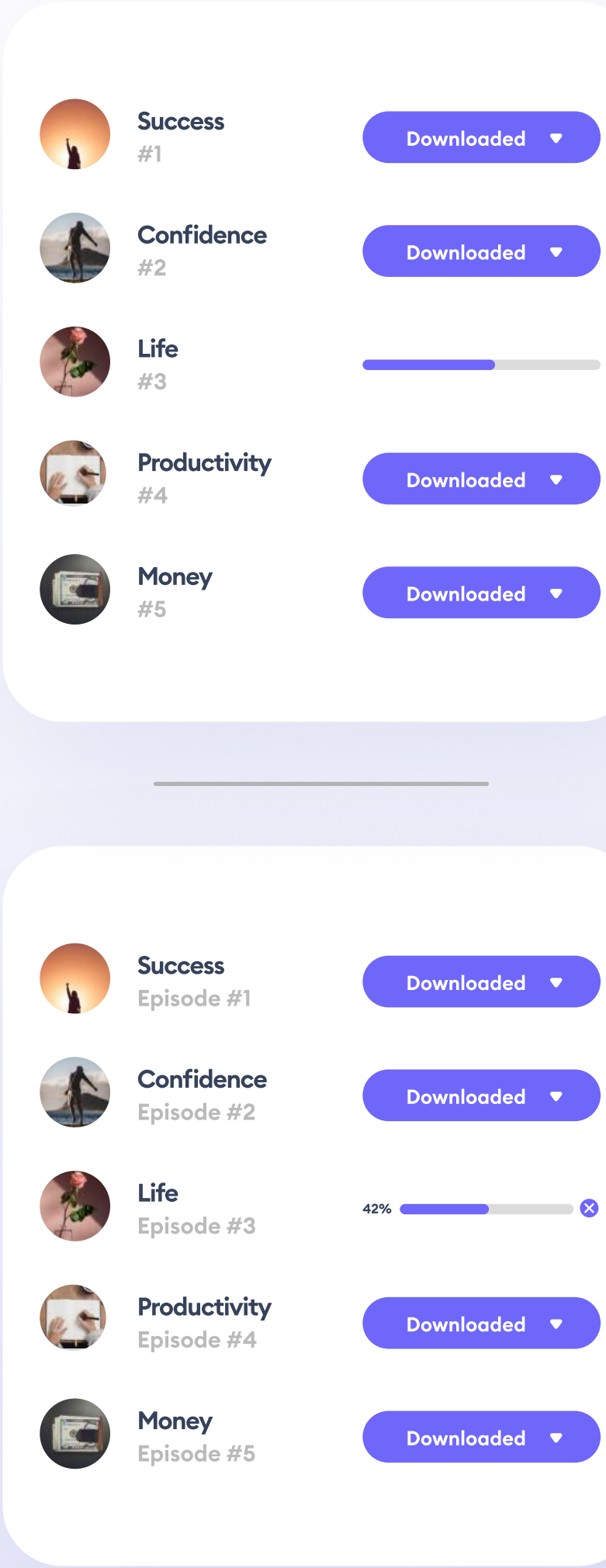
Joe Green Senior Analyst Shortlisted	Experience 5 Years	
Joe Green Senior Analyst Rejected	Experience 3 Years	
Joe Green Senior Analyst In - process	Experience 6 Years	
Joe Green Senior Analyst Rejected	Experience 1.5 Years	

Here, It fails to create visual distinction between elements.

Joe Green Senior Analyst SHORTLISTED	Experience 5 Years	
Joe Green Senior Analyst REJECTED	Experience 3 Years	
Joe Green Senior Analyst IN - PROCESS	Experience 6 Years	
Joe Green Senior Analyst REJECTED	Experience 1.5 Years	

Add color-based distinction to highlight significant classifications and quick visual scanning.

Tip - 76 Avoid the ‘super - minimal’ look



Here, It fails to provide proper details about the element.

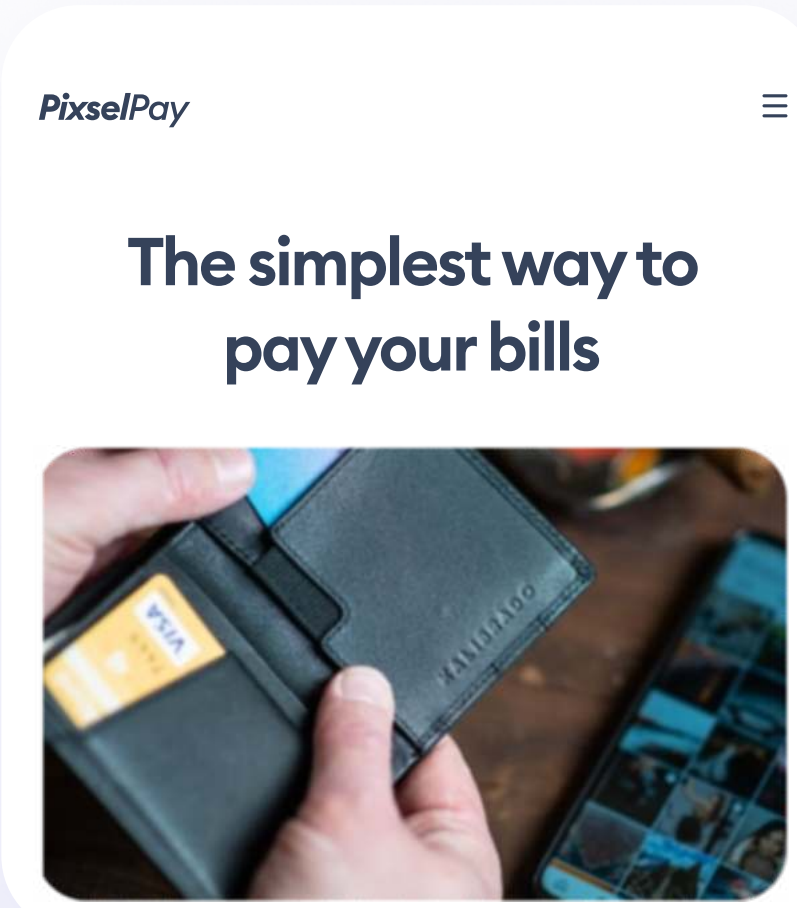
Add some details to the elements to make user know much about the process.

Tip - 77 Power of Dark - Side

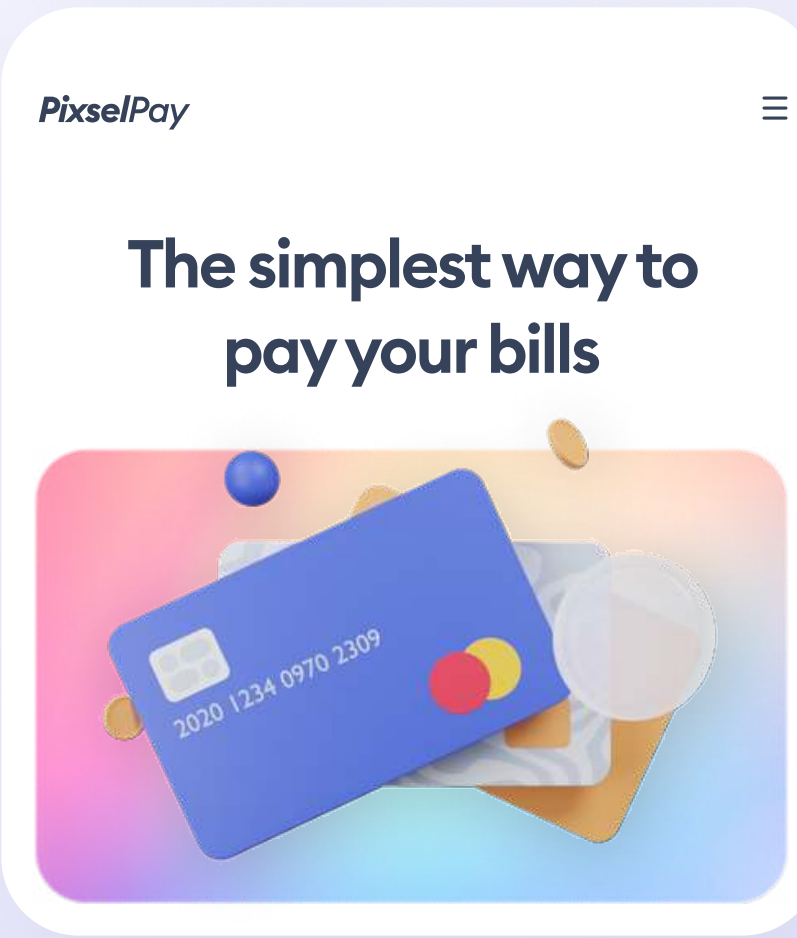
Using just shadows for the separation of layers does not help much for dark themes.

Use shades of Grey to communicate an element's elevation when working on Dark themes.

Tip - 78 Use Supportive Images

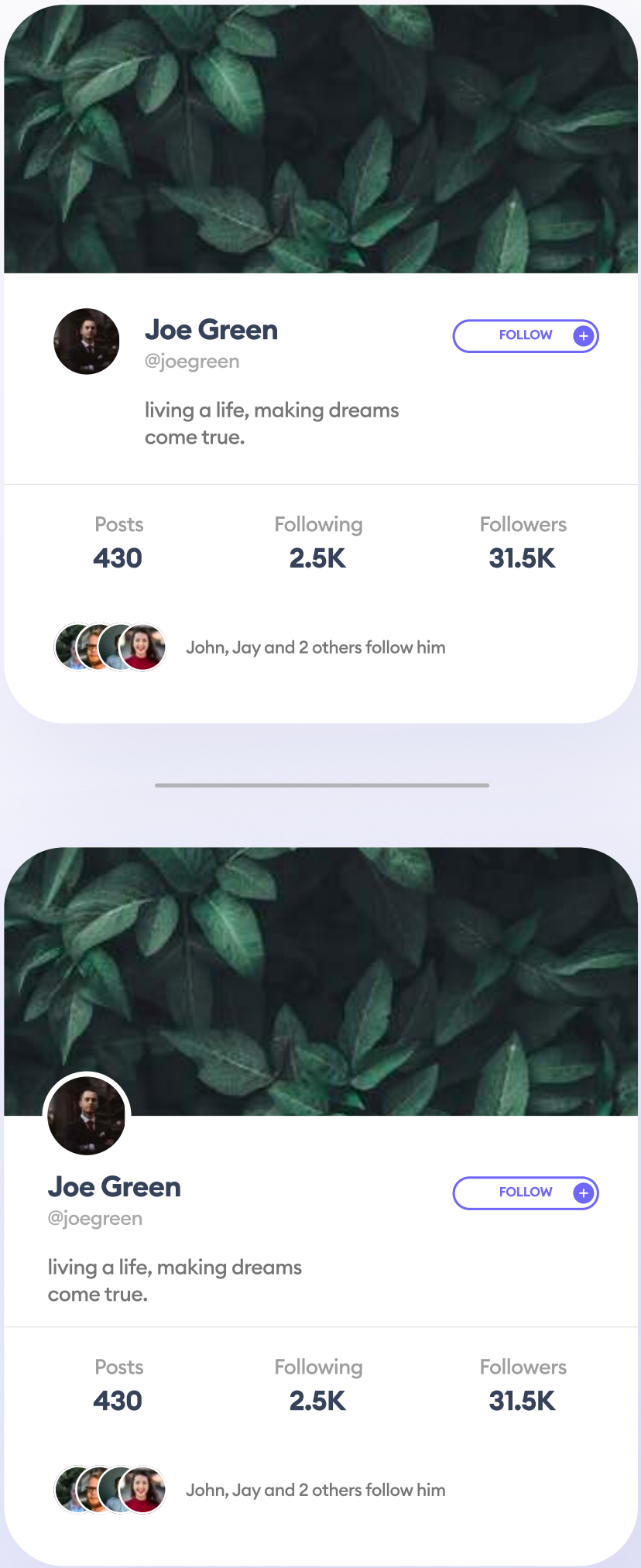


irrelevant images fails to support the story and meaning.



Use Images that support what you are telling and add meaning.

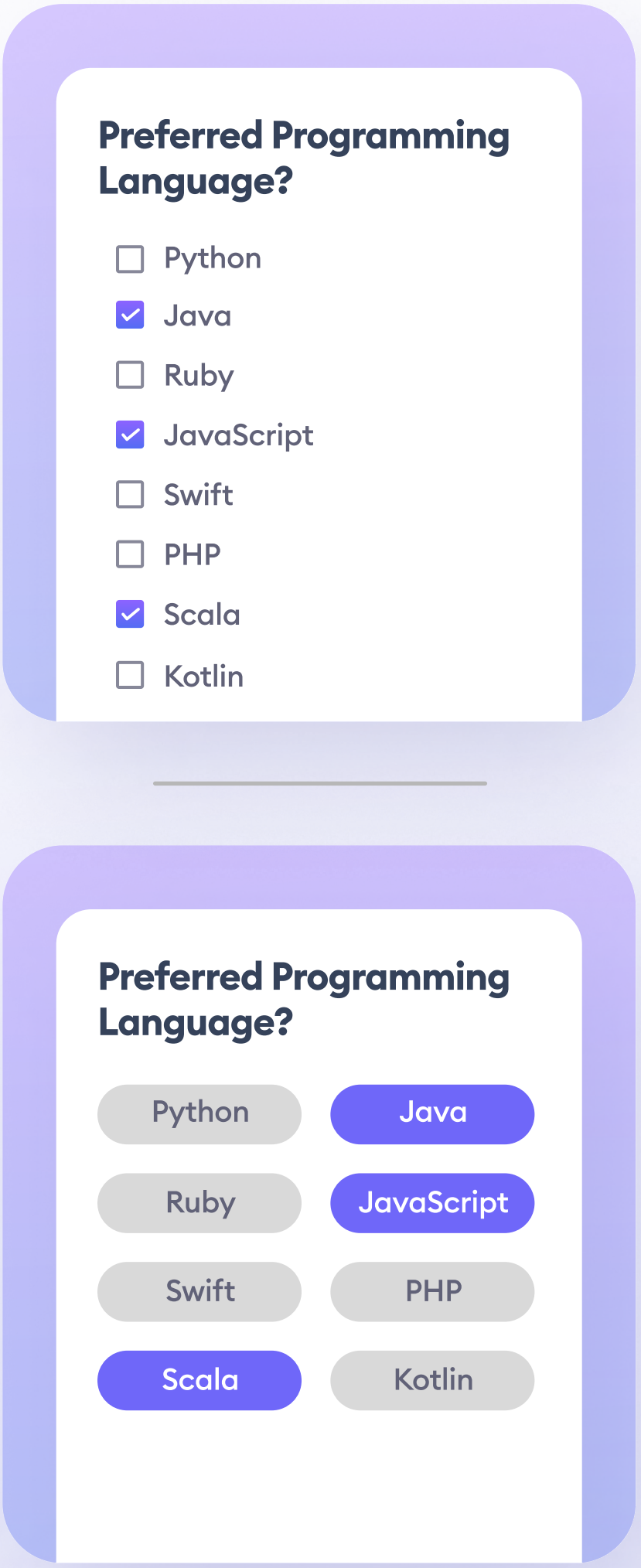
Tip - 79 Overlapping Elements



Keeping elements separate gives a basic look.

Add overlapping elements to create depth and clarity in design.

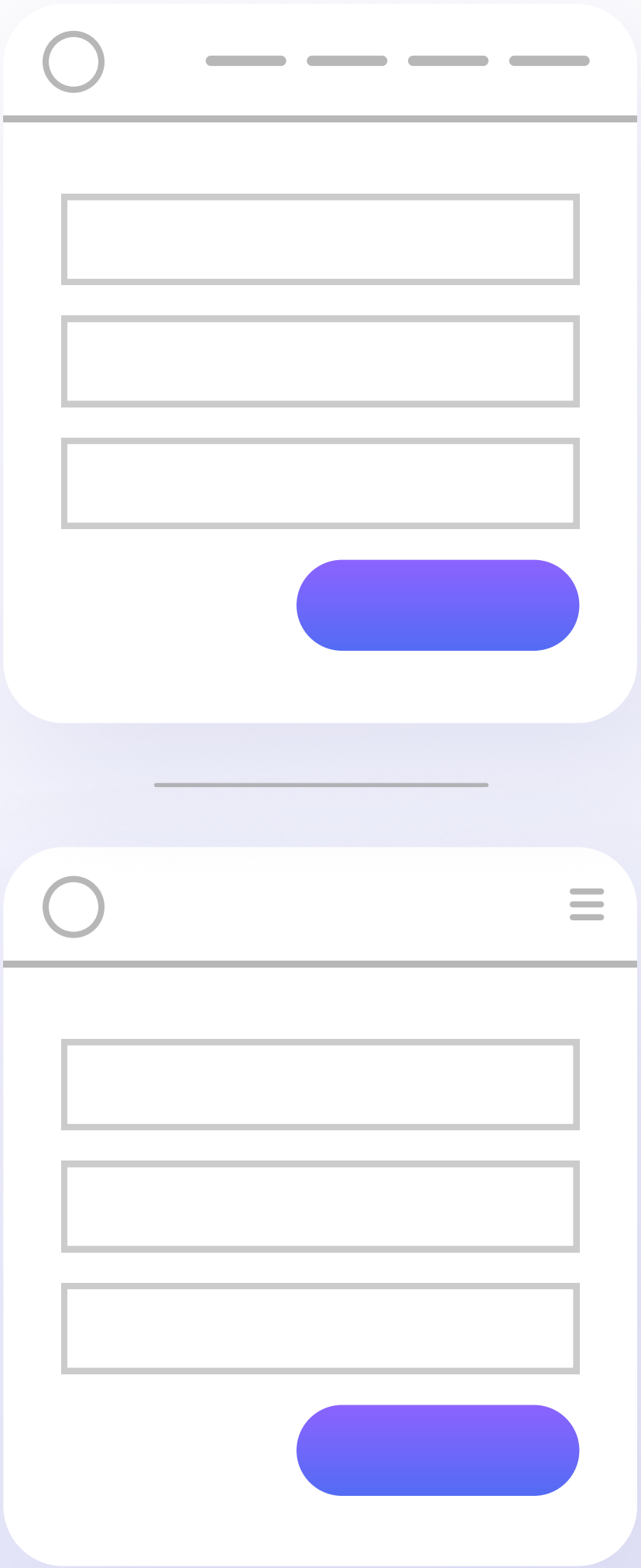
Tip - 80 Checklist VS Toggle Tokens



Long list of check box can cause users to abandon your form.

Use Toggle Tokens for selecting option from a large list.

Tip - 81 Visible Vs Hamburger Navigation



Visible Navigation decreases conversion rate.

Use Hamburger Menu to increase conversion rate.

Tip - 82 Text Wrapping on button

Name

Contact

Email

Submit Your Form

Text wrapping on a button is not a good practice.

Name

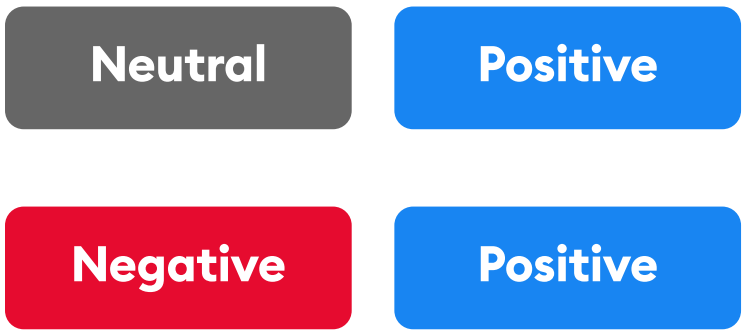
Contact

Email

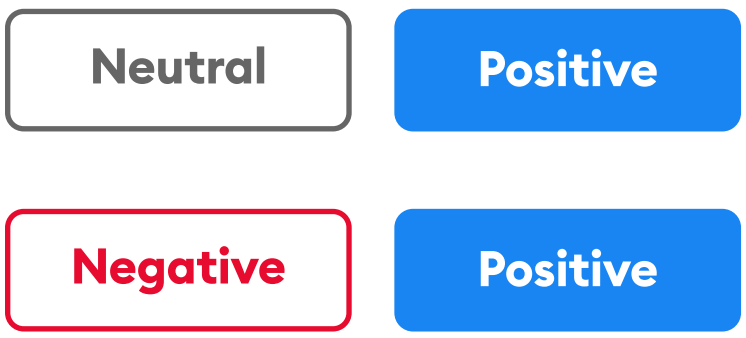
Submit Form

Don’t wrap text on buttons, Button label should be shown on a single line.

Tip - 83 Button’s Color Contrast

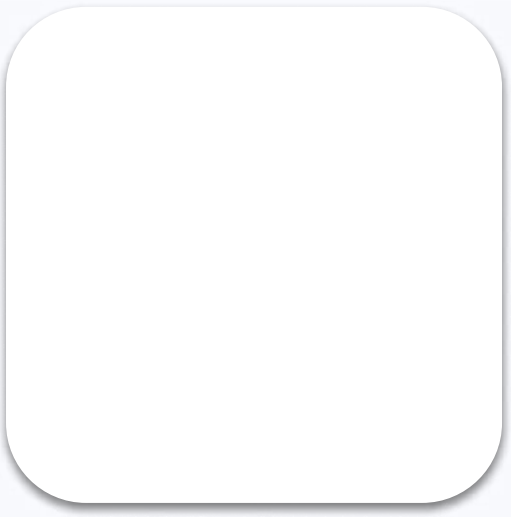


Both buttons have similar contrast. they compete for user’s attention.



Positive action has much lighter contrast. User sees a clear action.

Tip - 84 Avoid Using Default Shadows



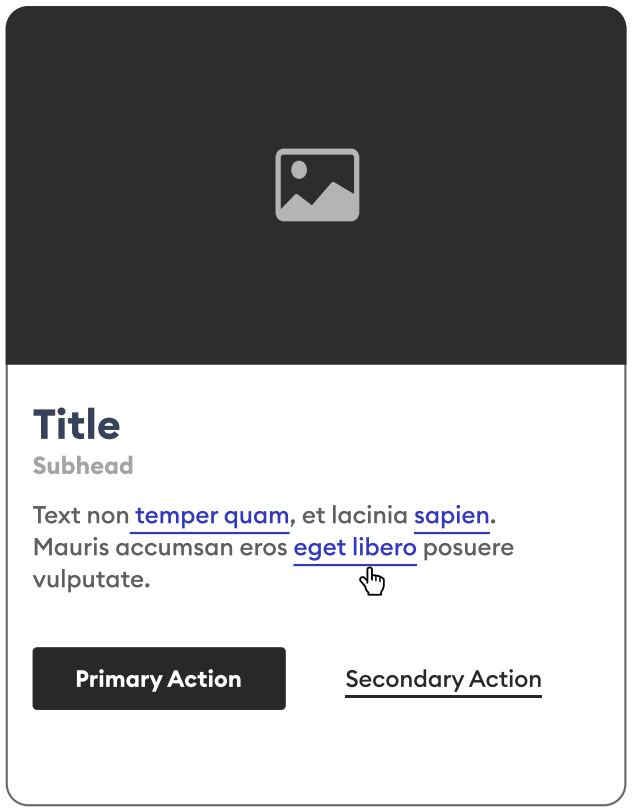
X: 0 px
Y: 2 px
BLUR: 4 px
COLOR: 000000
OPACITY: 50%

Default shadows of any software whether Figma, Xd, Sketch etc looks terrible.

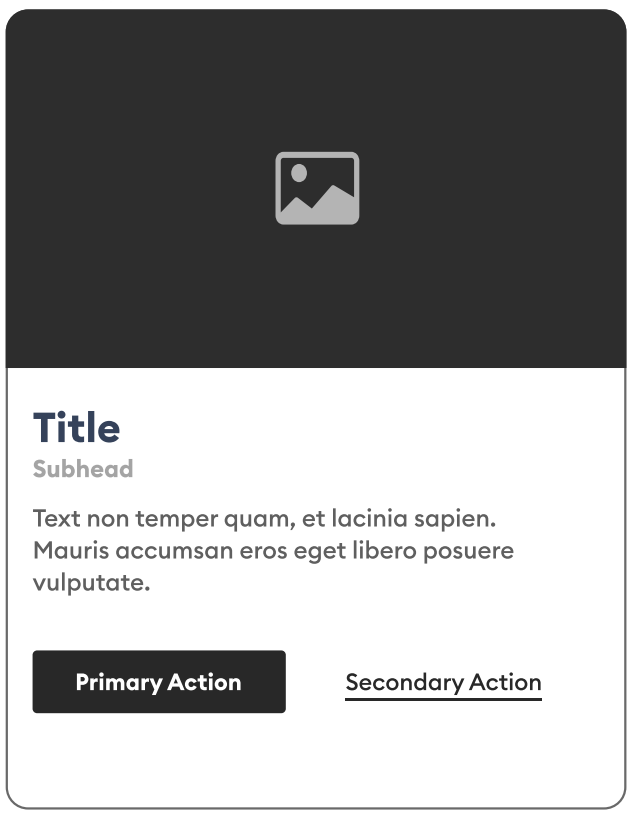
X: 0 px
Y: 8 px
BLUR: 24 px
COLOR: 000000
OPACITY: 15%

Make shadows look softer by lowering the opacity and increasing the blur.

Tip - 85 Limit Links



Too many inline links look awful and provide a negative impression.



A single link or a limited set of actions should be provided by a card.

Tip - 86 DON’T make the text too small

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet. Ea consequuntur recusandae qui quae dolores et culpa ratione qui officiis voluptas ut dolore eaque aut corrupti autem At quae fugit? Et accusamus magni id internos laboriosam non perspiciatis deserunt id error amet in sunt consequatur. In eveniet corrupti et illo dolorem vel odio quod. Ut consequatur suscipit a rerum nobis non dolor 33 consequatur vero et enim consequuntur.

12pt

Small text create difficulty for people to read clearly.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet. Ea consequuntur recusandae qui quae dolores et culpa ratione qui officiis voluptas ut dolore eaque aut corrupti autem At quae fugit? Et accusamus magni id internos laboriosam non perspiciatis deserunt id error amet in sunt consequatur. In eveniet corrupti et illo dolorem.

16pt

Make sure your body text should be no smaller than a size of 14pt.

Tip - 87 DON’T make continuous use of all caps

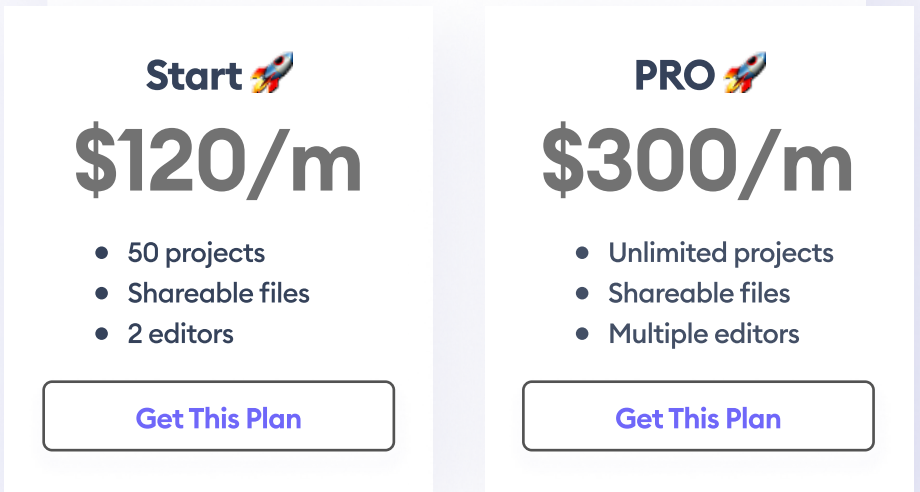
NOWHERE ELSE ON EARTH MAKES THE HEART SWOON LIKE THE MENTION OF PARIS. THE CITY LURES WITH ITS MAGNIFICENT ART, ARCHITECTURE, CULTURE, AND CUISINE, BUT THERE’S ALSO A QUIETER MAGIC WAITING TO BE EXPLORED: THE QUAINT COBBLED LANES, THE SWEET PATISSERIES AROUND THE CORNER, AND THE COSY LITTLE BISTROS.

Text of all caps are actually difficult for people to read.

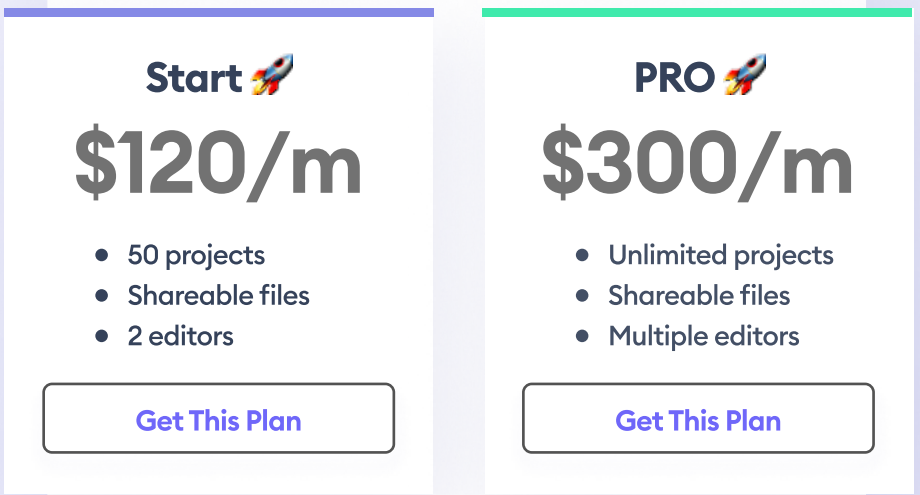
Nowhere else on earth makes the heart swoon like the mention of Paris. The city lures with its magnificent art, architecture, culture, and cuisine, but there’s also a quieter magic waiting to be explored: the quaint cobbled lanes, the sweet patisseries around the corner, and the cosy little bistros.

make sure that you use caps in moderation.

Tip - 88 Accent color

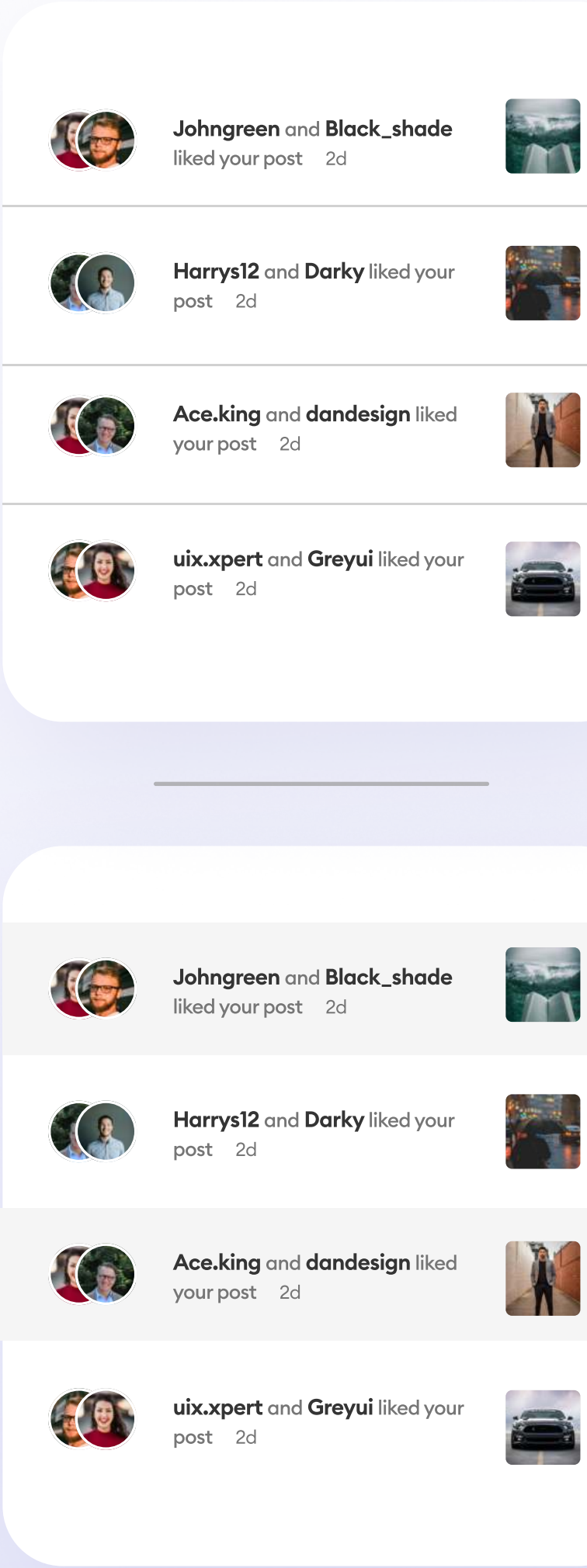


It fails to categorise the sections and looks kinda same.



Use accent colors to assist users visually categorise sections.

Tip - 89 Contrast



Using Borders for the differentiation, Feels a little outdated.

Create contrast by using color and space for content differentiation.

Tip - 90 Form Distinguish

First Name

Last Name

Address

City

Ungrouped forms fails to give the proper clarity among the users.

Personal Information

First Name

Last Name

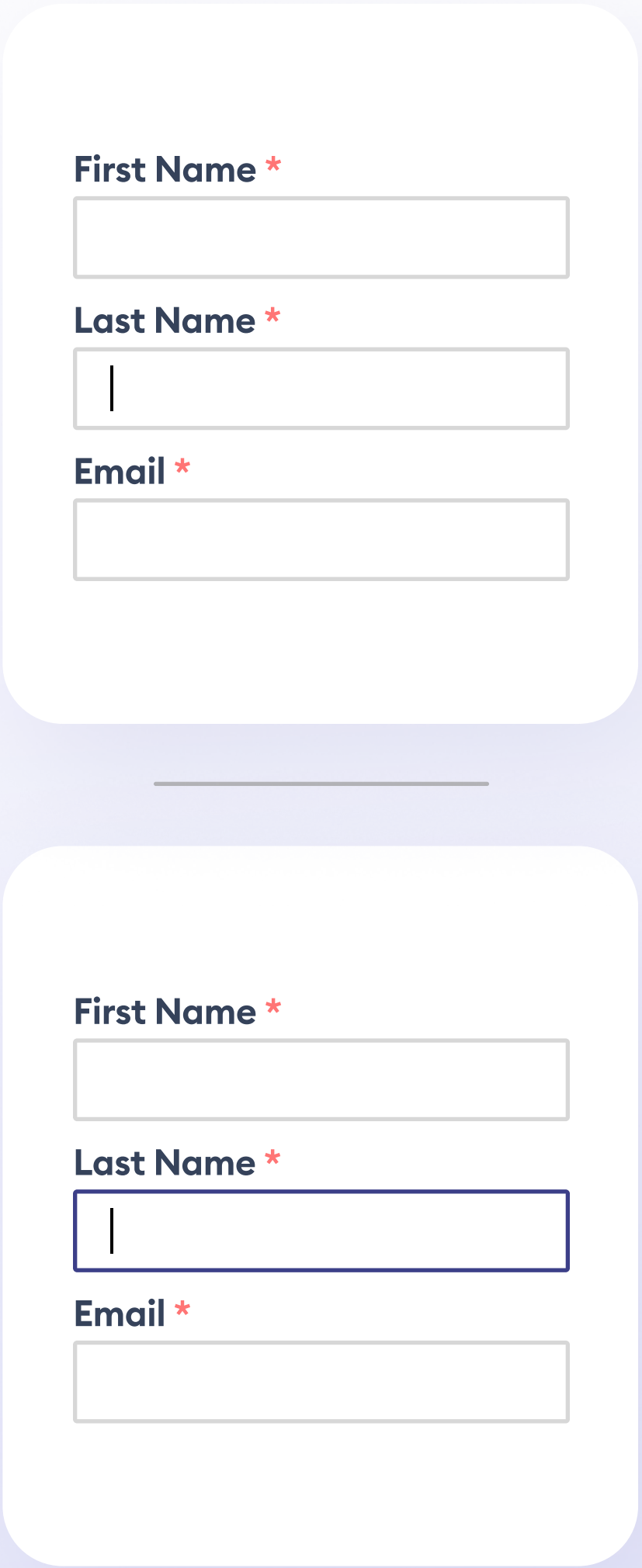
Contact Information

Address

City

Reinforcement of awareness with title + grouping to distinguish between paragraphs and region.

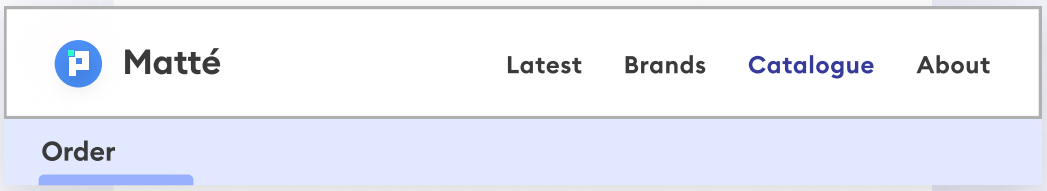
Tip - 91 Input area



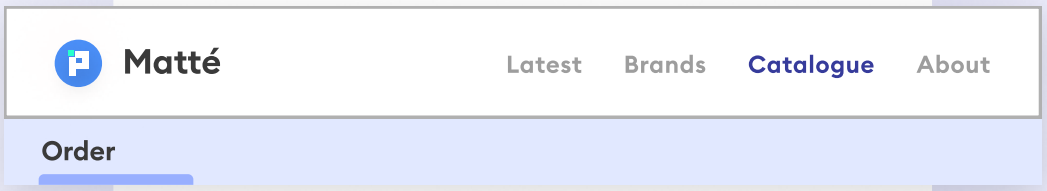
No interactive sections make the process less interesting.

Differentiating the selective section makes an interactive affect on users.

Tip - 92 Emphasize by de-emphasizing

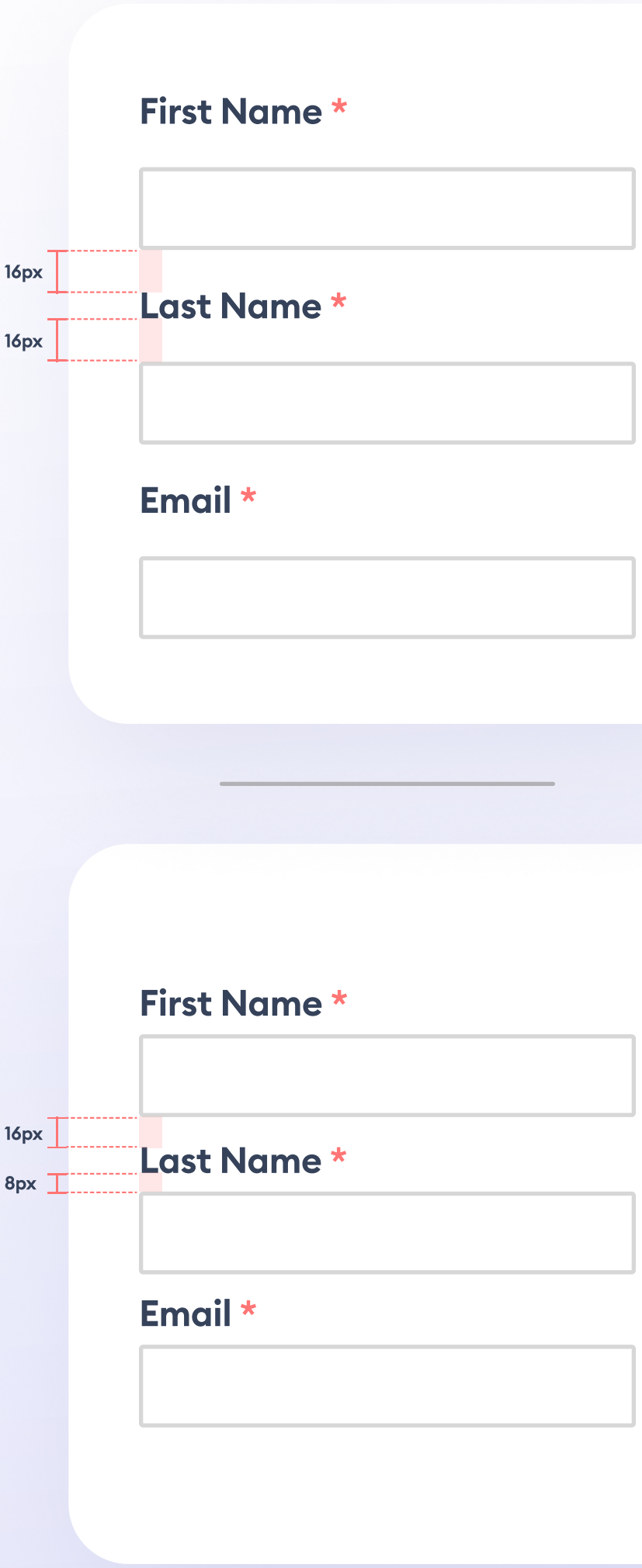


Active nav item doesn't really stand out compared to the inactive items.



Give the inactive items a softer color so they sit more in the background and help to make active nav 'Pop'.

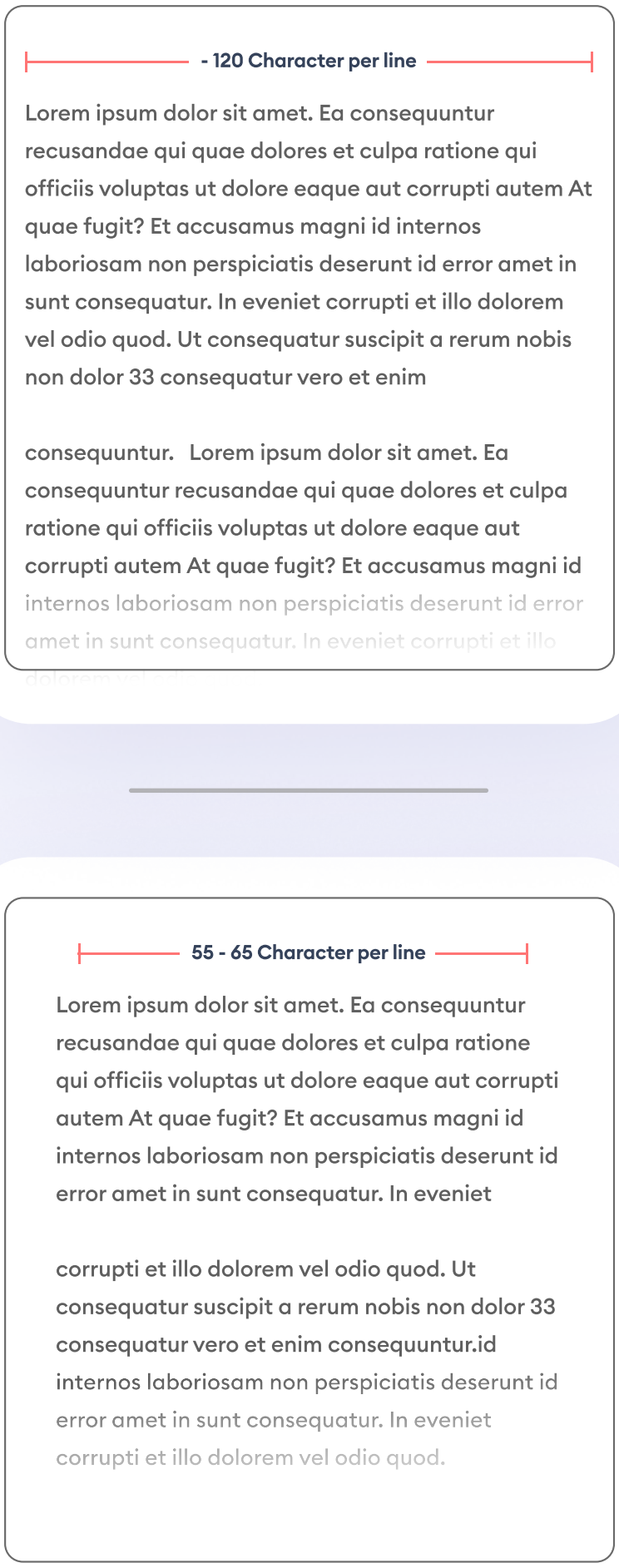
Tip - 93 Avoid ambiguous spacing



The elements in the form group don't feel obviously "connected".

The fix is to increase the space between each form group so it's clear which label corresponds to which input.

Tip - 94 Keep your line length in check



Usually this means lines that are too long, makes text harder to read.

Stick to 45-75 range if you want to play it safe.

Tip - 95 Right-align numbers

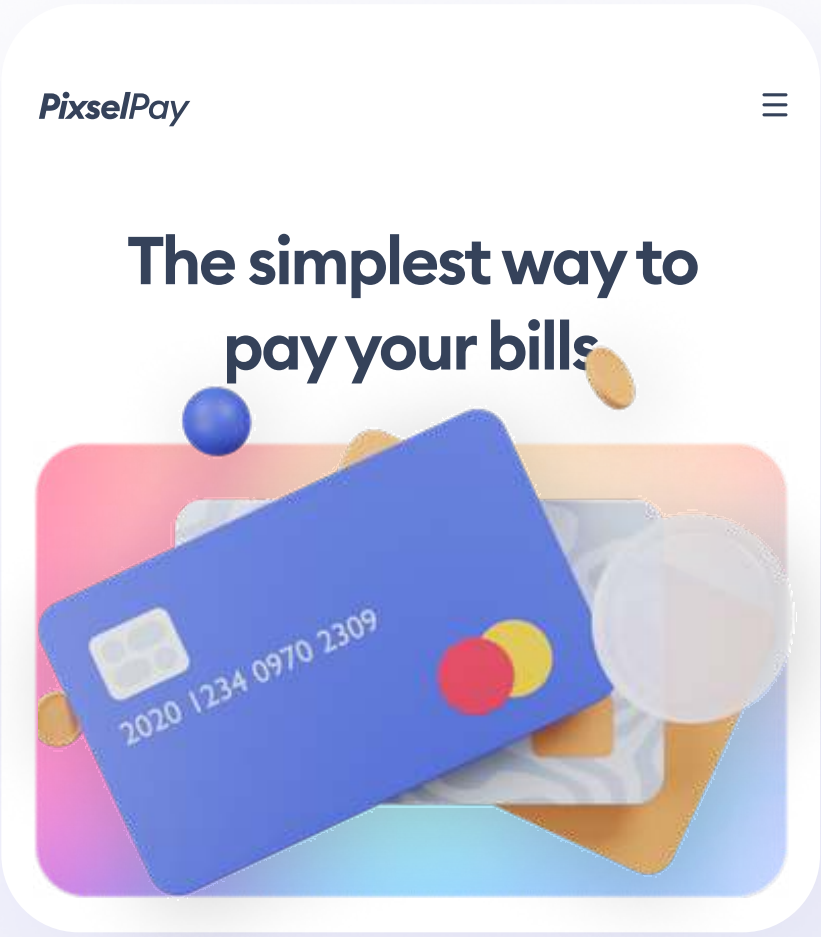
MBOL	PRICE	CHG	MKT CAP
PPL	$174.72	-197	1.007T
OOGL	$1,068.72	-17.91	875.4B
MZN	$1,645.79	+30.78	849.7B
SFT	$1,656.56	+0.67	547.4B

Decimal in a list of numbers placed uneven, makes everything look cluttery.

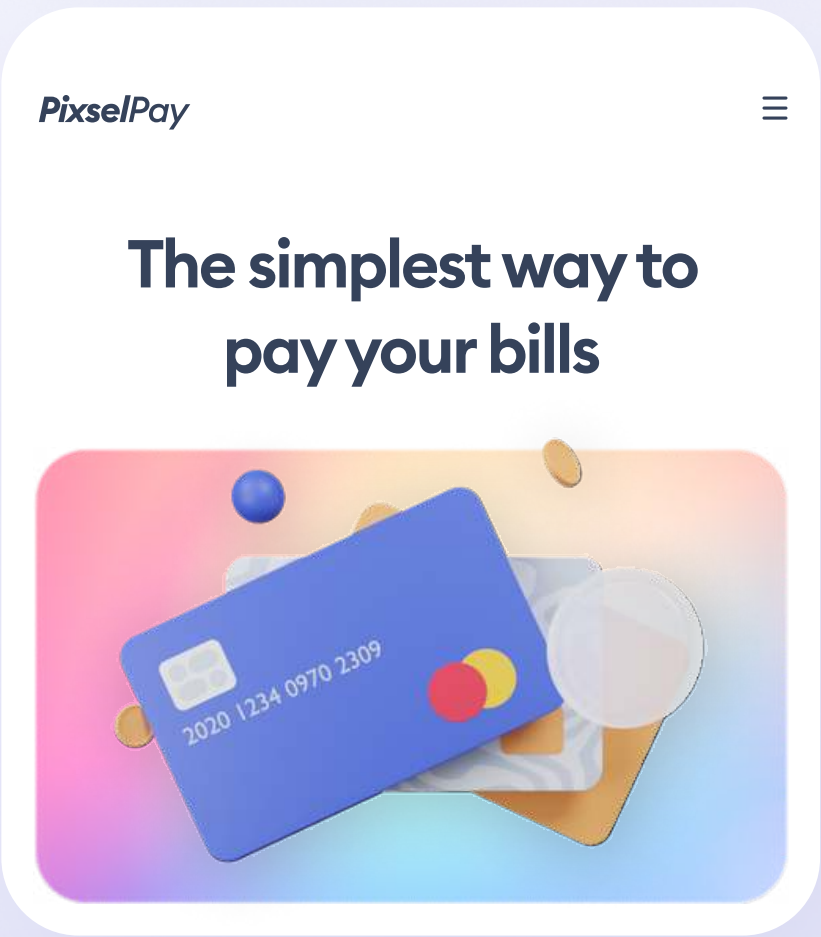
MBOL	PRICE	CHG	MKT CAP
PPL	$174.72	-197	1.007T
OOGL	$1,068.72	-17.91	875.4B
MZN	$1,645.79	+30.78	849.7B
SFT	$1,656.56	+0.67	547.4B

Usually, when the decimal in a list of numbers is always in the same place, they’re a lot easier to compare at a glance.

Tip - 96 Scale your images

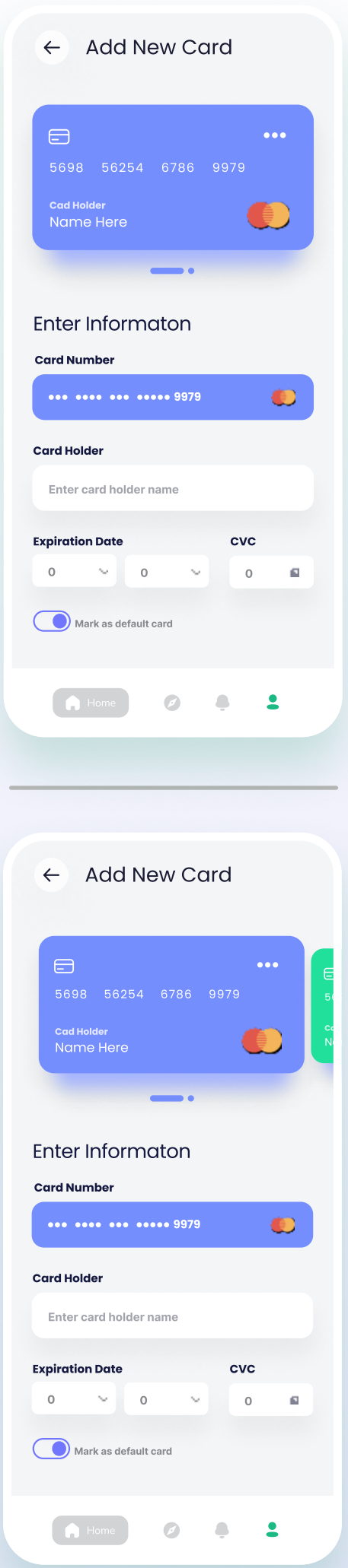


Scaling the image to the full screen might feel different for different screen sizes.



Instead scale it to fill the screen so the visual content is visible across all display sizes.

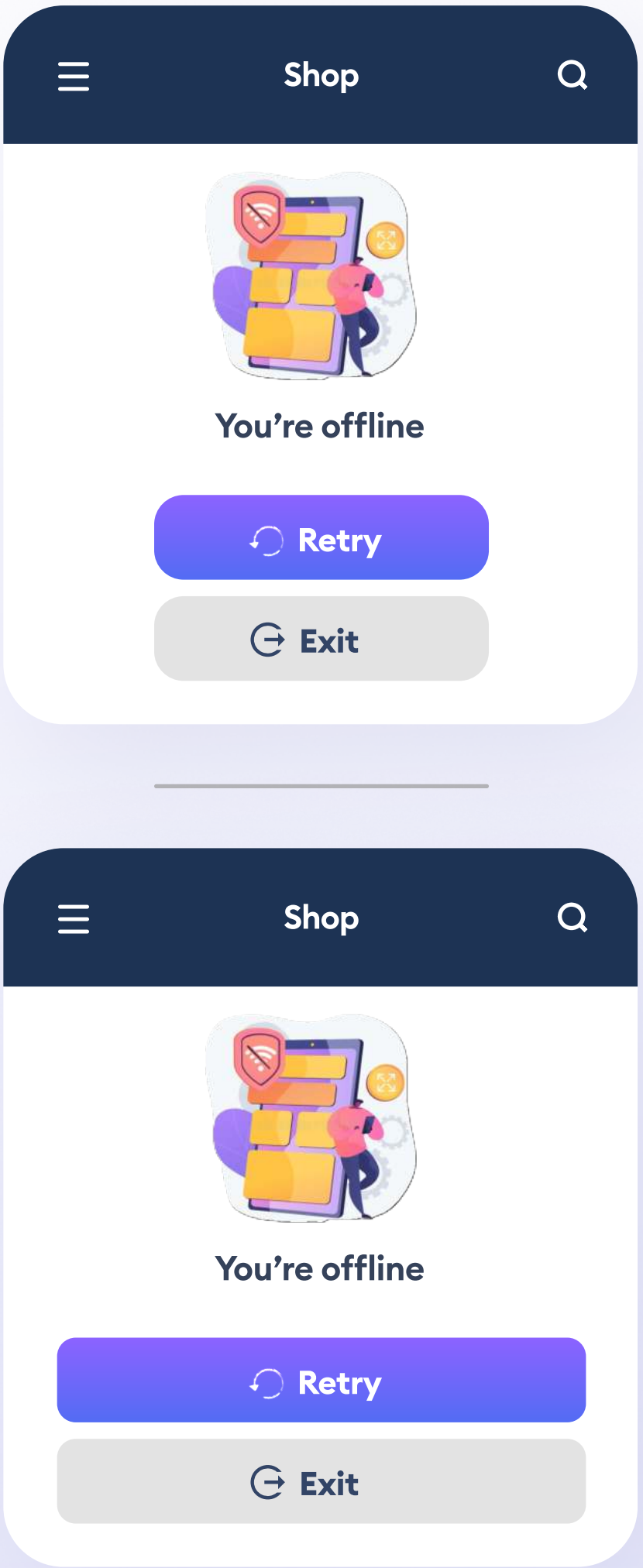
Tip - 97 Show offscreen elements



Having just a slider indicator can sometimes lead to ingnorance of the offscreen element.

Show a glance of offscreen element to indicate that there's more content hidden behind a swipe motion.

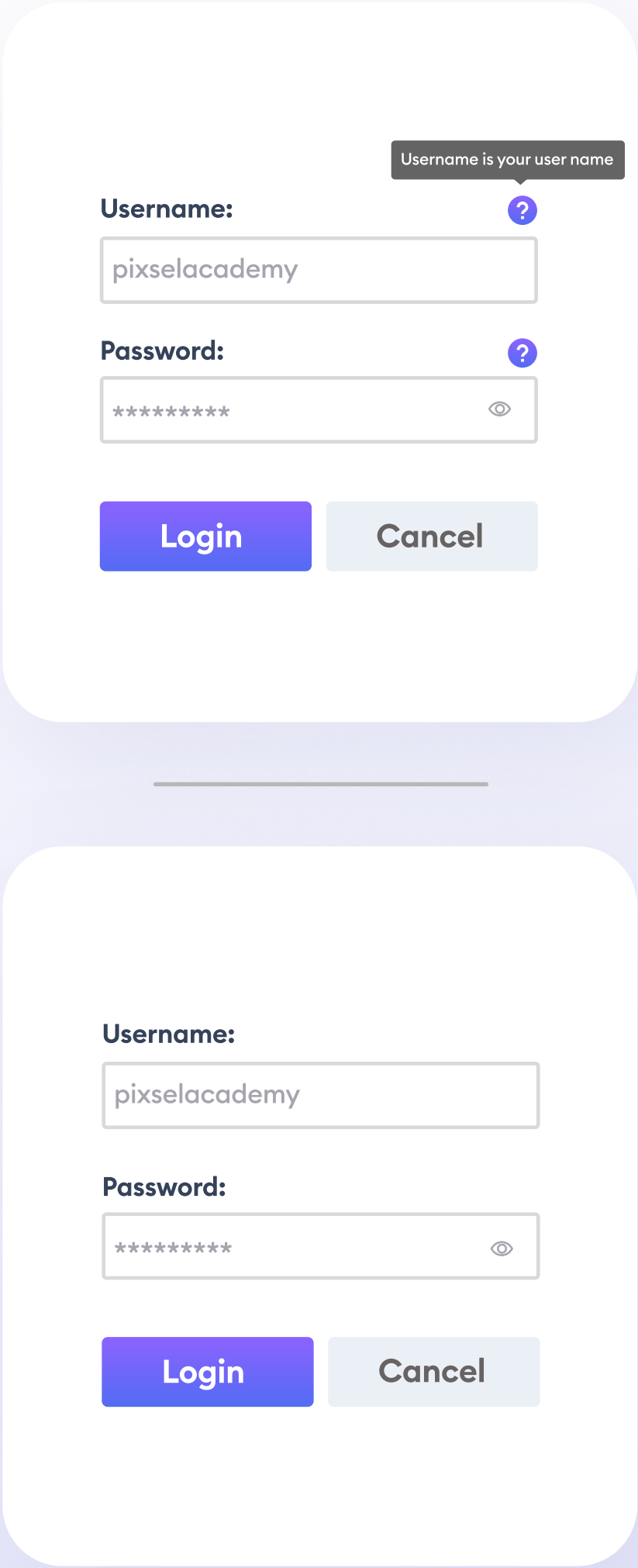
Tip - 98 Use full-width buttons



Small-sized buttons gives an incomplete feeling.

Instead try to make your buttons full-width with respect to system-specific margins.

Tip - 99 Unnecessary guide



Avoid stating the obvious info, especially with tooltips.

Obvious fields don't need explanation, and when they do add it right below.

Tip - 100 Round or Box checkbox

What are your favourite hobbies?

- ○ Cycling
- ● Football
- ○ Painting
- ● Swimming
- ○ Collecting Coins

Round checkboxes look too similar to radio-buttons!

What are your favourite hobbies?

- ☐ Cycling
- ☑ Football
- ☐ Painting
- ☑ Swimming
- ☐ Collecting Coins

Checkboxes should always be “boxes”!

Tip - 101

Create more than you Consume

This is a mistake you must avoid if you want to understand UI design. It's thousand times easier to read random design papers, keep scrolling social media for inspiration than it is to design.

I know it’s important for designers to consume the latest information and knowledge in their field but it’s necessary to maintain a balance between them.

More creation leads to more practice and ultimately help you to enhance your skill in UI design.

Thank You.

DESIGN.RIP

無料教育